

EXPLORING INTERCULTURAL COMMUNICATION: INSTRUCTORS MANUAL



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Exploring Intercultural Communication: Instructors Manual

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Introduction

The following resources were developed to help you prepare for your intercultural communication course. These supplemental materials were designed to help you facilitate dialogue and engagement with the textbook material in your classroom whether you are teaching face-to-face or online. Please remember this is an instructor's manual and intended for faculty members who are using this book. Please do not post this manual anywhere it can be accessed publicly. This manual provides instructors with chapter outlines, additional chapter resources, including, activities, discussions, supplemental materials, PowerPoint slides, and a test bank.

Outlines

For each textbook chapter we have provided an outline that provides an overview of the chapter to help instructors focus on key points in their instruction.

Chapter Resources

Activities

Active learning provides students with the opportunity to engage with course content in deeper and more meaningful ways. For each chapter, we have provided several activities illustrating key concepts and ideas.

Activities are designed for classes of roughly 30 students but they can be modified and adapted to meet the needs of classes of all sizes. We tried to be considerate of the changing modalities that we find ourselves teaching in so our classroom activities can be adapted for synchronous and asynchronous online courses. Activities can be modified for online breakout sessions (depending upon the platform being utilized) or set up to be completed entirely in the learning management system (canvas, blackboard, etc.).

The activities are structured to provide an introduction and content connection, then an explanation of the student activity is provided followed by further investigation. Leaving time for students to share their experiences with the activities helps improve student engagement and learning. Most activities can be completed individually, in pairs, small groups, and sometimes in a large class setting. Finally, some activities may require advance preparation, these are noted where needed to help you prepare.

Discussion

Each chapter has discussion questions that can be adapted to large class discussions; smaller, breakout discussions; and online discussion forums. The goal of the discussion questions is to help students connect the course content to their daily lives and the larger cultural events of our time.

Supplemental Materials

Each chapter includes links to a variety of multimedia resources. These resources include websites, videos from a number of sources including TED Talks, news articles, podcasts, online modules, movies, and other popular culture clips. These resources are provided with a web link, identifying information, and a brief explanation. The goal of these resources is to provide additional materials that you might use to illustrate and expand upon the chapter content.

PowerPoint Slides

We have provided a set of PowerPoint slides for each chapter. These slides are meant to supplement the textbook chapters and follow the chapter outlines.

The slides follow the same section headings used in the textbook chapter allowing students to connect the slide content back to the section of the textbook being shared. Slides include relevant section headings corresponding with the textbook. Our attempt was to provide the key findings from each chapter while allowing faculty to expand upon specific topics as they teach. While the slides do have some images we worked to make sure that the material was accessible and not too busy for students to easily follow along. We hope you will add additional information as you tailor the slides to your own teaching preferences.

Test Banks

A set of test questions is included for each chapter. Each chapter includes 20 multiple-choice (including true/false) questions that ask students directly about key concepts and definitions found in the textbook. The correct answer is marked with an asterisk for easy upload via Respondus. In addition to the multiple-choice questions, each chapter has a number of written questions that require both short answers and longer essay-style responses.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Introduction

Licensing

1: What is Intercultural Communication?

- 1.1: Chapter Resources
- 1.2: Outline
- 1.4: Test Bank

2: Cultural Essentials and the Roots of Culture

- 2.1: Chapter Resources
- 2.2: Outline
- 2.4: Test Bank

3: Identity and Intercultural Communication

- 3.1: Chapter Resources
- 3.2: Outline
- 3.4: Test Bank

4: Verbal Processes in Intercultural Communication

- 4.1: Chapter Resources
- 4.2: Outline
- 4.4: Test Bank

5: Nonverbal Processes in Intercultural Communication

- 5.1: Outline
- 5.3: Resources
- 5.4: Test Bank

6: Culture Shock

- 6.1: Chapter Resources
- 6.2: Outline
- 6.3: Test Bank

7: Barriers to Intercultural Communication

- 7.1: Chapter Resources
- 7.2: Outline
- 7.4: Test Bank

8: Intercultural Conflict

- 8.1: Chapter Resources
- 8.2: Outline
- 8.4: Test Bank

9: Intercultural Relationships

- [9.1: Chapter Resources](#)
- [9.2: Outline](#)
- [9.4: Test Bank](#)

10: Intercultural Communication Competence

- [10.1: Chapter Resources](#)
- [10.2: Outline](#)
- [10.4: Test Bank](#)

[Index](#)

[Glossary](#)

[Detailed Licensing](#)

Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: What is Intercultural Communication?

[1.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[1.2: Outline](#)

[1.4: Test Bank](#)

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1.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

What is Intercultural Communication?

Students come to this course with a number of different assumptions about what the course will be about. I often end up with students who think we are going to spend a semester looking at a number of different nation-states with a focus on how they communicate. Obviously, there is room for this kind of discussion as we explore key concepts but the focus on ethnic culture often dominates early perceptions of the course. Section 1.2 (Culture: Central to our Lives) addresses this perception:

This can be traced back to the work of early 19th-century German scholar Wilhelm von Humboldt, who was one of the first to equate nations with cultures (Rogers & Steinfatt, 1999). We often hear about French culture or Chinese culture. But within political boundaries, cultures are rarely monolithic. There tend to be many regional differences, as well as differences based on ethnicity, age, profession, social class, and other categories.

Section 1.4 (Intercultural Communication as an academic discipline) also addresses another aspect of this perception:

Hall was above all concerned with creating greater cultural awareness among employees of the US Department of State. He was striving to improve the ability of US technicians and diplomats to interact effectively with their foreign counterparts. Given that perspective, his approach was understandably more practical than theory-based. That pragmatism continues to be important in the field, as a central goal is to provide individuals with practical information that can be used in everyday encounters (Rogers & Steinfatt, 1999).

Student Activity:

Part 1: Have students take a few minutes to think about your class. What were their expectations when they enrolled and how is the course described in the catalog description? What are their initial impressions of the format and the course materials? You can have them write some thoughts down in this part.

Part 2: Have students get into small groups and share what they wrote beginning with their expectations for the course when they enrolled and how that has or hasn't changed based on their first impressions of the course.

Investigation:

1. Why do you think the perception of culture as something that exists at the national level persists?
2. How does this influence how we think about people from different countries?
3. Does this perception limit our ability to learn more about the different cultures in our own country?
4. What benefits could be gained from rethinking what it means to be in an intercultural encounter?

Social Justice

Section 1.1 ends with a call to expand our communicative communities and challenge our biases

Being interculturally competent means not only being responsible and empathetic in our personal encounters but extending that process more broadly. We need engaged global citizens, knowledgeable and caring about people and events outside our own backyards. Part of that process is being cognizant of the privileged position many of us enjoy. Important in that process is a willingness to break out of our regular routines of communication and information retrieval, occasionally stepping outside our social media bubble to encounter different voices and points of view. In that way, we are likely to be better informed about the complexities and fragmentations of global communities. This can lead to enhanced recognition of the need for social justice, i.e. the struggle to confront discrimination and challenge inequities.

Student Activity:

Have students look up one of the following movements for social justice (they can do this before they come to class or in class if everyone has access to a phone or computer connected to the internet):

- Antifa (Anti-fascists)
- Black Lives Matter
- Environmental Justice
- Climate Justice

- Health at Every Size
- Mad Pride
- March for Our Lives
- Me Too Movement
- Occupy Wall Street
- Prison Abolition
- Sex Workers' Rights Movement
- United Farm Workers
- United We Dream

Students should be prepared to share a little about the movement that they looked up including what inequities or discrimination the movement is working to address. They can share individually or within groups of students who chose the same movement.

Investigation:

1. Were you aware of this movement for social justice before you looked them up?
2. Are they a part of your social media bubble?
3. Did you learn anything new?
4. How might you continue to learn more about the movement?
5. What changes would that require in your current communication (information retrieval) routines?

The Cultural Iceberg

In Section 1.2 (Culture: Central to our Lives) students are introduced to the definition of culture as "an accumulated pattern of values, beliefs, and behaviors, shared by an identifiable group of people with a common history and verbal and nonverbal symbol systems." Culture can be a difficult concept for students to grasp, one analogy that has been used to help students think about culture is the cultural iceberg.

Just as an iceberg has a visible (cultural aspects we are conscious about) section above the waterline and a larger, unseen (cultural aspects we are unconscious about) section below the waterline, so too can culture be described as having some aspects that are conscious (observable elements of culture which we are conscious about) and others that can only be suspected, imagined, or intuited (elements of culture that we are less conscious about). Also, like an iceberg, the conscious elements only represent a small part of culture and it is only from delving deeper and understanding the elements below the surface that a richer understanding of culture can be formed.

Please note: The "iceberg model" is not perfect; some cultural elements can be evident both above and below the waterline. For example, in the case of religion, rituals and symbols may be conscious while beliefs may be unconscious. Someone may be wearing a religious symbol, which is observable if we are familiar with this conscious religious symbol. Some religious beliefs, for example, that some animals are unclean (below the waterline) lead to observables like the avoidance of certain food; we can observe this behavior, but without other cultural clues we may not be aware that this is linked to a person's belief. And other explanations are possible for this behavior too; for example, the specific person might not like to eat meat because they are vegetarian.

The "iceberg model" of culture (Edward T. Hall): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=woP0v-2nJCU>

Examples of conscious and unconscious elements of culture: <http://opengecko.com/interculturalism/visualising-the-iceberg-model-of-culture/>

Student Activity:

Now that students have an idea of culture as something that is both seen and unseen, have them label their own iceberg. Students can draw their own iceberg or you can provide them with a worksheet. This activity can be completed individually, in pairs, in small groups, or collectively as a class.

Investigation:

1. What aspects of culture are most visible above the waterline?
2. What do these aspects of culture help us understand?
3. How are they learned?

4. Using some specific examples provided helps students see the connections between what is visible and the values, norms, etc. associated with that aspect. For example, one thing I often talk about in my class is education. In Southern California there are a large number of colleges and universities, this is visible in the physical space they occupy, the road signs directing us to them, etc. The fact that we devote so much space to colleges and universities is indicative of the value that we place on higher education and “going to college.” Guiding this discussion will also allow you to preview much of the content you will cover moving forward in the course.

Adapted from: <https://cit4vet.erasmus.site/module-2-models-of-culture/2/> licensed under a [Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License](#).

Discussion

1. Social context refers to the stated rules or unstated norms that guide communication (section 1.3: Transactional Model of Communication). Think of a social norm that you practice. Where or how did you learn this norm? Have you ever broken this norm or witnessed someone breaking it? What was the reaction from others? What are the consequences of this norm violation? Why do you think social norms are so important for how we engage with each other?
2. The transactional model of communication (section 1.3: Transactional Model of Communication) refers to the parties engaged in communication as communicators instead of senders and receivers? What is this change in language meant to help us understand about the nature of human communication? Do you think it is possible to not communicate in a given interaction? Are there examples of kinds of communication where using sender and receiver would be more accurate?

Supplemental Resources

[If the World Were 100 People](#)

If the population of the world was only 100 people, what would society look like? Produced and Written by Gabriel Reilich; Animation by Jake Infusino.

[WIL Module 5.2 - Intercultural Communication](#)

This interactive module includes content and activities that will support participants in communicating respectfully and productively across cultures in the workplace. It provides an introduction to intercultural communication, values, etc.

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1.2: Outline

1.1: Broadening our Horizons

A. In 2012, the world's population was 7,050,000,000. Instead of talking about numbers of this magnitude, Smith represents the world as 100 people so we can more easily examine what nationalities make up the world's population, what language they speak, how old they are, and how these statistics involve wealth and education.

B. Besides simple cultural differences such as language, food, etc. cultural identity impacts individuals' accessibility to certain resources such as shelter, electricity, running water, healthcare, education, and political and legal systems.

1. What is Intercultural Communication?

A. Intercultural communication refers to the process of interacting with people who are different from oneself in fundamental ways related to appearance, language, worldviews, or a number of other categories.

1. For many people, this phenomenon is part of their everyday lives.

2. The majority of human societies deal with multiple cultures and multiple languages.

B. Globalization - the means of communication and transportation available today result in more mixing of cultures than ever before along with a growing internationalization in all areas of business and economic activity.

1. At the same time, political and economic forces are causing large numbers of people to become asylum-seekers or economic refugees, creating more diverse cities and countries throughout the world.

2. This process can also create conflict and the fear of foreigners or xenophobia.

2. The Need for Intercultural Communication Today

A. Given the demographical and globalizing trends of recent decades, in today's world, one is likely to have more encounters (online or in-person) with people from different cultures.

1. Technological advances have played a major role in bringing people together.

2. Increasing ease of travel to different parts of the world.

B. The openness and flexibility needed for successful cross-cultural exchanges offer benefits in personal and professional interactions of all kinds.

1. Companies are increasingly looking for employees who are flexible, tolerant, and able to work with others different from themselves

C. Communities and societies benefit as well, as understanding and tolerance reduce animosity and conflict.

1. Studies have shown that the geographical regions with the lowest number of immigrants or members of a minority tend to have the highest level of negative views of those groups.

D. Intercultural understanding is essential as well in gaining an informed and balanced appreciation of media.

3. Ethics and Intercultural Communication

A. The digital divide between those (predominately in developed countries) with easy access to *Facebook* and other online services and those (predominately in developing countries) who have no Internet connectivity, and possibly even no access to electricity.

1. Social justice, i.e. the struggle to confront discrimination and challenge inequities.

B. We are both consumers and producers of culture and we all have a role in shaping the nature of the world in which we live.

C. It is important not to think of culture as a fixed entity with a controlling influence on our lives.

D. There is a natural human tendency to want to be among those similar to ourselves, known as homophily.

1. Those who seem different become the "other", rejected for being dissimilar and therefore considered inferior

2. This is one of the strongest reasons we need today worldwide more intercultural understanding, so that future leaders are acculturated to accept diversity and practice tolerance.

1.2: Culture- Central to our Lives

1. Culture is a slippery concept

2. Neuliep defines culture as "an accumulated pattern of values, beliefs, and behaviors, shared by an identifiable group of people with a common history and verbal and nonverbal symbol systems"

A. An accumulated pattern of values, beliefs, and behaviors...

1. Individual cultural identities develop over time

2. Culture references a number of aspects of normal human existence

B. ...shared by an identifiable group of people...

1. That group may be small or large, fixed in a single location or dispersed among different diaspora communities (geographically separated).

C. ...with a common history...

1. How important historical memory is to members of a culture may vary.

2. According to Rogers and Steinfatt (1999), "collective cultural consciousness," the embedded memories of historical events important to a particular cultural group, can act as a kind of "message filter", significantly affecting communication dynamics (p. 3).

D. ...and (common) verbal and nonverbal symbol systems.

1. Language plays an oversized role in social cohesion and is the most important vehicle for the transmission of cultural values.

2. Nonverbal communication patterns are also a prominent constituent part of a group's identity and an easily identifiable marker for group membership.

3. Both systems are based on symbols. Some see the use of symbols as the essence of a culture.

3. Culture is not something we are born with, but rather it is learned, starting with our families, then moving on to our school experiences, and friends, and media.

4. Culture is not fixed and immutable; culture does not exist in a vacuum, but is influenced by historical, social, political, and economic conditions.

5. Cultural values are constructed from social dynamics in the countries or groups represented.

6. In everyday life, cultures are often associated with nation-states

A. But within political boundaries, cultures are rarely monolithic.

B. There tend to be many regional differences, as well as differences based on ethnicity, age, profession, social class, and other categories.

1.3: Communication- A Human Necessity

A. Putting communication at the front of your mind and becoming more aware of how you communicate can be informative and have many positive effects.

1. Communication Meets Needs

A. Physical needs include needs that keep our bodies and minds functioning like air, food, water, and sleep. At the most basic level, communication can alert others that our physical needs are not being met.

B. Instrumental needs include needs that help us get things done in our day-to-day lives and achieve short- and long-term goals. Some common instrumental needs include influencing others, getting the information we need, or securing support (Burlison, Metts, & Kirch, 2000).

C. Relational needs include needs that help us maintain social bonds and interpersonal relationships. Communicating for relational needs helps us achieve the social relating that is an essential part of being human.

D. Identity needs include our need to present ourselves to others and be thought of in particular and desired ways. Our identity changes as we progress through life, but communication is the primary means of establishing our identity and fulfilling our identity needs.

2. Communication Is a Process

A. Communication can be defined as the process of understanding and sharing meaning

1. The participants are the senders and/or receivers of messages in a communication encounter.

2. The message is the verbal or nonverbal content being conveyed from sender to receiver.

a. Encoding is the process of turning thoughts into communication.

b. Decoding is the process of turning communication into thoughts.

3. Encoded messages are sent through a channel, or a sensory route on which a message travels, to the receiver for decoding.

3. Transactional Model of Communication

A. The transactional model of communication describes communication as a process in which communicators generate social realities within social, relational, and cultural contexts.

1. Refers to the people in a communication encounter as *communicators*.

2. The model suggests that we are simultaneously senders and receivers.

B. The transactional model also includes an important understanding of context.

1. Social context refers to the stated rules or unstated norms that guide communication.

a. As we are socialized into our various communities, we learn rules and implicitly pick up on norms for communicating.

b. Norms are social conventions that we pick up on through observation, practice, and trial and error.

2. Relational context includes the previous interpersonal history and type of relationship we have with a person.

a. We communicate differently with someone we just met versus someone we've known for a long time.

3. Cultural context includes various aspects of identities such as race, gender, nationality, ethnicity, sexual orientation, class, and ability.

1.4: Intercultural Communication as an Academic Discipline

1. As an academic discipline, it is often traced back to anthropologist Edward T. Hall and his book *The Silent Language* (1959).

A. Hall was above all concerned with creating greater cultural awareness among employees of the US Department of State.

B. That pragmatism continues to be important in the field, as a central goal is to provide individuals with practical information that can be used in everyday encounters

2. European scholars have contributed important new insights and approaches to intercultural communication as have Australian and New Zealand scholars.

A. These scholars tend to focus more centrally on language issues than is the case for intercultural communication research in North America.

3. In the latter part of the 20th century, there has been considerable interest in critical intercultural communication, which views intercultural communication within the context of power structures.

A. That perspective will inform much of the discussion of intercultural communication in this textbook.

B. One of the enriching characteristics of the field is that it draws on knowledge and experience representing a great variety of academic fields.

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1.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. The means of communication and transportation available today result in more mixing of cultures than ever before. This coincides with trends in commerce and trade in recent decades which have facilitated growing internationalization in all areas of business and economic activity. A process known as:

- *a. Globalization
- b. Culture
- c. Xenophobia
- d. Digital Divide

2. Studies have shown that the geographical regions with the lowest number of immigrants or members of a minority tend to have the highest level of negative views of those groups.

- *a. True
- b. False

3. There is a natural human tendency to want to be among those similar to ourselves, known as:

- a. Heterogeneity
- *b. Homophily
- c. Ethnocentrism
- d. Social Inequity

4. Which of the following is not a part of the definition of culture adopted by the textbook?

- a. An accumulated pattern of values, beliefs, and behaviors.
- b. Shared by an identifiable group of people.
- c. With a common history.
- *d. And a decentralized form of government.

5. The most important vehicle for the transmission of culture is:

- a. The State
- b. Identity
- *c. Language
- d. School

6. In order to be part of a cultural group you must share the same geographical space.

- a. True
- *b. False

7. Culture is something we are born with.

- a. True
- *b. False

8. Communication fills _____ needs including helping us get things done in our daily lives and achieving short- and long-term goals.

- a. Physical
- *b. Instrumental

- c. Relational
- d. Identity

9. Throughout history, when societies wanted to severely punish someone for a social transgression, the harshest punishment was excommunication — banishment from the community.

*a. True

b. False

10. In communication models, the verbal or nonverbal content being conveyed is:

a. Participants

b. Channel

*c. Message

d. Context

11. Encoding is the process of turning communication into thoughts.

a. True

*b. False

12. This model describes communication as a process in which communicators generate social realities within social, relational, and cultural contexts.

a. Linear

b. Interactive

*c. Transactional

d. Contextual

13. In the transactional model of communication this context includes various aspects of identities such as race, gender, nationality, ethnicity, sexual orientation, class, and ability.

a. Political

b. Social

c. Relational

*d. Cultural

14. Japan is considered a collectivistic culture.

*a. True

b. False

15. Individualistic cultures tend to value silence.

a. True

*b. False

16. If the world were 100 people how many of them would be from the United States and Canada?

a. 60

b. 15

*c. 5

d. 1

17. Xenophobia is/are:

a. A benign process present in all cultures

*b. The fear of foreigners

c. Economic refugees

d. Disparities in the global economy

18. All of the following are reasons to improve our understanding intercultural communication except:

a. We are increasingly likely to have encounters with people from other cultures

b. Ease of travel has decreased communication apprehension and increased the need to be interculturally competent and sensitive

*c. Becoming knowledgeable about other cultures helps us move away from our own cultural understanding

d. Companies are increasingly looking for employees who are flexible, tolerant, and able to work with others

19. The struggle to confront discrimination and challenge inequities leads to:

*a. Social justice

b. Equality

c. Color blindness

d. Broadening our horizons

20. Culture is:

a. Forced upon us

b. Innate

c. Something we are born with

*d. Learned

Short Answer

1. What is the digital divide?

2. What is the channel in the communication process? Provide some examples.

3. Explain the difference between an individualistic culture and a collectivistic culture.

4. Describe critical intercultural communication.

Essay

1. Identify and explain three reasons why it is increasingly important that we understand (and study) intercultural communication.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Cultural Essentials and the Roots of Culture

[2.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[2.2: Outline](#)

[2.4: Test Bank](#)

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2.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

Values Comparison

Section 2.1 (A Values Analysis Approach to Intercultural Communication) introduces students to Geert Hofstede, sometimes called the father of modern cross-cultural science and thinking, who developed a framework for comparing values across cultures. This activity has students explore these comparisons further using the Country Comparison tools at [Hofstede Insights](#).

Student Activity: Have students choose two or three countries to compare. You can use a single point of comparison for all students (e.g. the United States) or assign specific countries to students or let them choose the countries to compare. The comparison tool will display that countries score on the following metrics: Power Distance, Individualism, Masculinity, Uncertainty Avoidance, Long-Term Orientation, and Indulgence. Students can engage in whole country comparisons or focus on one or more of the specific dimensions. You can have students share their comparisons by presenting in class or having them write down their findings. The investigation questions can be used in a class discussion or you can provide them to students to guide their comparisons.

Investigation:

1. Assuming you are from one country and traveling to another, what differences would be important to understand and how would you have to adjust your expectations and behaviors in this new environment?
2. How would a business operate differently in these countries, would it depend on what kind of business it was?
3. Would you prefer to live in one country or another, why or why not?

We Are All Connected with Nature

In Section 2.1 (Value Orientation Theory) we are introduced to The Kluckhohn-Strodtbeck Value Orientations theory. According to Kluckhohn and Strodtbeck (1961), every culture faces the same basic survival needs and must answer the same universal questions. It is out of this need that cultural values arise. The basic questions faced by people everywhere fall into five categories and reflect concerns about: 1) human nature, 2) the relationship between human beings and the natural world, 3) time, 4) human activity, and 5) social relations.

This activity takes a closer look at how different cultures answer what is the relationship between human beings and the natural world? Some societies believe nature is a powerful force in the face of which human beings are essentially helpless. We could describe this as “nature over humans.” Other societies are more likely to believe that through intelligence and the application of technology, humans can control nature. In other words, they embrace “humans over nature” position. Between these two extremes are the societies that believe humans are wise to strive to live in “harmony with nature.”

Student Activity: Asks students to begin by focusing on their own national culture. You can have them write down a few sentences about how they think their culture answers these questions. After students have had time to reflect on their own perceptions of our relationship with nature. Share the following TED Talk video: [The forest is our teacher. It's time to respect it](#), by Nemonte Nenquimo.

Investigation:

1. After watching the video how do you think indigenous cultures perceive the human relationship with nature?
2. How are these indigenous views of our relationship with nature different from your own?
3. What tensions exist between these two views and how has that contributed to the problems Nemonte identifies in the Amazon?
4. Do you think it is possible for understanding between two cultures who view nature and our relationship to it so differently?
5. What can we do to help protect indigenous land rights?

Values Collage

Chapter 2 begins with a focus on values. “Values are deeply felt and often serve as principles that guide people in their perceptions and behaviors. Using our values, certain ideas are judged to be right or wrong, good or bad, important or not important, desirable or not desirable.” Because values run so deep, it can be difficult to uncover them, using images can sometimes help us access the otherwise inaccessible.

Student Activity: Provide students with a prompt, here are some examples:

- Leadership

- Family
- Punctuality
- Personal Space
- Holiday
- Wealth
- Community

Then have students select several images and arrange them in a collage (on physical paper or digitally). Once they are finished students can share their collages in small groups or to the whole class. You can also have students write a description or a reflection about what they presented and/or learned about their own values surrounding the prompt.

Investigation:

1. What values did you identify for your prompt?
2. Were you aware of these values prior to the activity?
3. Were you surprised by any of the other presentations and what they valued about a specific area?
4. How are these values reinforced in your cultural experiences?
5. What if we wanted to change our cultural values about this concept? Do you think it is possible? How would we go about it?

Materials Note: If you want to do this activity in class you should plan on providing the images or assign the prompt ahead of time so students can bring the images to class with them.

Discussion

1. In Section 2.1 (Value Dimensions) we learned about power distance, “how openly a society or culture accepts or does not accept differences between people, as in hierarchies in the workplace.” Think about your current workplace (you could also use a previous workplace), where would you place it on the spectrum from large to small power distance? Some things to consider when answering:
 - Are hierarchies enforced amongst the employees?
 - Are formal titles used?
 - Are there chain of command rules that limit who you can communicate with and about what?
 - Are there differences in the uniform or clothing expectations depending on role?
 - Are you comfortable with where your workplace falls on this spectrum? Would you make changes if you could?
2. Section 2.2 (Intercultural Communication: A Dialectical Approach) focuses on a dialectical approach to communication. “Dichotomies are dualistic ways of thinking that highlight opposites, reducing the ability to see gradations that exist in between concepts.” Specifically, the static-dynamic dialectic suggests that culture and communication change over time yet often appear to be and are experienced as stable. While cultural change usually happens slowly when confronted with crises we can see significant cultural changes in a short period of time. We have been living through one of these events for the past few years. The Covid-19 pandemic will leave a lasting impact on many aspects of culture, where do you see this dichotomy play out in our cultural experiences coming out of the pandemic? What dynamic changes have taken place? Where had our culture remained static despite the crises we had to manage? There are great resources for this discussion available from the Claude Pepper Center at Florida State University, [The Cultural Impact of COVID-19](#). In addition to the general discussion laid out here you could also choose one area from their list of resources and focus the discussion, for example on how our relationship with science and expertise has shifted.

Supplemental Resources

[Geert Hofstede on Culture](#), Video interview with Geert Hofstede on culture and his exploration of it. 10/10/2011

[The Fundamental Question of the Pandemic is Shifting: We understand how this will end. But who bears the risk that remains?](#) *Ed Yong, The Atlantic, June 9, 2021*, Discusses individualist and collectivist attitudes toward the pandemic and the vaccine-

[What We Get Wrong About Time](#). Claudia Hammond, BBC Future. December 3, 2019. Most of us tend to think of time as linear, absolute and constantly “running out” – but is that really true? And how can we change our perceptions to feel better about its passing?

[A Discussion Series On Cultural Diversity: What Is Culture?](#) National Model United Nations

[6 Activities for Tackling Cultural Differences](#). Everyone is influenced by culture. The thing is, not everyone can pinpoint what beliefs, assumptions, and values come from their culture. In fact, if you asked your students to tell you about their culture, they may not know just what to say or where to start. These activities will get them, and you, past the cultural blinders. With these activities, issues of culture will naturally come forth, and that will give you and your class a chance to talk about them. By Susan Verner at Busy Teacher.

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2.2: Outline

2.1: A Values Analysis Approach to Intercultural Communication

1. Values and Culture

A. Value systems are fundamental to understanding how culture expresses itself.

B. Values are deeply felt and often serve as principles that guide people in their perceptions and behaviors.

1. Using our values, certain ideas are judged to be right or wrong, good or bad, important or not important, desirable or not desirable.

2. Cultural values are learned, mostly subconsciously, and are hidden deep within the language and traditions of the surrounding society.

2. Value Dimensions

A. Individualism vs. Collectivism

1. Individualism is just what it sounds like. It refers to people's tendency to take care of themselves and their immediate circle of family and friends, perhaps at the expense of the overall society.

a. The United States is labeled as the most individualistic country.

b. In the United States, individualism is valued and promoted—from its political structure (individual rights and democracy) to entrepreneurial zeal (capitalism).

2. Collectivism describes a society in which tightly-integrated relationships tie extended families and others into in-groups.

a. Collectivistic cultures (seen as prevalent in Africa, Asia, Latin America, and the Middle East) emphasize group identity and conformity, with children expected to be obedient and respectful.

3. Think of these qualities as points along a continuum rather than fixed positions.

4. Individuals and co-cultures may exhibit differences in individualism/collectivism from the dominant culture and certain contexts may highlight one or the other.

B. Power Distance

1. How openly a society or culture accepts or does not accept differences between people, as in hierarchies in the workplace, in politics, and so on.

2. Large power distance cultures openly accept that a boss is “higher” and as such deserves more formal respect and authority.

a. People tend to accept relationships of servitude.

b. An individual's status, age, and seniority are an integral part of the social equation.

3. Small power distance cultures, in which superiors and subordinates are more likely to see each other as equal in power.

a. This leads to an informality of speech, dress, and manners that other cultures might find difficult to negotiate because of their own beliefs, assumptions, and behaviors.

4. Research indicates that the United States tilts toward small power distance but is more in the middle of the scale

C. Uncertainty Avoidance

1. Measures a society's tolerance for ambiguity, in which people embrace or avert an event of something unexpected, unknown, or away from the status quo.

2. Strong uncertainty avoidance generally prefer to steer clear of conflict and competition.

a. They tend to appreciate very clear instructions.

b. They dislike ambiguity.

3. Weak uncertainty avoidance cultures, such as the U.S. and Britain, show more acceptance of differing thoughts or ideas and are highly tolerant of uncertainty.

D. Masculinity vs. Femininity

1. This index is about how society views traits that are considered masculine or feminine.
2. In masculine-oriented cultures, gender roles are usually crisply defined.
 - a. Traditionally perceived “masculine” values are assertiveness, materialism, and less concern for others.
3. In feminine-oriented cultures, gender roles are more fluid
 - a. Feminine cultures are thought to emphasize “feminine” values: concern for all, an emphasis on the quality of life, and an emphasis on relationships.
 - b. Feminine cultures typically offer generous paid maternity *and* paternity leave, free healthcare, and free access to higher education.
4. The United States is actually more moderate, and its score is ranked in the middle between masculine and feminine classifications.

E. Long-term vs. Short-term Orientation

1. The long-term orientation values persistence, perseverance, and thriftiness.
 - a. Long-term orientation is often marked by an order to relationships based on age and status.
 - b. A sense of shame, both personal and for the family and community, is also observed across generations.
2. The short-term orientation values tradition only to the extent of fulfilling social obligations or providing gifts or favors.
 - a. Personal stability and consistency are also valued in a short-term oriented culture, contributing to an overall sense of predictability and familiarity.
3. The United Kingdom and the United States rank as short-term orientation.

F. Indulgence vs. Restraint

1. The degree of freedom that societal norms give to citizens in fulfilling their human desires.
2. High indulgence ratings allow relatively free gratification of basic and natural human desires related to enjoying life and having fun.
 - a. These cultures tend to place higher importance on leisure and tend to act and spend money as they please.
3. Low indulgence ratings have strict social norms.
4. Most Anglo-Western nations such as The United States have a high indulgence rating.
3. Value Orientation Theory: Every culture faces the same basic survival needs and must answer the same universal questions. It is out of this need that cultural values arise.

A. What is the inherent nature of human beings?

1. The people in some societies are inclined to believe that people are inherently evil and that society must exercise strong measures to keep the evil impulses of people in check.
2. On the other hand, other societies are more likely to see human beings as basically good and possessing an inherent tendency towards goodness.
3. Between these two poles are societies that see human beings as possessing the potential to be either good or evil depending upon the influences that surround them.

B. What is the relationship between human beings and the natural world?

1. Nature over humans - some societies believe nature is a powerful force in the face of which human beings are essentially helpless.
2. Humans over nature - societies are more likely to believe that through intelligence and the application of technology, humans can control nature.
3. Harmony with nature - between the two extremes are the societies that believe humans are wise to strive to live in.

C. What is the best way to think about time?

1. Some societies are rooted in the past, believing that people should learn from history and strive to preserve the traditions of the past.
2. Other societies place more value on the here and now, believing people should live fully in the present.
3. Then there are societies that place the greatest value on the future, believing people should always delay immediate satisfactions while they plan and work hard to make a better future.

D. What is the proper mode of human activity?

1. In some societies, “being” is the most valued orientation. Striving for great things is not necessary or important.
2. In other societies, “becoming” is what is most valued. Life is regarded as a process of continual unfolding.
3. Finally, there are societies that are primarily oriented to “doing.” In such societies, people are likely to think of the inactive life as a wasted life.

4. Critique of Cultural Values Analysis

A. While such distinctions can be useful in describing general cultural traditions and patterns of behavior, they are problematic when applied to individuals.

B. Contemporary scholars of intercultural communication urge caution in using these categories, as they tend to “present people’s individual behavior as entirely defined and constrained by the culture in which they live so that the stereotype becomes the essence of who they are.”

1. Critics like Holliday describe the use of Hofstede’s categories as essentialism, that is, assuming that people and things have ‘natural’ characteristics that are inherent and unchanging.
2. The term reductionism is used in similar fashion, referring to the tendency to explain an object by reducing it to a different, usually simpler, level.
3. Holliday emphasizes the importance of allowing other cultures to define themselves, advocating a decentered perspective.

2.2: A Dialectical Approach to Intercultural Communication

1. Taking a dialectical approach allows us to capture the dynamism of intercultural communication.

A. A dialectic is a relationship between two opposing concepts that constantly push and pull one another

B. Thinking dialectically helps us see the complexity in culture and identity because it doesn’t allow for dichotomies.

2. We can better understand intercultural communication by examining six dialectics:

A. Cultural-Individual

1. This dialectic captures the interplay between patterned behaviors learned from a cultural group and individual behaviors that may be variations on or counter to those of the larger culture.
2. This dialectic is useful because it helps us account for exceptions to cultural norm

B. Personal-Contextual

1. This dialectic highlights the connection between our personal patterns of and preferences for communicating and how various contexts influence the personal.
2. In some cases, our communication patterns and preferences will stay the same across many contexts. In other cases, a context shift may lead us to alter our communication and adapt.

C. Differences-Similarities

1. This dialectic allows us to examine how we are simultaneously similar to and different from others.
2. When we overfocus on differences, we can end up polarizing groups that actually have things in common. When we overfocus on similarities, we essentialize, or reduce/overlook important variations within a group.

D. Static-Dynamic

1. This dialectic suggests that culture and communication change over time yet often appear to be and are experienced as stable.

E. History/Past-Present/Future

1. This dialectic reminds us to understand that while current cultural conditions are important and that our actions now will inevitably affect our future, those conditions are not without a history.

F. Privileges-Disadvantages

1. This dialectic captures the complex interrelation of unearned, systemic advantages and disadvantages that operate among our various identities.

2. To understand this dialectic, we must view culture and identity through a lens of intersectionality, which asks us to acknowledge that we each have multiple cultures and identities that intersect with each other.

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2.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. _____ are deeply felt and often serve as principles that guide people in their perceptions and behaviors.
 - a. Cultures
 - *b. Values
 - c. Dimensions
 - d. Beliefs
2. Individualism is where you are concerned with the needs of the individuals in a culture as a whole.
 - a. True
 - *b. False
3. "Daniel Boone's father knew it was time to move whenever a new neighbor was so close that he could see smoke from the neighbor's fireplace," illustrates what enduring American value?
 - *a. Individuality
 - b. A lack of formality
 - c. Efficient use of time
 - d. Cooperation with nature
4. Among Japanese students, when an underclassman addresses an upperclassman, they ordinarily use the term sempai to identify the individual's status. This example illustrates what aspect of Japanese culture?
 - a. High context
 - b. Low context
 - *c. Large power distance
 - d. Small power distance
5. The extent to which people within a culture are made nervous by situations, which they perceive to be unstructured, unclear, or unpredictable, reflects the cultural orientation toward:
 - a. Flexibility
 - *b. Uncertainty avoidance
 - c. Power distance
 - d. Indulgence
6. Collectivist cultures value independence over interdependence.
 - a. True
 - *b. False
7. People in this type of culture tend to be relatively laid-back about status and social standing.
 - a. Long-term orientation
 - b. Short-term orientation
 - c. Large power distance
 - *d. Small power distance
8. _____ cultures typically offer generous paid maternity and paternity leave, free healthcare, and free access to higher education.
 - a. Masculine

*b. Feminine

c. Indulgent

d. Restrained

9. In the US there may be a respect for tradition, there is also an emphasis on personal representation and honor, a reflection of identity and integrity. This reflects:

a. The long-term orientation

*b. The short-term orientation

c. Strong uncertainty avoidance

d. Weak uncertainty avoidance

10. This dimension refers to the degree of freedom that societal norms give to citizens in fulfilling their human desires.

a. Uncertainty avoidance

b. Power distance

c. Masculinity v. Femininity

*d. Indulgence v. Restraint

11. On this scale, the United States is moderate as its score is ranked in the middle between masculine and feminine classifications.

*a. True

b. False

12. Early Western European immigrants to North America encountered a vast, unforgiving wilderness that they set out to “tame,” and modern astronauts working to “conquer” space, are examples of:

a. Humans being subject to nature

b. Cooperation with nature

*c. Controlling nature

d. Nurture over nature

13. Some societies are rooted in the past, believing that people should learn from history and strive to preserve the traditions of the past. Other societies place more value on the here and now, believing people should live fully in the present. What orientation is reflected in these values?

a. Human nature

b. Relationship to the natural world

*c. Time

d. Activity

14. Contemporary scholars of intercultural communication urge caution in using categories, as they tend to “present people's individual behavior as entirely defined and constrained by the culture in which they live so that the stereotype becomes the essence of who they are” this is known as:

a. Ethnocentrism

*b. Essentialism

c. Cultural appropriation

d. Decentered

15. We may think of a white, heterosexual male as being very privileged, he may also have a disability that leaves him without the able-bodied privilege that a Latina woman has. This example best illustrates what dialectic?

a. Cultural-Individual

b. Personal-Contextual

c. Static-Dynamic

*d. Privilege-Disadvantage

16. This dialectic suggests that culture and communication change over time yet often appear to be and are experienced as stable.

a. Cultural-Individual

b. Differences-Similarities

*c. Static-Dynamic

d. Privilege-Disadvantage

17. In societies that are primarily oriented to _____, people are likely to think of the inactive life as a wasted life.

a. Becoming

*b. Doing

c. Being

d. Longing

18. This critique of cultural value analysis argues that it reduces identities to a predetermined set of characteristics, associated with ethnic or cultural stereotypes.

a. Ethnocentrism

b. Racism

c. Essentialism

*d. Reductionism

19. _____ are dualistic ways of thinking that highlight opposites, reducing the ability to see gradations that exist in between concepts.

*a. Dichotomies

b. Dyads

c. Disingenuous

d. Delusions

20. When discussions of reparations, or compensation for descendants of slaves, comes up. a common refrain of some white people is "I've never owned slaves. Why should I have to care about this now?" This example illustrates the tension between _____ dialectic?

a. Static-Dynamic

*b. History/Past-Present/Future

c. Privilege-Disadvantage

d. Personal-Contextual

Type: E

Short-Answer

1. Explain the "Dialectical Approach" to intercultural communication.

2. How do cultural values underlie cultural norms? Elaborate with real world examples.

3. How does ethnocentrism affect one's viewpoint?

4. How do the beliefs and values of individuals affect society?

5. How do geography, climate, and natural resources affect what a culture values?

Essay

1. Compare and contrast how the current culture that you are a member of, values and displays one of the following in everyday life: Individualism vs. Collectivism, Power Distance, Uncertainty avoidance, or Masculinity vs. Femininity. (be sure to use everyday examples as well as course content to back your claims).

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Identity and Intercultural Communication

[3.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[3.2: Outline](#)

[3.4: Test Bank](#)

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3.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

Cultural Interview

Chapter 3 begins by directing us to ask “Who am I?” As we learned in previous chapters our self-concept is developed in part by how others see us. Thinking about who we are now, who we were before, and who we will become is a life-long process. This activity will help students think explicitly about themselves and who they are. You can use all of the interview questions or pair the list down to meet your specific needs.

Student Activity: This activity can be done individually where students simply answer the questions for themselves. Or it can be an interview where they are put in pairs and they ask each other the questions.

Interview Questions:

1. How do you define “family?”
2. Who holds the most “status” in your family? Why?
3. How do you define success?
4. Do you consider your parents to be successful?
5. How important is education in your family?
6. Did you ever live with your grandparents or extended family?
7. Is punctuality important to you? Why or why not?
8. What is the most important meal of the day?
9. What types of foods do you like to eat? Are these foods considered indigenous to your culture?
10. Do you actively participate in organized religion?
11. How important is religion in your family? Why ?
12. If religion is important in your family, do you plan to pass this on to your children? Why or why not?
13. Are the roles of men and women specifically defined in your family? If so, what are they?
14. Do you have any eating habits/rituals that are specific to your culture?
15. What is your most important (or most celebrated) holiday?
16. If you are from a culture that speaks English as a second language, do you speak your native language? If not, why? If so, will you teach your native language to any children you have?
17. How do you perceive physical contact?
18. What is considered most disrespectful in your culture?
19. What is considered most respectful in your culture?
20. What would you say is, from your perspective, the most commonly held misconception about people of your culture?
21. Have you ever experienced racism? In what form?
22. Have you ever felt excluded based on your gender?

Investigation:

1. What is self-concept? How do your interactions with others, like your family, influence your perception of yourself?
2. Did any of your answers surprise you? Why or why not?
3. Did you notice any similarities between the answers of your classmates? Did these similarities correlate with a shared cultural identity?
4. Are there areas where your individual identity diverges from your cultural norms?
5. Are there other questions you would add to this list to encourage self-reflection?

Refugee Resettlement

Section 3.3 (Refugees) focuses on cross-cultural adaptation including refugees. “In addition to those leaving their home country in order to better themselves and their families economically, many migrants leave in order to escape regional or national danger or deprivation. Some leave to escape discrimination due to their ethnicity, religion, or political affiliation.” Refugees face a difficult decision to leave, a perilous journey to reach safety, and are often subject to exploitation, suspicion, and discrimination.

“Organized efforts to help refugees exist in many countries. In some cases, these are organized by national governments, often in cooperation with international groups such as the international Red Cross or the UN Refugee Agency” (section 3.3: Refugees). The

United States has historically led the world in refugee resettlement numbers but admissions have recently fallen to record lows. In 2018 the United States fell behind Canada as the top resettlement country globally. And in the fiscal year 2020, the United States resettled fewer than 12,000 refugees, a far cry from the 70,000 to 80,000 resettled annually just a few years earlier and the 207,000 welcomed in 1980, the year the formal U.S. resettlement program began ([Migration Policy Institute, 2021](#)).

Student Activity: Have students review [current refugee crises](#) facing the world. This could be done individually or in small groups. Where are we seeing large numbers of refugees? What are they fleeing? Where are they headed? You could assign each small group one specific area (e.g. Syria, Venezuela, South Sudan, etc.) and then have them share out the basic details with the class.

Investigation:

1. Should the US increase the number of refugee admissions?
2. What obligation do we have in the “West” to help those feeling crisis situations?
3. What potential problems might increasing refugee admissions in the US cause
4. How could they be managed?

Ableism

Section 3.2 (Ability) focuses on a variety of different cultural identities. One often-overlooked cultural identity is disability. The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) defines an individual with a disability as “a person who has a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities, a person who has a history or record of such an impairment, or a person who is perceived by others as having such an impairment” (Allen, 2011). Ability has institutionalized privileges and disadvantages associated with it. Ableism is the system of beliefs and practices that produces a physical and mental standard that is projected as normal for a human being and labels deviations from it abnormal, resulting in unequal treatment and access to resources.

Until recently a medical model was the dominant view of disability. In this view disease or injury was seen as something to be cured through medical intervention. In this model, the focus is on the individual who needs to be made normal by healing. Today this outdated view is being replaced by a social model of disability. In this view, disability is seen as mainly caused by environmental and social barriers. Disability is a reflection of society’s unwillingness to provide accessible spaces and facilities that would enable individuals with disabilities to fully participate in all aspects of society. A wheelchair user isn’t disabled because they are in a wheelchair, but because society continues to build stairs.

[Elevator Pitch](#), Martyna Starosta, Time, July 31, 2020.

A short film by Martyna Starosta looks at accessibility challenges in New York City’s massive subway system, as advocates fight to get elevators in stations and improve usage for all.

Student Activity: Have students get into small groups to explore the ways in which societal and environmental barriers create disability.

*One other example I often point to is the increasing prevalence of touch screens, they are ubiquitous in cell phones at this point but they are becoming incredibly standardized on kiosks at the grocery store, the airport, the bank, etc. The move from physical buttons to touch screens has made it increasingly difficult for those who are blind or visually impaired to access these self-service devices.

Some additional resources you might include:

There have been significant changes to the way buildings are designed in American architecture since the passage of the Americans With Disabilities Act (ADA) thirty years ago. The ADA is a landmark civil rights legislation that was a pivotal element in architecture and design for creating public space, buildings, and products. We take for granted the ramps, push-button doors, Braille signage, and other accessible features we encounter in our daily lives due to the ADA. However, there is still a way to go. In 2019, a multi-million dollar library was opened in Queens, NY. The beautiful design with tiers of shelves that connect to cascading stairs were not accessible for anyone using a wheelchair. Disability advocates argue that there’s only so much legislation can do and that it goes beyond civil rights. Designs should be on a broader vision of accessibility that takes a mind shift. The snake-like pathways at the Robert W. Wilson Overlook combine form and function that meet accessibility needs. Designers have moved from “universal design” to “inclusive design” that helps just about everybody (for example, curb cuts for wheelchair users). Architecture and design need to go beyond the ADA letter of the law and embody civil rights goals.

[Building Accessibility Into America, Literally](#), Michael Kimmelman, The New York Times, July 20, 2020.

A viral video of a woman crying over her broken wheelchair by an airline spotlights an ongoing problem of airlines mishandling wheelchairs. Since airlines were required to report lost or damaged wheelchairs in 2018, more than 15,000 have been mishandled by major airlines. This figure would be significantly higher if not for the pandemic that limited air travel. In 2019, an average of 29 wheelchairs were lost or damaged. The problem has been ignored for too long and airlines do not fully understand the importance of a wheelchair for those who need them. Although airlines are responsible for repairing or replacing mishandled wheelchairs, this can take weeks or even months. A wheelchair user's mobility and independence will be limited without their wheelchair. Airlines need to do better to ensure safe and dignified travel for all and improve the experience for travelers with wheelchairs.

[Airlines have lost or damaged more than 15,000 wheelchairs since late 2018](#), Hannah Sampson, The Washington Post, June 7, 2021.

Hundreds of millions of people with disabilities live in cities throughout the world and about one billion people will be urban dwellers by 2050. The UN declared poor accessibility is a major challenge. Physically disabled individuals encounter barriers such as blocked ramps, no elevators, and inaccessible bathrooms. Learning disabled individuals can be overwhelmed with loud noises, flashy lights, or environments that are sensory overload. Although there are strides made with The US's Americans With Disabilities Act, Britain's Equality Act, and Australia's Disability Discrimination Act are meant to increase access, it does not always happen on the ground. Cities will benefit from accessibility. Disabled people are less likely to socialize due to a lack of accessible transportation leading to cities losing out on economic gains. Some cities are making a change. Seattle, known for its hilly roads, is not easily accessible for people with limited mobility. AccessMap was created to allow people with limited mobility to plan an accessible route, such as limiting the amount of uphill and downhill routes. Singapore's "Silver Tsunami" (1 in 5 will be over 60 by 2030) made them aware of accessibility challenges with their aging population. The city has been praised by the UN for its universal design of a business building without columns and low concierge counters to help people with limited mobility easily move around the building. Other cities such as Washington DC's fully accessible metro system and Sonoma's autism-friendly design are incorporating accessibility into their city designs.

[What would a truly disabled-accessible city look like?](#), Saba Salman, The Guardian, February 14, 2018.

Investigation:

1. What example did your group come up with to illustrate the way that social structures and environmental barriers create disability?
2. What choices have been made in the construction of our physical space to contribute to disability? For example, stairs take up a significant amount of space in a building, it would be much more cost and space-efficient to just use robes or polls to move from one level to the next but that would render a significant portion of the population disabled because they could not pull themselves up a rope ladder to reach higher levels of the building. In this case, stairs are the accommodation but that is a choice and one that continues to exclude millions of people.
3. Why is it so easy for able-bodied folks to overlook these concerns in their daily lives?
4. What can we do to advocate for more inclusive design? [Why It Is Time to Make Inclusive Development Inclusive](#), Charlotte McClain-Nhlapo, TED Talk.

Discussion

1. In Section 3.1 (Personal, Social, and Cultural Identities) we are introduced to the three main identity categories, personal, social, and cultural. "Our social identities are the components of self that are derived from involvement in social groups with which we are interpersonally committed." Identify a social identity that you occupy? Is your membership in this group voluntary or involuntary? Is your participation implicit or explicit? How long have you been a part of this social group? How does this social identity shape your personal identity? How would your personal identity be impacted if you were to no longer have this specific social identity?
2. "Transgender is an umbrella term for people whose gender identity and/or expression do not match the gender they were assigned by birth" (section 3.2: Gender). Increasingly transgender rights have been under a microscope as states have moved to restrict access to trans affirming healthcare, mental health services, and participation in school athletics.

[At least 7 states proposed anti-trans bills in first week of 2022](#), Matt Laviates, NBC News, January 7, 2022. [In Texas, an unrelenting assault on trans rights is taking a mental toll](#), Rina Torchinsky, NPR, February 25, 2022. [Alabama May Pass the Most Aggressive Anti-Transgender Bill Yet](#), Serena Sonoma, glad, March 3, 2022. No person should be subject to discrimination because of who they are. What does this kind of legislation do? What is the history behind this effort? Why is this proposed

legislation harmful? How can individuals help fight these bills? [Dr. Rachel Levine Questions State Bills Targeting Transgender Health Care](#), Becky Sullivan, Ari Sahpiro, NPR, April 1, 2021.

Supplemental Materials

[All Mixed Up: What Do We Call People Of Multiple Backgrounds?](#) Leah Donnella, NPR Code Switch, August 25, 2016.

In a country where the share of multiracial children has multiplied tenfold in the past 50 years, it's a good time to take stock of our shared vocabulary when it comes to describing Americans with multiple backgrounds.

[To Fix the US Coronavirus Response, Start with Culture](#) Sarah McCool, Global Health Now, August 19, 2020. John Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health. Culture is critical to understanding Americans' divided response to COVID-19, but no one is talking about it.

Why do we say "Latino?"

The first thing to pop into your mind when you hear "Latino" is probably people from Latin America - places like Mexico, Colombia, Venezuela, etc. But where exactly did the history of that word come from, and has it always meant Central America and South America as well as the Caribbean? Today Danielle traces the origin of the term "Latino" and the debates that still surround it as well as the term "Hispanic" and "Latinx." Created and Hosted by Danielle Bainbridge Produced by Complexly for PBS Digital Studios

Why Do We Say "Asian American" Not "Oriental"?

The word Oriental is hundreds of years old, so why do Americans no longer use the word "Oriental"? And how did the word "Asian American" take its place? Watch this week's Origin of Everything (PBS)

Is One Of America's Favorite Founding Myths At The Root Of Our Pandemic Failure?

America's response to the coronavirus pandemic has been panned as selfish and individualistic. But has America always had a tradition of prioritizing individualism? In this episode of Think Again, NBC News correspondent Andrew Stern digs into our nation's past to investigate our present and future.

What the U.S. coronavirus response says about American exceptionalism

Coronavirus cases in Florida, Arizona and South Carolina are increasing faster than in any other country in the world, reigniting the debate over American exceptionalism. Nick Schiffrin talks to former Mexican foreign minister Jorge Castaneda, former Hungarian ambassador to the U.S. Réka Szemerényi and Maina Kiai, a human rights and anti-corruption lawyer previously with the United Nations.

Planetary

We are in the midst of a global crisis of perspective. We have forgotten the undeniable truth that everything is connected. [PLANETARY](#) is a provocative and breathtaking wake-up call, a cross-continental, cinematic journey, that explores our cosmic origins and our future as a species. PLANETARY is a poetic and humbling reminder that it's time to shift our perspective. PLANETARY asks us to rethink who we really are, to reconsider our relationship with ourselves, each other, and the world around us - to remember that: we are PLANETARY. In a stunning visual exploration, the film interweaves imagery from NASA Apollo missions with visions of the Milky Way, Buddhist monasteries in the Himalayas, and the cacophonous sounds of downtown Tokyo and Manhattan, with intimate interviews from renowned experts including astronauts Ron Garan and Mae Jemison (the first African American woman in space), celebrated environmentalist Bill McKibben, National Book Award winner Barry Lopez, anthropologist Wade Davis, to National Geographic Explorer Elizabeth Lindsey, and Head of the Tibetan Buddhist Kagyu school, the 17th Karmapa. They shed new light on the ways our worldview is profoundly affecting life on our planet.

Discussion Questions

1. A key theme implicit throughout this film is the role of beauty and appreciation for the wonder of this planet. Human civilization is responsible for causing a lot of damage to the natural world. What do you think are the benefits of reminding ourselves of the beauty of what we are destroying?

2. Planetary is an emotive film. Which parts of the film were the most powerful emotionally? Why? Were there any parts that didn't affect you emotionally? Why?
3. Peter Russell says that the current crisis we're in was probably inevitable as soon as we started developing tools as a species. Do you think the crisis we are in is inevitable?
4. Do you agree that one of the things we require is a shift in our worldview, a change in how we use the incredible technologies we have developed as a species? If so, what do you think are the features of this worldview? What are the attitudes and values that are required for us to develop a sustainable civilization?
5. Janine Benyus talks about the idea of humanity becoming a "welcome species" when "civilization is functionally indistinguishable from the ecosystem that surrounds it." What do you think is meant by the phrase "a welcome species"? What do you think are the main differences between human civilization and the natural world, especially in terms of things like waste and recycling? Do you think these differences are unavoidable?

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3.2: Outline

3.1: Foundations of Culture and Identity

A. We develop a sense of who we are based on what is reflected back on us from other people. Our parents, friends, teachers, and the media help shape our identities.

B. Most people in Western societies reach a stage in adolescence where maturing cognitive abilities and increased social awareness lead them to begin to reflect on who they are

C. Our identities make up an important part of our self-concept and can be broken down into three main categories.

1. Personal, Social, and Cultural Identities

A. Our identities are formed through processes that started before we were born and will continue after we are gone; therefore our identities aren't something we achieve or complete.

B. Personal identities include the components of self that are primarily intrapersonal and connected to our life experiences.

1. Personal identities may change often as people have new experiences and develop new interests and hobbies.

C. Social identities are the components of self that are derived from involvement in social groups with which we are interpersonally committed.

1. Social identities differ from personal identities because they are externally organized through membership.

2. Social identities do not change as often because they take more time to develop, as you must become interpersonally invested.

D. Cultural identities are based on socially constructed categories that teach us a way of being and include expectations for social behavior or ways of acting

1. Since we are often a part of them since birth, cultural identities are the least changeable of the three.

2. In order to be accepted as a member of a cultural group, members must be acculturated, essentially learning and using a code that other group members will be able to recognize.

E. Ascribed identities are personal, social, or cultural identities that are placed on us by others.

F. Avowed identities are those that we claim for ourselves.

1. Although some identities are essentially permanent, the degree to which we are aware of them, also known as salience, changes. The intensity with which we avow an identity also changes based on context.

G. Dominant identities historically had and currently have more resources and influence.

1. Uneven distribution of resources and power means members of dominant groups are granted privileges while non-dominant groups are at a disadvantage.

H. Nondominant identities historically had and currently have less resources and influence.

1. The main nondominant groups must face various forms of institutionalized discrimination, including racism, sexism, heterosexism, and ableism.

2. Identity Development

A. While the stages in this model help us understand how many people experience their identities, identity development is complex, and there may be variations.

B. We must also remember that people have multiple identities that intersect with each other.

C. Nondominant Identity Development

1. The first stage is unexamined identity, which is characterized by a lack of awareness of or lack of interest in one's identity.

a. When a person's lack of interest in their own identity is replaced by an investment in a dominant group's identity, they may move to the next stage.

2. In the conformity stage, an individual internalizes or adopts the values and norms of the dominant group, often in an effort not to be perceived as different.

- a. Individuals may attempt to assimilate into the dominant culture by changing their appearance, their mannerisms, the way they talk, or even their name.
 - b. So people move to the next stage when they realize that despite their efforts they are still perceived as different by and not included in the dominant group.
3. In the resistance and separation stage, an individual with a nondominant identity may shift away from the conformity of the previous stage to engage in actions that challenge the dominant identity group.
- a. Individuals in this stage may also actively try to separate themselves from the dominant group, interacting only with those who share their nondominant identity.
 - b. Staying in this stage may indicate a lack of critical thinking if a person endorses the values of the nondominant group without question.
4. The integration stage marks a period where individuals with a nondominant identity have achieved a balance between embracing their own identities and valuing other dominant and nondominant identities.

D. Dominant Identity Development

1. The unexamined stage of dominant identity formation is similar to nondominant in that individuals in this stage do not think about their or others' identities.
 - a. Unlike people with a nondominant identity who usually have to acknowledge the positioning of their identity due to discrimination and prejudice they encounter, people with dominant identities may stay in the unexamined stage for a long time.
2. In the acceptance stage, a person with a dominant identity passively or actively accepts that some people are treated differently than others but doesn't do anything internally or externally to address it.
 - a. In the passive acceptance stage, we must be cautious not to blame individuals with dominant identities for internalizing racist, sexist, or heterosexist "norms."
 - b. Some may progress to an active state where they acknowledge inequality and are proud to be in the "superior" group.
- c. Many people never progress from this stage. If they do, it's usually because of repeated encounters with individuals or situations that challenge their acceptance of the status quo, such as befriending someone from a nondominant group or taking a course related to culture.
3. The resistance stage of dominant identity formation is a major change from the previous in that an individual acknowledges the unearned advantages they are given and feels guilt or shame about it.
 - a. While moving to this step is a marked improvement in regards to becoming a more aware and socially just person, getting stuck in the resistance stage isn't productive, because people are often retreating rather than trying to address injustice.
4. People in the redefinition stage revise negative views of their identity held in the previous stage and begin to acknowledge their privilege and try to use the power they are granted to work for social justice.
5. The final stage of dominant identity formation is integration. This stage is reached when redefinition is complete and people can integrate their dominant identity into all aspects of their life, finding opportunities to educate others about privilege while also being a responsive ally to people in nondominant identities.

E. Bi- or Multiracial Identity Development

1. Originally, people thought that bi-racial individuals followed the development model of minority individuals, but given that we now know that race and the meanings about race are socially constructed, it makes sense to realize that a person of mixed racial ancestry is likely to be viewed differently (from both the dominant culture and the individual's own culture) than a minority individual.
2. Stage 1: Personal Identity. Children are not aware of race as a value-based social category and derive their personal identity from individual personality features instead of cultural ones.
3. Stage 2: Group Categorization. In the move from stage one to two, the person goes from no racial or cultural awareness to having to choose between one or the other.

4. Stage 3: Enmeshment/Denial. Following the choice made in stage two, individuals attempt to immerse themselves in one culture while denying ties to the other.

a. This process may result in guilt or feelings of distance from the parent and family whose culture was rejected in stage two.

b. If these feelings are resolved then the child moves to the next stage. If not, they remain here.

5. Stage 4: Appreciation. When feelings of guilt and anger are resolved the person can work to appreciate all of the cultures that shape their identity.

a. While there is an attempt to learn about the diversity of their heritage, they will still identify primarily with the culture chosen in stage two.

6. Stage 5: Integration. In the fifth and final stage, the once fragmented parts of the person's identity are brought together to create a unique whole.

3. Difference Matters

A. Whenever we encounter someone, we notice similarities and differences.

1. We don't only see similarities and differences on an individual level. In fact, we also place people into in-groups and out-groups based on the similarities and differences we perceive.

2. In these situations, it is more likely that stereotypes and prejudice will influence our communication.

B. There is an ideology of domination that makes it seem natural and normal to many that some people or groups will always have power over others.

1. Individuals with dominant identities may not validate the experiences of those in nondominant groups because they do not experience the oppression directed at those with nondominant identity.

C. One of the first reasons difference matters is that people and groups are treated unequally, and better understanding of how those differences came to be can help us create a more just society.

3.2: Exploring Specific Cultural Identities

A. By looking at history, we can see how cultural identities that seem to have existed forever actually came to be constructed for various political and social reasons and how they have changed over time.

B. Social constructionism is a view that argues the self is formed through our interactions with others and in relation to social, cultural, and political contexts

1. Race is a socially constructed category based on differences in appearance that has been used to create hierarchies that privilege some and disadvantage others.

A. Race didn't become a socially and culturally recognized marker until European colonial expansion in the 1500s.

1. Racial distinctions have been based largely on phenotypes, or physiological features such as skin color, hair texture, and body/facial features.

2. Western "scientists" used these differences as "proof" that native populations were less evolved than the Europeans, which helped justify colonial expansion, enslavement, genocide, and exploitation on massive scales.

3. Racial classifications used by the government and our regular communication about race in the United States have changed frequently.

B. We should not assume, however, that someone identifies with his or her cultural lineage, as many people have more in common with their US American peers than a culture that may be one or more generations removed.

1. If you are unsure what to use, you could always observe how a person refers to himself or herself, or you could ask for his or her preference. In any case, a competent communicator defers to and respects the preference of the individual.

2. Ethnicity is a term that describes shared culture — the practices, values, and beliefs of a group.

A. Ethnicity, like race, continues to be an identification method that individuals and institutions use today — whether through the census, affirmative action initiatives, non-discrimination laws, or simply in personal day-to-day relations.

B. The label *Latin American* generally refers to people who live in Central American countries.

3. Gender is an identity based on internalized cultural notions of masculinity and femininity that is constructed through communication and interaction.

A. While it is true that there are biological differences between who we label male and female, the meaning our society places on those differences is what actually matters in our day-to-day lives.

1. The biological differences are interpreted differently around the world, which further shows that although we think gender is a natural, normal, stable way of classifying things, it is actually not.

B. Sex is based on biological characteristics, including external genitalia, internal sex organs, chromosomes, and hormones

1. While the biological characteristics between men and women are obviously different, it's the meaning that we create and attach to those characteristics that makes them significant.

C. Gender has been constructed over the past few centuries in political and deliberate ways that have tended to favor men in terms of power.

1. This system is based on the ideology of patriarchy, which is a system of social structures and practices that maintains the values, priorities, and interests of men as a group

2. Feminism as an intellectual and social movement advanced women's rights and our overall understanding of gender.

3. Transgender is an umbrella term for people whose gender identity and/or expression do not match the gender they were assigned by birth.

4. Sexuality is often something we view as personal and private but one only needs to observe popular culture and media for a short time to see that sexuality permeates much of our public discourse.

A. Sexuality is also biological in that it connects to physiological functions that carry significant social and political meaning like puberty, menstruation, and pregnancy.

B. Sexuality connects to public health issues like sexually transmitted infections (STIs), sexual assault, sexual abuse, sexual harassment, and teen pregnancy.

C. Sexuality is at the center of political issues like abortion, sex education, and gay and lesbian rights.

1. Sexual orientation refers to a person's primary physical and emotional sexual attraction and activity.

5. Ability

A. The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) defines an individual with a disability as "a person who has a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities, a person who has a history or record of such an impairment, or a person who is perceived by others as having such an impairment"

B. Ableism is the system of beliefs and practices that produces a physical and mental standard that is projected as normal for a human being and labels deviations from it abnormal, resulting in unequal treatment and access to resources.

1. During the early part of the 1900s, the eugenics movement was the epitome of the move to rehabilitate or reject people with disabilities

2. Much has changed for people with disabilities in the United States in the past fifty years. The independent living movement (ILM) was a part of the disability rights movement that took shape along with other social movements of the 1960s and 1970s.

C. Interability communication is communication between people with differing ability levels.

1. Since many people are unsure of how to communicate with a person with disabilities, the "Ten Commandments of Etiquette for Communicating with People with Disabilities" to help you in communicating with persons with disabilities.

3.3 Identity and Migration

1. Cross-cultural adaptation

A. Acculturation is the learning and adapting of at least some of the values, norms, and behaviors of the new culture.

1. Distinguish between psychological adjustment (emotional well-being) and sociocultural adaptation (the ability to function day-to-day in the target culture).

2. Assimilation is the loss of one's original cultural identity by acquiring a new identity in the host culture

3. Adapting to the host culture but maintaining the identity from one's native culture is integration.
 4. In separation the individual maintains his or her native identity with minimal adaptation to the host culture, although the individual may choose for practical reasons, such as employment, to adopt particular aspects of the host culture
 5. The fourth mode of acculturation is marginalization, in which individuals have a weak identification with both host and native cultures.
 6. An additional mode of acculturation was identified by Richard Mendoza (1989). He labeled this cultural transmutation, in which an individual chooses to identify predominately with a third cultural group, such as youth culture or gay/lesbian groups.
- B. The history of immigration in the United States is also tied to the way that race has been constructed.

2. Refugees

- A. In addition to those leaving their home country in order to better themselves and their families economically, many migrants leave in order to escape regional or national danger or deprivation.
- B. Relationships between refugees and permanent residents can present problems. Resentments are formed due to resources allocated to refugees, attributing crime to refugees, or blaming refugees for diseases or illnesses.

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3.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. Each individual has only one identity.
 - a. True
 - *b. False
2. This social identity is derived from a sense of shared history, traditions, values, similar behaviors, area of origin, and in some instances, language.
 - a. Regional
 - b. National
 - *c. Ethnic
 - d. Personal
3. An individual's gender identity is a direct result of their biological sex.
 - a. True
 - *b. False
4. Social identities based solely on physical appearance represent _____ identity.
 - a. Regional
 - b. Ethnic
 - c. Personal
 - *d. Racial
5. Which of the following is an example of a personal identity?
 - a. Irish American
 - *b. Singer
 - c. Book club member
 - d. Female
6. _____ identities are based on socially constructed categories that teach us a way of being and include expectations for social behavior or ways of acting.
 - a. Personal
 - b. Social
 - *c. Cultural
 - d. Avowed
7. Ascribed identities are personal, social, or cultural identities that are placed on us by others, while avowed identities are those that we claim for ourselves.
 - *a. True
 - b. False
8. This view argues that the self is formed through our interactions with others and in relation to social, cultural, and political contexts.
 - *a. Social constructionism
 - b. Ascribed identities

c. Redefinition

d. Interability communication

9. African American, Asian American, European American, Latinx, and Native America are all examples of ____ classifications in the US.

a. Ethnic

b. Gender

*c. Racial

d. Ability

10. ____ is an identity based on internalized cultural notions of masculinity and femininity that is constructed through communication and interaction.

a. Ethnicity

*b. Gender

c. Race

d. Ability

11. Patriarchy is a system of social structures and practices that maintains the values, priorities, and interests of men as a group

*a. True

b. False

12. When one's gender identity is not aligned with the expectations that society has of them based on their biological sex they are broadly referred to as:

a. Fluid

b. Binary

c. Cis

*d. Trans

13. A person's primary physical and emotional sexual attraction and activity is referred to as:

a. Sexuality

b. Gender

*c. Sexual orientation

d. Transgender

14. The system of beliefs and practices that produces a physical and mental standard that is projected as normal for a human being and labels deviations from it abnormal, resulting in unequal treatment and access to resources is know as:

a. Genderism

*b. Ableism

c. Racism

d. Disability

15. Leaning on or hanging on to a person's wheelchair is similar to leaning or hanging on to a person and is generally considered annoying. The chair is part of the personal body space of the person who uses it.

*a. True

b. False

16. This mode of acculturation includes the loss of one's original cultural identity by acquiring a new identity in the host culture. The goal is to become indistinguishable from other people in that culture.

- *a. Assimilation
- b. Integration
- c. Separation
- d. Marginalization

17. In addition to those leaving their home country in order to better themselves and their families economically, many migrants leave in order to escape regional or national danger or deprivation, becoming:

- a. Asylees
- *b. Refugees
- c. Expatriates
- d. Settlers

18. Sometimes individuals have a weak identification with both host and native cultures instead of choosing to identify with a third cultural group. Mendoza (1989) referred to this as:

- a. Marginalization
- b. Separation
- *c. Transmutation
- d. Adaptation

19. When filling out the US Census, individuals did not get to select a racial classification of their own until:

- a. 1830
- b. 1920
- *c. 1970
- d. 2000

20. Despite making up more of the workforce, women continue to face a significant pay gap in the workplace making roughly 70 cents to every dollar earned by men.

- *a. True
- b. False

Type E

Short Answer

1. Why does the melting pot metaphor fail to capture the history of immigration in the United States? Can you think of a more apt metaphor
2. Even though experts agree that race is social rather than biological, explain how it is still “real” (has meaning in our society and affects people).
3. What is the difference between gender and sexual orientation?

Essay

1. The United States has historically led the world in refugee resettlement numbers but admissions have recently fallen to record lows. In 2018 the United States fell behind Canada as the top resettlement country globally. And in fiscal year 2020, the United States resettled fewer than 12,000 refugees, a far cry from the 70,000 to 80,000 resettled annually just a few years earlier and the 207,000 welcomed in 1980, the year the formal U.S. resettlement program began ([Migration Policy Institute, 2021](#)). Should the US increase the number of refugee admissions? What potential problems might this increase cause and how could they be managed?

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: Verbal Processes in Intercultural Communication

[4.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[4.2: Outline](#)

[4.4: Test Bank](#)

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4.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

Language Shapes Thought

In section 4.1 (Language Shapes Our Thought) we are introduced to the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis which “postulates that your native language has a profound influence on how you see the world, that you perceive reality in the context of the language you have available to describe it.” At its extreme, this view leads to linguistic determinism which argues that speakers of different languages cannot share a worldview because we cannot conceive of that for which we lack vocabulary. Today we are more likely to encounter the concept of linguistic relativity, “meaning that language shapes our views of the world but is not an absolute determiner of how or what we think.”

To help students explore this concept further share one of these resources:

- The article, [Does Your Language Shape How You Think?](#), Guy Deutscher, New York Times Magazine, Aug. 26, 2010, which begins with a discussion of Sapir-Whorf and its influence on our understanding of language and communication. While the underlying assumptions of the theory have not held up the influence of our language on how we perceive reality is unquestionable. The article goes on to provide several examples to illustrate this connection.
- Or, this TED Talk from Lera Boroditsky, [How Language Shapes the Way We Think](#). There are about 7,000 languages spoken around the world -- and they all have different sounds, vocabularies, and structures. But do they shape the way we think? Cognitive scientist Lera Boroditsky shares examples of language -- from an Aboriginal community in Australia that uses cardinal directions instead of left and right to the multiple words for blue in Russian -- that suggest the answer is a resounding yes. "The beauty of linguistic diversity is that it reveals to us just how ingenious and how flexible the human mind is," Boroditsky says. "Human minds have invented not one cognitive universe, but 7,000."

Investigation:

1. Do you think there is sufficient evidence to disprove the linguistic determinism worldview?
2. What examples help illustrate why modern communication study has embraced linguistic relativity?
3. How does one's language shape their perceptions of the world? Can you think of examples beyond the reading/video?
4. What relationship is there between linguistic determinism and bi-multilingualism? How does speaking multiple languages influence meaning making?
5. How can we “see” things that we lack the language for?
6. If one culture couldn't discover algebra because of the lack of number words in their language what might our language miss and what we have yet to discover as a result?

Cultural Communication Variation

Section 4.1 (The Study of Language) explores the study of communication, including linguistics. “Linguistics deals with the study of particular languages and the search for general properties common to all languages. It also includes explorations into language variations (i.e. dialects), how languages change over time, how language is stored and processed in the brain, and how children learn language.” This activity has students focus on specific aspects of verbal communication to identify cultural variations.

There are a number of cultural variations in how we use language:

- A. words, syntax, meaning
- B. tone, volume, rate
- C. direct/indirect, turn-taking, interruption
- D. content
- E. use of silence

Student Activity: You can have students self-select or you can assign them one group for the discussion. Describe some of the different variables and distinctions within these aspects of languages, thinking about examples from your own cultural experiences. Some additional guiding questions:

- Group A: Brainstorm some examples of words that have different meanings in different cultures. How do contextual clues influence meaning?

- Group B: How do the nonverbal aspects of language influence communication? How do they vary across cultures? Do these variations influence meaning?
- Group C: What does it mean that one way of talking is more direct than another? What are different ways people can interrupt one another and take control of the conversation?
- Group D: Brainstorm a few examples of what is acceptable/unacceptable content to discuss in different cultures. Are some topics acceptable for only some groups to talk about?
- Group E: How is silence viewed in different cultures? Can silence be used intentionally to communicate? Are there times when silence is perceived differently?

Investigation:

1. Have students share their answers to the questions posed.
 - a. Section 4.1 (Language Is Arbitrary and Symbolic) explores the difference between connotative and denotative meanings. How does this variation in meaning influence what we think words mean and how that varies across cultures? Section 4.3 (Communication Styles) looks at the difference between high and low context cultures. How might this influence the role that contextual cues play in our interpretation of meaning?
 - b. Nonverbal is covered explicitly in chapter 5 so this discussion gives you a chance to preview what is to come. Particular emphasis should be placed on vocalics (section 5.2: Vocalics) or paralanguage, the nonverbal aspects of speech that influence meaning, including rate, pitch, tone, volume, intensity, etc.
 - c. Section 4.3 (Communication Styles) covers the variations one might see in how direct or indirect one might be when communicating. “Direct speech is very explicit while indirect speech is more obscure.” How might these different styles be perceived in various contexts? If the norm is for one style and the other is employed how might others react?
 - d. Section 4.1 (Language Shapes Our Thoughts) discusses how language shapes our thought. This discussion includes jargon, argot and other differences in available words to describe everyday phenomena.
 - e. Attitudes toward silence are the focus of discussion at the end of section 4.3 (Attitudes Towards Speaking, Silence, and Writing). Silence is also discussed in Chapter 5 (sections 5.2 and 5.3). The absence of language use is nonverbal but there is a lot of overlap in our understanding of the phenomenon as it is used in verbal communication exchanges.

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Jargon

Section 4.1 (Language Shapes Our Thought) argues that “sometimes, a special language is developed by a group, sometimes labeled a jargon, which often references a specialized technical language.” Students use a lot of jargon without realizing that they are doing so, this discussion focuses their attention on the specific jargon that they use in specific cultural contexts.

Student Activity: Have students choose a culture that they are a member of and then share some jargon from that culture that those outside the culture would not be familiar with. Then have classmates guess what that jargon means.

Investigation:

1. What cues did you use in guessing the meaning? Are you also a member of (or familiar with) this particular culture?
2. Does this same jargon have a different meaning in different cultural settings?
3. When you are unfamiliar with jargon how can you go about decoding the meaning?
4. Why do cultures develop jargon?
5. This discussion can also help illuminate the role of code-switching in our lives. Section 4.3 (Variations in Context Rules of Communication Styles) defines code-switching as the “practice of shifting the language that you use to better express yourself in conversations. This can include, but is not limited to, language, accent, dialect, and vocalics or paralanguage.”
 - a. Would you use this jargon in other aspects of your life or is it specific to this cultural context?
 - b. Besides vocabulary, what other aspects of code-switching are at play as you move between different cultural settings?

Discussion

1. Section 4.2 (Bilingualism and Multilingualism) focuses on Moving Between Languages, and specifically bilingualism and multilingualism. In most parts of the world today, most individuals have at least some capability in a second language: “The majority of the world's population uses more than one language on a regular basis and monolingualism is by and large a historical and Anglophone anomaly.” Why do some geographical areas see more bi or multilingualism than others? In the US

only about 20-25% of the population speak a second language, why do you think our rate is so low? [Half of the world is bilingual. What's our problem?](#), Jay Mathews, The Washington Post, April 25, 2019. Do you think being bilingual is valued in the US? Why or why not? Do you think we should be working to increase access to improved language acquisition in the US? How should we do so, think about the Critical Period Hypothesis ([Creating Bilingual Minds](#), Naja Ferjan Ramirez, TED Talk) and theories on Second Language Acquisition discussed in section 4.2.

2. "Words, by themselves, do not have any inherent meaning. Humans give meaning to them, and their meanings change across time. For example, there is no inherent, logical connection between "cat" or (or the German Katze or Chinese猫) and the feline animal. We negotiate the meaning of the word "kat," and define it, through visual images or dialog, in order to communicate with our audience" (section 4.1: Language Is Arbitrary and Symbolic). If words are arbitrary and lack inherent meaning how then do we use them to communicate? Share the Radiolab video [Words](#). After students watch the video, have them discuss what words they remember from the video. What specific meanings do they recall? How do they "know" that is what the word means? Are some of the meanings easier to decode? Why?

Supplemental Resources

[Does Time Work Differently In Different Languages?](#), NatvLang, July 7, 2017

Whorf ignited a controversy when he claimed the Hopi don't speak or think about time the way Europeans do. Malotki wrote 600 pages to prove him wrong. Come explore Sapir-Whorf and Hopi Time! Do speakers of different languages have different concepts of time?

[How to Save A Language From Extinction](#), Daniel Bögre Udell, TED Talk, May 2019.

As many as 3,000 languages could disappear within the next 80 years, all but silencing entire cultures. In this quick talk, language activist Daniel Bögre Udell shows how people around the world are finding new ways to revive ancestral languages and rebuild their traditions -- and encourages us all to investigate the tongues of our ancestors. "Reclaiming your language and embracing your culture is a powerful way to be yourself," he says.

[Arrival](#) is a 2016 American science fiction drama film directed by Denis Villeneuve and adapted by Eric Heisserer, who conceived the project as a spec script based on the 1998 short story "Story of Your Life" by Ted Chiang. The film stars Amy Adams as Louise Banks, a linguist enlisted by the United States Army to discover how to communicate with extraterrestrial aliens who have arrived on Earth, before tensions lead to war.

Discussion Questions:

1. What is the difference between communication and language? How does the movie argue that communication is difficult?
2. Do you need shared experience in order to communicate?
3. Do the humans and aliens communicate verbally or nonverbally?
4. What are three questions about language and/or communication that the movie raises for you?

Joy Luck Club - Meet the Parents

The scene from [The Joy Luck Club](#) depicts Waverly (Chinese-American) introducing her boyfriend (American) to her parents. Using what you have learned about High v. Low Context and Direct v. Indirect Cultures explain what happens in this interaction and why it goes so poorly.

[Why Isn't The Sky Blue?](#), Tim Howard, Radiolab from WNYC, May 12, 2012.

What is the color of honey, and "faces pale with fear"? If you're Homer--one of the most influential poets in human history--that color is green. And the sea is "wine-dark," just like oxen...though sheep are violet. Which all sounds...well, really off. Producer Tim Howard introduces us to linguist Guy Deutscher, and the story of William Gladstone (a British Prime Minister back in the 1800s, and a huge Homer-ophile). Gladstone conducted an exhaustive study of every color reference in The Odyssey and The Iliad. And he found something startling: No blue! Tim pays a visit to the New York Public Library, where a book of German philosophy from the late 19th Century helps reveal a pattern: across all cultures, words for colors appear in stages. And blue always comes last. Jules Davidoff, professor of neuropsychology at the University of London, helps us make sense of the way different people see different colors in the same place.

[Are We Unique? Toddlers Outsmart Chimps in Some Tasks, Not All](#), Patti Neighmond, NPR Morning Edition, September 7, 2007.

Is human communication unique? This radio story explores the ways in which other animals, specifically chimps and apes communicate and whether it is distinct from human communication.

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4.2: Outline

4.1: Language and Culture

A. We use language as a system to create and exchange meaning with one another, and the types of words we use influence both our perceptions and others interpretation of our meanings.

B. Language is one of the more conspicuous expressions of culture.

1. The Study of Language

A. Linguistics is the study of language and its structure. Linguistics deals with the study of particular languages and the search for general properties common to all languages.

B. Areas of research for linguists include:

1. Phonetics: the study of the production, acoustics, and hearing speech sounds.

2. Phonology: the patterning of sounds.

3. Morphology: the patterning of words.

4. Syntax: the structure of sentences.

5. Semantics: meaning.

6. Pragmatics: language in context.

2. World Languages

A. Languages evolve over time.

B. Language families group languages together, according to similarities in vocabulary, grammar, and pronunciation.

1. Languages within a same family derive from a common ancestor, called a proto-language.

2. Membership in a given family is determined through comparative linguistics

3. There are languages which do not belong to families, known as language isolates

C. A dialect refers to a variety of a language that is used by particular group of speakers, defined normally regionally, but could be related to social class or ethnicity as well.

3. Language Is Arbitrary and Symbolic

A. Words, by themselves, do not have any inherent meaning. Humans give meaning to them, and their meanings change across time.

B. Words have two types of meanings:

1. The denotative meaning is the common meaning, often found in the dictionary.

2. The connotative meaning is often not found in the dictionary but in the community of users itself.

4. Language Evolves

A. As time passes and technology changes, people add new words to their language, repurpose old ones, and discard archaic ones.

5. Language Shapes Our Thought

A. The link between language and culture and the idea that language shapes how we think about our world

1. The Sapir-Whorf hypothesis postulates that your native language has a profound influence on how you see the world, that you perceive reality in the context of the language you have available to describe it.

B. More widely accepted today is the concept of linguistic relativity, meaning that language shapes our views of the world but is not an absolute determiner of how or what we think.

C. Learning a second language leads one early on to appreciate the fact that there may not be a one-to-one correspondence between words in one language and those in another.

1. While the dictionary definitions (denotation) may be the same, the actual usage in any given context (connotation) may be quite different.
2. Jargon, which often references a specialized technical language.
3. A related term is an argot, a kind of secret language designed to exclude outsiders, such as the language used by criminal gangs.

4.2: Moving Between Languages

1. Bilingualism and Multilingualism

A. Individuals are much more likely than in the past to be exposed, in person or online, to speakers of other languages.

B. Bilingualism

1. Studies have shown that not only do bilinguals have the advantage of likely fluency in two languages but that the process of growing up bilingual also has a positive effect on brain development.
2. Bilinguals may differ in their level of proficiency in the languages they speak.
3. Normally a bilingual will have one dominant language

C. Monolingualism is by and large a historical and Anglophone anomaly

2. Learning a Second Language

A. Many monolinguals are likely to assume that the difference between languages is largely semantic, that is to say, that moving from one language to another is simply a matter of substituting words.

1. How sentences are put together can vary significantly by language. Learning German, for example, will expose learners to syntax (word order) that is quite different from the way sentences are put together in many languages.
2. The degree of difficulty in learning a second language can vary depending on a number of factors, such as motivation, time commitment, and innate ability to learn.

B. Most current theories of Second Language Acquisition (SLA) advocate a sociocognitive approach, combining learning of vocabulary and grammar through drills and repetition and culturally strategic knowledge and strategic competence, i.e., what's appropriate to say in a given context.

C. Polyglots, speakers of multiple languages, are motivated to learn as many languages as possible.

3. Language Learning and Technology

A. Language learners may be using online resources in conjunction with instructed language learning in a formal school setting, or they may be independently learning or maintaining a second language.

1. There are commercial online language learning services online such as DuoLingo or Mango Languages.
 2. A free alternative is to connect online with other language learners through a site such as the Mixxer.
 3. Tandem learning, in which two learners of each other's language serve as conversation partners and native informants, is also popular.
- B. Informal language learning through the Internet has become increasingly popular, as it offers just-in-time learning, anytime access, and low cost.

1. For tourists, there are phrasebooks, virtual guided tours, and other language and cultural resources in electronic form.
2. Among the self-directed language learning software packages, one of the better-known products is Rosetta Stone. It features a sequenced presentation of the target language, initially in phrases and short sentences, and then moving on gradually to larger language chunks.

4. English as a World Language

A. Often there is a close and natural connection between the language one learns and the culture represented by that language. In fact, interest in the target culture may be the starting point for learning a new language.

B. It is estimated that there are today a larger number of people worldwide who speak English as a second language than as a native language.

1. English is seen in many countries as an essential tool for social and economic advancement.
 2. English is sometimes seen an instrument of cultural imperialism, given the history of colonization, evangelization, and spread of US consumer/popular culture from the Anglophone world.
 3. The different social significance of speaking English across cultures points to the inherent cultural forces language embodies beyond serving as a means of communication.
 4. Language choice can be a way to position oneself socially. In many cultures, English may be an important component of individual identity and agency.
- C. The interest in English has resulted in a boom in English classes in many countries.
1. There has been a shift in how English is taught as a second language. It is no longer the case that learning English is tied necessarily to learning as well about the culture of Great Britain or the USA.
 2. There is a lot of interest in "English for Special Purposes," English classes tailored to those with particular professional needs, such as business, tourism, or a highly technical field. This may lead to limited proficiency in English within a narrow semantic field.
- D. In the early days of the Internet there was concern that English would crowd out all other languages. That has not, however, been the case. Statistics show much faster Internet growth in countries where English is not the dominant language.

5. Endangered Languages

- A. There are approximately 6500 languages spoken in the world today, but about 2000 of those languages have fewer than 1000 speakers.
1. It is estimated that at least half of the world's languages are endangered and will become extinct within the next century.
 2. Particularly with indigenous languages in the Americas and Asia. Of the 165 indigenous languages still spoken in North America, only 8 are spoken by as many as 10,000 people. About 75 are spoken by only a handful of older people.
- B. Given the close connection we have discussed here between language and culture, losing language communities also means a loss of human cultural capital, which is irreplaceable.
1. In an effort to preserve endangered languages, field linguists attempt to capture recordings from the remaining speakers of these languages.
 2. For the majority of the world languages which do not have a written language, losing the last remaining speakers can mean the disappearance of the spoken stories and traditions.

6. Translation & Interpretation

- A. Both enable communication across language boundaries from *source* to *target*. Both need deep cultural and linguistic understanding along with expert knowledge of the subject area and the ability to communicate clearly.
- B. Translation generally involves the process of producing a written text that refers to something written in another language.
1. Traditionally, the *translator* would read the *source* in its original language, decipher its meaning, then write, rewrite, and proofread the content in the *target* language to ensure the original meaning, style, and content are preserved.
 2. Translators are often experts in their fields of knowledge as well as linguists fluent in two or more languages with excellent written communication skills.
- C. Interpretation is the process of orally expressing what is said or written in another language.
1. *Interpreters* need to transpose the *source* language within the given context, preserving its original meaning, but rephrasing idioms, colloquialisms, and other culturally-specific references in ways that the *target* audience can understand.
 2. Interpreters are also often experts in fields of knowledge, cultures, and languages with excellent memories.

4.3 Variations in Communication Styles

1. Communication Styles

- A. Language is not culture free. How language is used in a particular culture is strongly related to the values a culture emphasizes, and how it believes that the relations between humans ought to be.

B. High and Low Context

1. In high context communication:

- a. The meaning is in the people, or more specifically, the relationship between the people as opposed to just the words.
- b. Body language is as important and sometimes more important than the actual words spoken.
- c. People tend to be more indirect and expect the person they are communicating with to "read between the lines" to decode the implicit part of their message.

2. High context cultures are very often collectivistic as well.

3. In low context communication:

- a. Little (or "low") context is needed for comprehension because the essence of the communication is conveyed by the words used and little information is conveyed by nonverbal means.

- b. The speaker is expected to be responsible for constructing a clear message that the listener can decode easily.

4. Low context cultures are individualist so people openly express their views.

5. Communication between people from high-context and low-context cultures can be confusing.

C. Direct/Indirect

1. The direct/indirect continuum has to do with the explicitness of one's talk, or how much of their thoughts are communicated directly through words and how much is hinted at.

2. Direct speech is very explicit while indirect speech is more obscure.

3. Direct styles:

- a. Those in which verbal messages reveal the speaker's true intentions, needs, wants, and desires.

- b. The focus is on accomplishing a task.

- c. The message is clear, and to the point without hidden intentions or implied meanings.

- d. The communication tends to be impersonal.

- e. Conflict is discussed openly and people say what they think.

4. Indirect styles:

- a. Those in which communication is often designed to hide or minimize the speaker's true intentions, needs, wants, and desires.

- b. Communication tends to be personal and focuses on the relationship between the speakers.

- c. The language may be subtle, and the speaker may be looking for a "softer" way to communicate there is a problem by providing many contextual cues.

- d. A hidden meaning may be embedded into the message because harmony and "saving face" are more important than truth and confrontation.

D. Elaborate/Understated

1. The quantity of talk that a culture values.

2. The elaborate style:

- a. Uses more words, phrases, or metaphors to express an idea than the understated style.

- b. Includes the use of rich and expressive language in everyday conversation.

- c. May be described as descriptive, poetic, or too wordy depending on your view.

3. The understated style:

- a. Values simplicity and silence. People who speak sparingly tend to be trusted more than people who speak a lot.

- b. Rewards prudent word choice that allows an individual to be socially discreet, gain social acceptance, and avoid social penalty.

E. Personal/Contextual

1. The contextual style is one where there are structural linguistic devices used to mark the relationship between the speaker and the listener.
2. The English language has no such linguistic distinctions; it is an example of the personal style that enhances the sense of “I.”

F. Instrumental/Affective

1. Refers to who holds the responsibility for effectively conveying a message: the speaker or the audience?
2. The instrumental style is goal- or sender-orientated, meaning it is the burden of the speaker to make themselves understood.
3. The affective style is more receiver-orientated thus, places more responsibility on the listener.

2. Variations in Context Rules of Communication Styles

A. While there are differences in the preferred communication styles used by various cultures, no particular [REDACTED] will use the same communication style all the time.

B. Code-switching is when a person either emphasizes or minimizes the differences between himself/herself and the other person in conversation.

1. The practice of shifting the language that you use to better express yourself in conversations.
2. People, consciously and unconsciously, code-switch to better reflect the speech of those around them.

C. Interracial Communication

1. Racist patterns and practices go through societal institutions, which means that racism exists and doesn't have to be committed by any one person.

2. As competent communicators and critical thinkers, we must challenge ourselves to be aware of how racism influences our communication at individual and societal levels.

a. Dominant groups tend to define what is correct or incorrect usage of a language, and since language is so closely tied to identity, labeling a group's use of a language as incorrect or deviant challenges or negates part of their identity.

b. The US Constitution does not stipulate a national language, and Congress has not designated one either.

3. Some people of color may engage in code-switching when communicating with dominant group members because adopting the language practices of the dominant group may minimize perceived differences.

3. Attitudes Towards Speaking, Silence, and Writing

A. In some cultures, such as the United States, speech is highly valued, and it is important to be articulate and well-spoken in personal as well as public settings.

1. Such countries tend to take silence as a sign of indifference, indignation, objection, and even hostility.

B. In listening cultures, silence is a way to keep exchanges calm and orderly. In collectivistic cultures, it is polite to remain silent when your opinion does not agree with that of the group.

C. The act of writing also varies widely in value

1. In the United States, written contracts are considered more powerful and binding than oral consent.

2. Other cultures tend to value oral communication over written communication or even a handshake over words.

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4.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. Language is one of the more conspicuous expressions of culture.
*a. True
b. False
2. The study of language and its structure is:
*a. Linguistics
b. Denotation
c. Determinism
d. Jargon
3. Which area of linguistics includes the study of language in context?
a. Phonetics
b. Syntax
c. Semantics
*d. Pragmatics
4. This aspect of linguistics focuses on the structure of sentences.
a. Phonology
b. Morphology
*c. Syntax
d. Pragmatics
5. All languages have a written form.
a. True
*b. False
6. A variety of a language that is used by a particular group of speakers, defined normally regionally, but could be related to social class or ethnicity, is known as:
a. Lingua franca
*b. Dialect
c. Pragmatics
d. Proto-language
7. Languages within the same family derive from a common ancestor, called a:
a. Lingua franca
b. Dialect
c. Pragmatics
*d. Proto-language
8. The _____ meaning of “home” is a place of security, comfort, and family.
*a. Connotative
b. Denotative
c. Argot

d. Performative

9. The denotative meaning is the common meaning, often found in the dictionary.

*a. True

b. False

10. AWOL is short for "absent without leave." AWOL is military ____ used to describe a person whose whereabouts are unknown.

a. Dialect

*b. Jargon

c. Argot

d. Denotation

11. ____ are speakers of multiple languages and are motivated to learn as many languages as possible.

*a. Polyglots

b. Bilinguals

c. Multilinguals

d. Monolinguals

12. Less verbally explicit communication and less written/formal information are characteristics of ____ cultures.

*a. High context

b. Low context

c. Elaborate

d. Understated

13. "Say what you mean" and "Don't beat around the bush" are mottos from ____ cultures.

a. Instrumental

b. Affective

c. High context

*d. Low context

14. In direct cultures, such as those in Latin America, business conversations may start with discussions of the weather, or family, or topics other than business as the partners gain a sense of each other, long before the topic of business is raised.

a. True

*b. False

15. This style is more receiver oriented thus placing more responsibility on the listener.

a. Instrumental

*b. Affective

c. Elaborate

d. Understated

16. English is the official language of the United States.

a. True

*b. False

17. If I say, "Close the window" my meaning is quite clear. However, if I were to ask, "Is anyone else cold in here?" the message is more ambiguous demonstrating what variation in communication style?

*a. Direct-Indirect

- b. Elaborate-Understated
- c. Personal-Contextual
- d. Instrumental-Affective

18. Adopting the language of dominant group members while maintaining a unique linguistic identity is referred to as:

- a. Standard English
- b. Language adaptation
- c. Linguistic mixing
- *d. Code-switching

19. _____ claims that there is an ideal time window for acquiring language, namely as children or adolescents.

- *a. Critical Period Hypothesis
- b. Bilingual Adaptation Theory
- c. Monolingual Hypothesis
- d. Linguistic Acquisition Theory

20. Of the more than 6000 languages currently spoken in the world today how many of them are threatened (less than 1000 current speakers)?

- a. 4000
- b. 3000
- *c. 2000
- d. 1000

Type E

Short-Answer

1. Explain the difference between linguistic determinism and linguistic relativity.
2. How does second (or multi) language acquisition change one's perception of language and culture?
3. What does silence communicate in the U.S.? How might these meanings differ in other cultures? Make sure to provide specific examples in your response.

Essay

1. How has the prominence of English as a global language shifted? What does this mean for how and where English is taught? What implications does this have on native English speakers?

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

5: Nonverbal Processes in Intercultural Communication

[5.1: Outline](#)

[5.3: Resources](#)

[5.4: Test Bank](#)

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5.1: Outline

5.1: Principles of Nonverbal Communication

1. Principles of Nonverbal Communication

A. Nonverbal communication is communication through means other than language.

1. Includes aspects of communication, such as gestures and facial expressions that do not involve verbal communication.

2. Also includes nonverbal aspects of speech itself such as accent, tone of voice, and speed of speaking.

B. The relative importance of nonverbal codes varies with context and culture, but nonverbal communication can contribute to well-over half of the emotional or relational meaning of any given message.

C. Nonverbal communication is crucial to the study of intercultural communication as nonverbal elements can take many different forms and can vary significantly in their manifestations and usage across cultures.

2. Nonverbal Communication Uses Multiple Channels.

A. When I talk to a friend, I listen to my friend's tone of voice, I watch my friend's facial expressions, use of eye contact, and gestures, and possibly touch them (multiple channels) all while trying to make sense of the words (one channel).

B. Nonverbal signals also come through the presence (or absence) of personal objects or artifacts.

3. Nonverbal Communication is More Ambiguous

A. Nonverbal communication and its meanings are primarily learned unconsciously.

B. Meaning is even harder to discern, there is no foolproof "dictionary" of how to interpret nonverbal messages.

4. Nonverbal Communication Has Fewer Rules

A. One reason that nonverbal communication is more ambiguous than verbal communication is that it is governed by fewer rules—and most of those will be informal norms.

B. There is not a universal code used that could be considered as a "language of the body" with conventionalized meanings that equate to the components that constitute spoken language

5. Nonverbal Messages Communication Emotions and Meanings

A. Nonverbal communication include both intentional and unintentional messages.

B. Our reliance on nonverbal communication becomes even more intense when people display mixed messages or verbal and nonverbal behaviors that convey contradictory meanings.

C. We almost always trust the nonverbal message over the verbal one because it is seen as more honest and revealing.

D. Nonverbal behavior also communicates status and power.

6. Nonverbal Communication is Influenced by Culture

A. It takes most people many years of immersion within a culture before they can fully understand the subtle meanings encompassed within that culture's nonverbal communication.

7. Nonverbal and Verbal Communication Work Together to Create Communication

A. As communicators, we do not experience or express them separately, but rather jointly to create meaning. We need *both* to communicate competently.

5.2: Types of Nonverbal Communication

1. Types of Nonverbal Behaviors

A. Every culture interprets posture, gestures, eye contact, facial expressions, vocal noises, use of space, degree of territory, and time differently.

B. Scholars call the different means used for transmitting information nonverbal communication codes.

2. Kinesics: means “movement,” and refers to the study of hand, arm, body, and face movements. It is thought by some to be the richest nonverbal code in terms of its power to communicate meaning

A. Gestures

1. One of the most common forms of gestures involve greetings and departures, which have rituals that are largely nonverbal, such as shaking hands or waving.
2. One of the richest arrays of gestures are for communicating insults and obscenities.
3. Beckoning gestures have traditionally been culture-specific. However, the forces of globalization and technology have exposed people worldwide to gestures used in popular media.

B. Facial Expressions

1. Facial expressions communicate an endless stream of emotions, and we make judgments about what others are feeling by assessing their faces.
2. What causes particular emotions and determines their intensity can be quite different personally and culturally.
 - a. Ekman and Friesen (1969) coined the term cultural display rules to describe such cultural differences in facial expressions.
 - b. Codes of general conduct, politeness, or social harmony may influence the public display of emotions.

C. Eye Contact

1. Eye contact, or *Oculistics*, serves many purposes. We use our eyes to express emotions, regulate a conversation, indicate listening behavior, show interest in others, respect, status, hostility, and aggression

D. Posture

1. Humans can stand up straight or slouch, lean forward or backward, round or slump our shoulders, and tilt our heads.
2. Posture communicates immediacy, the degree to which you find someone interesting and attractive, and power, the ability to influence people or events.

3. Vocalics

A. Vocalics, also called paralanguage, involves verbal and nonverbal aspects of speech that influence meaning, including rate, pitch, tone, volume, intensity, pausing, and even silence.

B. One of the roles vocalizations play is to function as a backchannel or filler in conversations, a way for a listener to send messages to the speaker

C. How conversations flow varies with culture and context. In situations in which a strict hierarchy is present or when the interaction is highly formal, there may be fixed patterns for managing a conversation and signaling when it is over.

4. Proxemics

A. Coming from the Latin *proximus*, meaning “near,” proxemics refers to communication through the use of physical distance or space.

B. Edward Hall (1966) pioneered the study of proxemics developing a four-level classification of social distance.

1. Intimate space, reserved for highly personal relationships, is 9 to 18 inches (23 to 45 cm).
2. Personal distance (“arm’s length”) is 1.5 to 4 feet (.5 to 1.2 m), the normal spacing for conversations.
3. Social distance he established at between 4 and 12 feet (1.2 to 3.6 m), the spacing normal in casual gathering and work environments.
4. Public distance he defined as being 12 feet (3.6 m) or longer, used for public speaking or large gatherings.

5. Haptics

A. Touch in communication interaction is called haptics.

B. Touch conventions vary significantly across cultures and are dependent as well on age, gender, and relationship.

C. Hall (1963) suggests that the use of proxemics and haptics merge within a culture to create what researchers now call contact and noncontact cultures.

1. In contact cultures, people stand closer together while talking, touch more frequently, and speak in louder voices.

2. In noncontact cultures, people stand farther apart while talking and touchless.

6. Physical Appearance and Artifacts

A. How you look conveys as much about you as what you say. Physical appearance includes attributes such as hair, clothing, body type, and personal grooming.

B. Across cultures, people credit individuals they find physically attractive with higher levels of intelligence, persuasiveness, poise, sociability, warmth, power, and employment success than they credit to unattractive individuals.

1. This tendency to make a blanket judgment of a person based on one trait the halo (positive) or horns (negative) effect.

C. Artifacts are the things we possess that influence how we see ourselves and that we use to express our identity to others.

D. Forms of dress serve as identity markers.

1. Many cultures have rules and conventions for dress and appearance, established through custom or religious beliefs.

2. Appearance messages are generally the first nonverbal codes we process, sizing up the other person based on skin color, appearance, and clothing.

3. Humans naturally tend to categorize, and that process includes grouping together other humans. We likely do that without being aware of this process of implicit bias.

7. Olfactics

A. The study of smell in humans.

B. Odor is used to categorize people according to status, power, or social class.

8. Music: Another Way to Communicate Nonverbally

A. Music is a "universal language" in that it is understood without the need for language.

B. Music plays many different roles in human society – entertaining, comforting, inspiring, socializing, and more.

C. Ethnomusicology is the study of music in cultural context.

1. It involves learning about and documenting the music, language, and cultural practices of underrepresented ethnic groups.

2. Globalization has resulted in the development of many hybridized musical forms.

3. Today, musical genres easily cross political and linguistic boundaries.

5.3: Time and Space

1. Chronemics

A. Time orientation, known as Chronemics, is the study of how we refer to and perceive time.

1. In monochronic time orientation, time is a commodity. Being punctual, completing tasks, and keeping schedules is valued, and may be more important than building or maintaining personal relationships.

2. In polychronic time orientation, however, schedules are less important, and punctuality is not considered an essential virtue.

B. Different perceptions of time can vary dramatically when it comes to arranging meetings.

2. Cultural Spaces

A. The *environment* involves the physical aspects of our surroundings.

B. The Impact of the Environment on Conversations

1. The nature of conversations is determined by the conversation partner, the purpose of the encounter, and the context in which it occurs.

2. Quiet, isolated environments are likely to lead to different conversation dynamics than a crowded, noisy environment.

- a. Information rate is the amount of information contained or perceived per a certain unit of time; the more information available to process, the greater the information rate.
 - b. An environment with a high information rate is said to have a high load. Examples would be a busy airport or a popular restaurant at lunchtime.
 - c. Environments with a low load might be a library reading room or a Japanese garden.
3. Some cultures purposely create spaces with low information loads for particular purposes or cultural practices.

C. Built Environments and Communication Patterns

1. The design of built environments, such as private homes or office buildings also has a significant effect on communication.

- a. Semi-fixed featured space allows rooms to have permeable divisions and perform multiple functions.
- b. Fixed-featured space in which room divisions are permanent.
- c. Informal space has no permanent divisions or walls.

3. Privacy Across Cultures

- A. The degree to which people seek and value solitude vary across cultures, as does the means and mechanisms for being alone.

- 1. Solitude, in which one is free from observation by others.
- 2. Intimacy, or shared privacy.
- 3. Anonymity, going unnoticed by others, especially in a crowd.
- 4. Reserve, in which one uses psychological means to create imagined isolation.

- B. Notions of privacy are related to the sense of private ownership, which can also differ markedly across cultures.

- 1. In the US, with a strong tradition of individualism and private ownership rights, mainstream cultural norms include sharp divisions between one's own possessions and those of others.
- 2. In other cultures, there are traditions of sharing and communal ownership.

- C. There is clearly a connection between the spaces humans inhabit and the cultural practices which take place there.

- D. Martin and Nakayama (2010) discuss the concept of "postmodern cultural spaces" in which city neighborhoods and boundaries in many places are becoming more flexible and fluid.

4. Car and Driving Behavior in a Cultural Context

- A. When we talk about human living spaces today, one of those difficult to ignore is the automobile.
- B. Anyone who has done much traveling outside one's home country has likely been struck by the difference in car cultures, driving behaviors, and traffic patterns.
- C. It's not just how we drive that may be different, but as well what it is we use our cars for.

5.4: Nonverbal Communication Challenges

1. Nonverbal Expectancy Violation Theory

- A. As in other areas tied to cultural values and behaviors, people develop an expectation of conformity with the conventions of the culture, in this case with the unwritten rules of nonverbal behavior.

- B. According to this theory, people have expectations about the appropriateness of nonverbal behavior, which is learned and culturally driven.

- C. When these expectations are violated, it produces a reaction called "arousal."

- 1. Our reaction depends on the severity of the violation, the nature of the person (such as attractiveness), and the implicit message associated with the violation.

- 2. The context and the person will determine our reaction.

- D. In general, it is good practice to anticipate nonverbal expectations to the degree possible. Even if we don't know the specifics of expectations in a given culture, we can certainly observe and learn.

2. Suggestions for Communicating Nonverbally Across Cultures

- A. Be cautious in making assumptions based on nonverbal actions. The same gestures may have quite different meanings in different cultures.
- B. Try to understand the cultural values attached to nonverbal conventions.
- C. Watch and imitate as appropriate.

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5.3: Resources

Activities

Distance Violations

Chapter 5, section 2 covers Types of Nonverbal Behaviors including Proxemics, communication through the use of physical distance or space, and like most communication, it varies from culture to culture.

Hall (1966) developed a four-level classification of social distance. For the US, he defined intimate space, reserved for highly personal relationships, as 9 to 18 inches (23 to 45 cm), and personal distance ("arm's length") at 1.5 to 4 feet (.5 to 1.2 m), the normal spacing for conversations. Social distance he established at between 4 and 12 feet (1.2 to 3.6 m), the spacing normal in casual gathering and work environments. Public distance he defined as being 12 feet (3.6 m) or longer, used for public speaking or large gatherings. Researchers have identified particular cultures as having a preference for closer proximity and a high degree of physical contact (Aiello, 1987).

Student Activity: To begin, ask students to think about their own use of proxemics. When you get in line how close do you stand to the person in front of you? How uncomfortable do you get if the person behind you stands too close? How comfortable would you be in a very crowded environment (e.g. train, festival, etc.)? With this in mind, send students to observe the use of space in various environments on campus. If you are doing this activity online you can give students a designated location, or you can let them choose on their own. You could also assign the task as homework and have them go to a variety of different environments to explore the differences.

Investigation:

1. What were your initial expectations about space in this particular environment?
2. What did you observe about the use of space?
3. Did you see anything that violated your expectations? How/why?
4. What happened when someone violated norms? Do you think it matters who is violating the norms (i.e. children, those who others might find physically attractive, etc.)?
5. Are there certain norms that seem more rigid than others? Why?

*In another variation you could have students set out to violate norms and observe/evaluate what happens. Are there distinct verbal or nonverbal reactions? This variation could be a little uncomfortable for some students so you might want to give them some flexibility.

Cultural Appropriation

Section 5.2 (Physical Appearance and Artifacts) argues:

Physical appearance and artifacts profoundly influence our communication encounters. In other words, how you look conveys as much about you as what you say. Physical appearance includes attributes such as hair, clothing, body type, and personal grooming...Artifacts are the things we possess that influence how we see ourselves and that we use to express our identity to others. They can include rings and tattoos, but may also include brand names and logos."

Cultures have rules, conventions, and norms for dress and appearance but what happens when other cultures borrow from those traditions? Where is the line between appreciation and appropriation?

Student Activity: Share one or more of the following resources with students:

- [My Culture is Not a Costume](#), Teen Vogue asks six women about Halloween costumes that co-opt their cultures.
- [Cultural Appropriation vs. Appreciation](#), CBC - Radio Canada. It's almost Halloween, have you picked a costume yet? It seems like every year certain costumes get everyone talking, so with that in mind, here's how we can all do a little more appreciating and a little less appropriating.
- [What's the Difference Between Appropriation and Appreciation?](#), Vice Asia. We asked London creatives from fashion, photography, art, magazines and music for their take on the term; and ask how we, as a society, can do better.
- [Keeping Up with the Kardashians Is Ending. But Their Exploitation of Black Women's Aesthetics Continues](#), Cady Lang, TIME, June 10, 2021. This article explores how our culture valorizes curves on wealthy, racially ambiguous white women, but stigmatizes these traits on Black women.

- [Who Really Owns the ‘Blaccent’?](#), Vulture: New York Magazine, Lauren Michele Jackson, August 24, 2018. Appropriation is a tricky thing in the 21st century, yet it has somehow grown only more clichéd in public conversation. This article explores how appropriation exists simultaneously in two spaces - in the traditions and communal enclaves of black folks; on the body of a white or nonblack person.
- [Azealia Banks, Iggy Azalea and Hip-Hop’s Appropriation Problem](#). Jeff Chang, The Guardian, December 26, 2014. Jeff Chang offers rhyme and reason to the rap beef between the two pop stars that shed light on the genre’s complex relationship with race and identity.

*The last two sources focus on paralanguage (“nonverbal aspects of speech that influence meaning, including rate, pitch, tone, volume, intensity, pausing, and even silence”) as well as physical appearance and artifacts. This discussion is also in section 5.2 under Vocalics.

Investigation:

1. How does this source define cultural appropriation? Is there a comparison to cultural appreciation? Where does the line between the two exist?
2. Share some examples of cultural appropriation.
3. How does history influence our perception of what constitutes appropriation?
4. Does the person’s intent matter in deciding whether or not something is cultural appropriation?
5. Why is cultural appropriation problematic (something to be avoided)?
6. How could these individuals/artists demonstrate an appreciation for these nonverbal aspects of cultural communication without engaging in appropriation?
7. What advice would you provide to others when it comes to Halloween and other times when we might wear a costume?

Emoticons

In section 5.1 we are introduced to the Principles of Nonverbal Communication, the start of this discussion focuses on the relative importance of nonverbal communication in conveying messages. “Recent studies have indicated that determining the impact of nonverbal elements on communication meaning is extremely difficult, and results can vary from 60-93%. In the bigger picture, the exact results don’t matter as much as the fact that nonverbal communication can contribute to well-over half of the emotional or relational meaning of any given message.” Given how important nonverbal messages are in conveying meaning, the question arises, what do we do in channels that limit our ability to use nonverbal messages, like written communication. When we use a written channel (e.g. email, text message, social media post, etc.) to convey our verbal messages our options for nonverbal messages are limited. To help fill this gap we have adopted emoticons.

Emoticons are such a valuable form of nonverbal communication that different teams of neuroscientists have studied the reactions they trigger in the human brain. All studies came to pretty much the same conclusion: emoticons triggered strong activity in the brain area connected to processing emotions, even though they would trigger no response in the brain area connected to recognizing human faces. In other words, people are able to read the emotions conveyed by emoticons while being aware of the fact that they do not represent real human faces. In this activity, you will have students see how well they can interpret the emoticons that others use.

Student Activity: Have students share three emojis (emoticons) that they like to use (use the faces, not the images of random objects). You can have them share electronically if that works for your classroom setting or students can draw the emoticons in a face-to-face classroom. Beyond sharing the specific emoticons, don’t have students tell us anything else about them. Once the emoticons have been shared either on paper or on a discussion board let the class see them and have peers explain (guess) what the emojis are (what emotion do they convey, when and how would you use them).

Investigation:

1. How accurate were the guesses from your classmates? Why do you think they were easy or hard to guess?
2. Was there significant overlap in the emojis shared? What can that teach us about the kind of emotions that are more difficult to convey in written channels? Is clarity of these emotions important in your culture?
3. Have you ever had someone misinterpret your use of an emoticon? What was the result?
4. Does your use of emojis change depending on the specific written channel that you are using?
5. How else might we fill in the missing nonverbal messages when using written channels?

Discussion

1. Section 5.3 details the impact of the Environment on Conversations. Quiet, isolated environments are likely to lead to different conversation dynamics than a crowded, noisy environment. What makes an environment high load instead of low load (section 5.3: The Impact of the Environment on Conversations)? Provide some examples of high versus low load environments. What kind of communication would you engage in if you were in a low load environment? If you needed to engage in the same communication in a high load environment, could you? What adjustments would you have to make?
2. Even though human beings are by nature social, we also need time alone. “The degree to which people seek and value solitude vary across cultures, as does the means and mechanisms for being alone” (section 5.3: Privacy across Cultures). Lang (1987) identified four types of privacy: solitude, intimacy, anonymity, and reserve. Explain what these 4 types of privacy entail and how they differ? Provide examples from your own life that help illustrate how you engage in each type. Are sometimes more important to you than others? Why? How do you make sure that your privacy needs are met? Is it difficult? Why?

Supplemental Materials

[The Power of Nonverbal Communication](#), Joe Navarro, TED Talk

For 25 years, Joe used nonverbal communication as his primary professional tool in the FBI to catch and interview spies, criminals, and terrorists. Since leaving the FBI his life's work has been in building awareness about the power of nonverbal communication, debunking myths and falsehoods about nonverbals, and giving people insight into how to better utilize nonverbals to enhance their communication skills.

[Why Americans Smile So Much; How immigration and cultural values affect what people do with their faces](#). Olga Khazan, The Atlantic, May 3, 2017.

Americans tend to smile more often than people in other countries. Olga Khazan digs into a couple of scientific findings why — it turns out that American smiles signal excitement, and confidence, and also have to do with a long history of immigration.

[Why do Americans Smile so Much](#), Alice Roth, Olga Khazan, Jeremy Raff, Caitlin Cadieux, The Atlantic, May 25, 2017. A short video that explores these ideas.

[Braids and Appropriation in America](#) | ELLE

Lupita Nyong'o, Young M.A., Ayana Bird, Lacy Redway, Vernon François and more talk about braids and black hair culture in America.

[Good Hair](#)

Good Hair is a 2009 American documentary film directed by Jeff Stilson and produced by Chris Rock Productions and HBO Films, starring and narrated by comedian Chris Rock. The film focuses on the issue of how African-American women have perceived their hair and historically styled it. The film explores the current styling industry for black women, images of what is considered acceptable and desirable for African-American women's hair in the United States, and their relation to African American culture. The Movie is available on a number of streaming devices including Amazon prime. The [clips on Relaxer](#) are particularly relevant.

[Intercultural Communication: Gestures](#), Activity by Elizabeth Jones

The learner will recognize common gestures and identify the meanings associated with those gestures ([CC BY-NC 4.0](#))

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5.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. Nonverbal communication is communication through means other than language.

*a. True

b. False

2. In Japan, for example, it is common to bow when greeting someone, with the nature of the bow (how deep and how long) being determined by the nature of the occasion and social connection of the persons involved. Greetings and departures are examples of this kind of nonverbal communication?

a. Facial Expressions

b. Eye Contact

*c. Gestures

d. Posture

3. The following image is an example of a(n):



a. Facial Expression

b. Vocalic

*c. Gesture

d. Artifact

4. People in all cultures have the ability to smile and value and interpret smiles the same way.

a. True

*b. False

5. While weeping in public in Japan is considered inappropriate, in Middle Eastern or Latin American cultures it is normal to express one's emotions openly and visibly. This is an example of:

a. National linguistic variations

b. Emotional overtones

c. Disruptive facial analysis

*d. Cultural display rules

6. Which of the following demonstrates a variation in posture:

a. Humans can maintain eye contact when speaking but avert their gaze when listening, they can have a steady gaze or dart from side-to-side.

*b. Humans can stand up straight or slouch, lean forward or backward, round or slump our shoulders.

c. Humans can smile, frown, raise our eyebrows or scrunch our noses.

d. Humans can bow, shake hands, kiss on the cheek, hug, touch forehands, rub noses, or press their hands together.

7. Which of the following is not an example of kinesics?

- a. Posture
 - b. Eye Contact
 - *c. Paralanguage
 - d. Facial expressions
8. In the United States, high-status communicators typically use relaxed postures, but in Japan, the opposite is true.
- *a. True
 - b. False
9. Rate, pitch, tone, volume, intensity, pausing, and even silence are all examples of:
- *a. Paralanguage
 - b. Backchanneling
 - c. Proxemics
 - d. Haptics
10. For the US, intimate space is _____, which is reserved for highly personal relationships.
- a. 12 feet or longer
 - b. 4 to 12 feet
 - c. 1.5 to 4 feet
 - *d. 9 to 18 inches
11. Always accept things with your right hand. The left hand is used to Wash the posterior and is therefore regarded as unclean. This is a _____ rule in Thailand.
- a. Proxemics
 - *b. Haptics
 - c. Kinesics
 - d. Vocalics
12. The United States is considered a _____ culture.
- a. Contact
 - b. Dual Contact
 - *c. Noncontact
 - d. Contactless
13. This image of tattoos is an example of what kind of nonverbal communication?



- a. Haptics
- *b. Artifacts
- c. Olfactics

D. Gestures

14. Music is a "universal language" in that it is understood without the need for language.

*a. True

b. False

15. The study of smell in humans is called:

a. Proxemics

b. Haptics

c. Kinesics

*d. Olfactics

16. "Time is money" is a common saying across _____ oriented cultures.

a. Chronemic

b. Polychronic

c. Haptic

*d. Monochronic

17. Going unnoticed by others especially in a crowd achieves which type of privacy?

a. Solitude

b. Intimacy

*c. Anonymity

d. Reserve

18. Which of the following is an example of an artifact?

*a. Clothing

b. Smiling

c. Waving

d. Winking

19. _____ cultures endorse displays of emotion that reinforce hierarchical relations (i.e., status reminders), such as showing anger toward a low-status person or appeasing a high-status person (e.g., smiling).

a. Low power distance

*b. High power distance

c. High context

d. Low context

20. In English sounds such as "uh-huh" or "hmm," or words and phrases like "yes" or "go on," function as?

a. Turn-taking cues

b. Vocalic influx

c. Proxemics

*d. Backchanneling

Type: E

Short-Answer

1. If there is a discrepancy between someone's verbal and nonverbal communication we are more inclined to believe the nonverbal. Explain why.
2. How do we communicate nonverbally through our environment?
3. Explain how car and driving behavior varies from one culture to another?
4. What are nonverbal expectations? How can they be violated? What are the potential implications of nonverbal expectancy violations?

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

6: Culture Shock

[6.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[6.2: Outline](#)

[6.3: Test Bank](#)

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6.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

The Fish Can't See the Water

There is a saying, ask a fish about the water they swim in, and they'll look at you blankly. The fish is so IN the water that they can't see it or describe it. It's all they know; the fish doesn't know anything else; how can one describe something when it is all there is? For humans, culture is the water. We are so IN our culture that we don't know anything else. It is not until we leave our culture for another that we can begin to see what has surrounded us the whole time.

Chapter 6.1 describes it this way "When a person moves to a cultural environment that is different than their own, they often experience personal disorientation called culture shock. Culture shock refers to the anxiety and discomfort we feel when moving from a familiar environment to an unfamiliar one." This activity has students reflect upon the dominant US culture through the eyes of those who have experienced culture shock when coming to the United States. Listening to these experiences lets us see our own culture in a new light and explore things that we take for granted.

Student Activity: Share one of the following lists with students:

- [23 Things That Are Considered 'Normal' in The US But That The Rest of The World Finds Weird](#), Jessica Booth, The Insider, May 3, 2021
- [31 Things Americans Think Are Normal, But Are Actually Reeaaalllyyy Weird](#), Kat Pickhardt, Buzzfeed, September 19, 2021.
- [25 Things The World Finds Strange About America \(That Even We Question\)](#), Lili Morwood, The Travel, December 8, 2018.

Investigation:

1. Do these things seem normal to you? Why or why not?
2. Did any of the things on the list strike you as odd? Why?
3. Have you ever stopped to wonder why these things are 'normal' in the US? Were you aware that they weren't in many other parts of the world?
4. Why does it take someone from outside the dominant culture to point these things out?
5. Now that they have been brought to your attention are there ones that you agree are weird? Would you be willing to change them in your own practice or in the larger culture?
6. Are there ones that you think should stay? How would you convince others about these?

Motivational Orientation

"Research suggests that nearly everybody who enters a new culture will experience some form of culture shock, but not everybody experiences culture shock the same way. How long culture shock lasts and the degree to which it is felt will vary according to several underlying factors. One of the most important factors is motivational orientation" (Section 6.1: Underlying Factors).

Those who have a high motivational orientation are more inclined to travel willingly and are excited to explore new cultures. These individuals may describe themselves as having wanderlust or the desire to explore the world through work, vacation, study abroad, etc.

Student Activity: Have students begin by rating their own motivational orientation on a scale of 1-10? Ask them to identify what evidence they would point to in order to support this claim (e.g. How much have they traveled from where they were raised? Have they been abroad? Do they want to study abroad? Do they visit culturally diverse areas (Chinatown, Little Saigon) in their current location? Once they have thought about their own motivational orientation, have them explore general trends in the US. What kind of data might we examine to get a sense of Americans' motivational levels?

- [Study Abroad Participation by State](#)
- [Share of Americans Holding a Passport](#)
- [Percentage of Americans Who Never Traveled Beyond the State Where They Were Born.](#)
- [The Geography of America's Mobile and 'Stuck,' Mapped.](#)

Investigation:

1. Based on the data that you examined, where would put US motivational orientation on a scale from 1-10.
2. How does your personal perception compare to the general data that you explored?

3. What factors do you think contribute to the data about Americans generally? Can we say that this is a reflection of motivation or are there extenuating circumstances that may hinder someone who is highly motivated?
4. Do you think the US values travel and specifically travel abroad to different cultures?
5. What could we do to help motivate people to seek out new cultural experiences?

Hello

In initial interactions communication plays a pivotal role in first impressions. As we learned in Chapter 5 nonverbal communication means we cannot not communicate because our very existence communicates, how we dress, how we present ourselves, etc. is all communication. When we first meet someone we will most likely engage in a greeting. This greeting is as much nonverbal as it is verbal (Chapter 4). Yet greeting behaviors are not universal; they vary from culture to culture and they can be one of the first things we notice when we explore a new culture. Culture shock happens in part because our way of doing things is not the same.

This activity has students explore this idea when it comes to greeting behaviors across cultures. In some cultures, a kiss is best. In others, a hug or handshake is preferred. In others, just saying “Hi” without any physical contact is safest. How we greet depends not just on culture but also on context. Who are you greeting, are you, strangers, coworkers, friends? The relational context (section 1.3: Communication Meets Needs) also influences our greeting behavior and what is appropriate.

Student Activity: Ask students what are some typical verbal greetings that they are familiar with. In English, this might include: hello, hi, hey, how are you, how’s it going? These tend to be relatively informal, how would you change the verbal greeting in a more formal environment? In addition to the verbal, greetings are also nonverbal. Again, in English speakers, this usually means a handshake, a wave, or a hug if you know the person. What other kinds of physical greetings might you encounter?

Once you have discussed the kinds of verbal and nonverbal greeting behaviors you might encounter you can have students practice different variations. This portion of the activity can be done in pairs, groups, or as the whole class. Give each student/pair/group a specific greeting and have them interact with each other.

- **Nose Bump**
 - Bring your nose in for a few friendly taps with theirs.
- **Air Kiss (cheek)**
 - In Argentina, Chile, Peru, Mexico, São Paulo (Brazil) and Colombia, one air kiss is standard, whereas in Spain, Portugal, Paraguay, Italy, and cities like Paris and Québec, it’s two. In Russia and Ukraine, three is the norm, and in some parts of France, it’s up to four air kisses on alternating cheeks
- **Hand Shake**
 - In some countries, handshakes only involve the right hand because the left is considered unclean.
 - Some countries expect a firm grip while others prefer a lighter touch.
- **Clap your hands**
 - An evening greeting in Zimbabwe involves hand clapping. Men clap hello and goodbye with their flat hands while women traditionally cup their hands. A few quick claps can also mean “thank you.”
- **Hand to heart**
 - Take the opposite person’s hands lightly in yours. Then, release the other person’s hands and bring your own hands to your chest and nod slightly to symbolize goodwill and an open heart.
- **Bow**
 - Press your palms together in an upward-pointing prayer position at heart level or higher, then bend your head slightly forward to take a bow.

Investigation:

1. How comfortable were you with the greeting assigned?
2. How did others react when you went to initiate a greeting with your assigned gesture?
3. When two parties meet and attempt to greet each other using different verbal and nonverbal behaviors what should they do?
4. Does one party have more of an obligation to change?
5. How does the uncomfortableness of engaging in behaviors that others might not be expecting help us understand culture shock?

Discussion Questions

1. Imagine you will be moving to [you can provide a specific country here or simply say abroad and have students choose] for an extended period of time, it could be to study, or for a job, or simply to travel. Using the discussion from section 6.2 on Tips for Managing Culture Shock lay out what you would do to prepare. Explain the general advice provided in the text and then explain how you would specifically go about doing it for your trip.
2. When people immigrate or travel to the United States it can be a difficult experience to find their place and navigate all of the differences between the culture they left and the one they now find themselves in. One factor that influences their degree of culture shock is sociocultural adjustment, which refers to the ability of the travel to fit in and interact with members of the host culture. In section 6.1 (Introduction to Culture Shock) you learned about several different attitudes (retreatism, resistance, revitalization) that hosts can have towards newcomers. Explain the different attitudes. As a member of the host culture, how do you think you would react? What specific behaviors would you engage in that would help demonstrate this attitude?

Supplemental Materials

[Why We Need to Embrace Culture Shock](#), Kristofer Gilmour, TED Talk

The newness and unknown of cultures other than what we are already familiar with can be daunting. Moving from a mental place of culture shock to 'culture comfort' involves a process of three steps we each can follow in our own time and in our own ways; 1) Flâneurie (or wandering while wondering), 2) Embrace the space around us and 3) Reflection on our actions and activities.

[Culture Shock: the Educational Adventure](#), Shiyi Ji, TED Talk

As an international student studying in America, Shiyi has experienced the highs, lows, and everything in between. Her new life has challenged her but she has grown so much and learned so much about herself. In this passionate talk, Shiyi shares her story, and the true experiences of culture shock, and encourages others to study abroad.

[Culture Shock + Compassion = Community](#), Ibrahima Sow, TED Talk

Coming to the United States at a young age, Ibrahima Sow endured a number of experiences that qualified as culture shock. Navigating his way in this new world, he met each challenge with heart and courage all the while determined to maintain his identity. What he learned is something that we can all benefit from; when culture shock is met with compassion, it can create a vibrant and strong community.

[Reverse Culture Shock](#), US Department of State

This section will discuss reverse culture shock -- the psychological, emotional, and cultural aspects of reentry. While the phenomenon of culture shock is increasingly well known (and relatively well prepared for in the foreign affairs community), reverse culture shock is not as recognized and understood. This is due in part to the fact that people are returning home. So why should "returning home" result in culture shock?

[Culture Shock](#), Virginia Tech, Global Education Office

This website provides information on culture shock, including what it is, stages, symptoms, and strategies for dealing with it.

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6.2: Outline

6.1: Introduction to Culture Shock

1. Culture Shock

A. When a person moves from a cultural environment that is different than their own, they often experience personal disorientation called culture shock.

B. Culture shock refers to the anxiety and discomfort we feel when moving from a familiar environment to an unfamiliar one.

1. In our own culture, through time, we have learned the million and one ways how to communicate appropriately with friends, family members, colleagues, and others.

2. When we enter a new culture, many of those familiar signs and signals are gone, leading us to feel helplessly lost in many circumstances.

2. The ABC's of Culture Shock.

A. The ABC's of culture shock refer to the affective, behavioral, and cognitive changes brought on by culture shock.

1. The affective dimension of culture shock refers to the anxiety, bewilderment, and disorientation of experiencing a new culture.

2. The behavioral dimension refers to confusion over the behaviors of people in the host culture.

3. The cognitive dimension refers to our inability to interpret our new environment or understand these "bizarre" social experiences.

B. Underlying Factors.

1. Research suggests that nearly everybody who enters a new culture will experience some form of culture shock, but not everybody experiences culture shock the same way.

2. One of the most important factors is motivational orientation; some people travel willingly and are excited to enter a new culture.

3. Personal expectations: people with high expectations for their cultural experiences tend to struggle more with culture shock. Those who travel with an open mind and heart, who take the experiences as they come in a more spontaneous way tend to adapt better.

4. When we travel to a new culture, the cultural distance between our home culture and host culture impacts our level of culture shock.

a. Cultural distance refers to the degree of difference in culture between the known, home environment and the new one.

b. When we travel to destinations where people speak a different language, have different racial features, practice a different religion, and have significantly different customs and traditions, we typically feel a greater degree of culture shock.

5. Another factor that influences the degree of culture shock is sociocultural adjustment, which refers to the ability of the traveler to fit in and interact with members of the host culture. The level of sociocultural adjustment largely rests on the hosts' attitudes toward visitors to their culture.

a. One attitude of hosts towards tourists is retreatism. Retreatism basically means that hosts actively avoid contact with tourists by looking for ways to hide their everyday lives.

b. Another attitude of hosts towards tourists is resistance. This attitude can be passive or aggressive. Passive resistance may include grumbling, gossiping about, or making fun of tourists behind their backs.

c. Other communities actively invest money to draw tourists to create economic well-being. This attitude is called revitalization.

6. Of course, individual personality attributes play a factor in how well one copes with culture shock.

C. Travelers and Tourists

1. Travelers are intellectually curious.

a. They desire to explore new places, taste new foods, meet new people, and immerse themselves in cultures that are different from their own.

2. Tourists are more interested in cultural exploitation rather than cultural exploration.

- a. A tourist would rather spend all day on a tourist beach than exploring a local, hidden beach.
- b. The characterizations of "traveler" and "tourist" are not mutually exclusive categories. There are many overlapping and gray areas. But in general, the distinction between traveler and tourist is a matter of orientation.

D. Study Abroad

- 1. Culture shock has been studied extensively in connection with study abroad programs.
- 2. In addition to study abroad, there are other avenues for university-age students to have meaningful longer-term encounters with a foreign culture.

6.2: Managing Culture Shock

- 1. Many studies have been conducted and a few models have emerged that help explain the stages of culture shock.

A. One of the best known models is The W-curve model, proposed by Gullahorn and Gullahorn (1963).

B. The W shape represents the fluctuation of travelers' emotions when adapting to a new culture, and then when re-adapting to their home culture.

- 1. The first stage, often called the honeymoon stage, happens right at the beginning of the journey.
- 2. Stage two, the culture shock stage, is characterized by frustration and fatigue of not understanding the norms of the new culture.
- 3. Navigating the new culture becomes easier, friendships and communities of support are established, and the language and customs become more familiar; this adaptation to the new culture is the third stage, called the adjustment stage.
- 4. This fourth stage is referred to as reverse culture shock, or re-entry shock.

C. Young Yun Kim (2005) sees adjustments happening in a cyclical pattern of stress – adaptation – growth.

- 1. She sees stress as useful for an individual's growth and prefers "cultural adjustment" over "culture shock".

- 2. It's also the case that acculturation is not just within the power of the individual.

2. Tips for Managing Culture Shock:

A. One of the best remedies for managing culture shock starts with simply understanding that culture shock exists.

- 1. When we realize that culture shock exists, we have an explanation for the emotional turmoil caused by culture shock.
- 2. if we learn more about the host country, we may begin to have an understanding of the different norms and customs in our new environment.
- 3. When we enter an unfamiliar culture, we confront situations that we just don't understand.
- 4. To better manage culture shock, we need to learn to tolerate ambiguity.
- 5. The best advice for managing culture shock is to be mindful of ethnocentrism and suspend ethnocentric evaluations.

B. To manage that stress, we need to cultivate a positive attitude.

C. It's important to have faith in yourself, in the essential goodwill of your hosts, and the positive outcome of the experience.

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6.3: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. _____ refers to the anxiety and discomfort we feel when moving from a familiar environment to an unfamiliar one..
 - a. PTSD
 - *b. Culture shock
 - c. Brain atrophy
 - d. Beliefs
2. Culture shock simply means your presence in another culture is shocking to the members of that culture.
 - a. True
 - *b. False
3. The ABC's of Culture Shock refer to?
 - *a. Affective, behavioral, cognitive
 - b. Aflac, bounty, capital
 - c. Affection, babbel, conciseness
 - d. Affiliation, behaviours, collaboration
4. The _____ dimension refers to confusion over behaviors of people in the host culture.?
 - a. Affective
 - b. Cognitive
 - *c. Behavioral
 - d. Power distance
5. The _____ dimension of culture shock refers to the anxiety, bewilderment, and disorientation of experiencing a new culture.:
 - a. Cognitive
 - *b. Affective
 - c. Power distance
 - d. Behavioral
6. The terms "tourist" and "traveler" are interchangeable and mean the exact same thing .
 - a. True
 - *b. False
7. The _____ dimension refers to our inability to interpret our new environment, or understand these "bizarre" social experiences..
 - a. Behavioral
 - b. Affective
 - c. Power distance
 - *d. Cognitive
8. The experience of culture shock can range from mildly annoying to profoundly disturbing; one of the best known models that helps explain culture shock is?..
 - a. Shock model
 - *b. W-Curve model
 - c. Ti84 model

d. Model x

9. According to your text, how many stages are in the w-curve model?

a. 5

*b. 4

c. 7

d. 8

10. This stage happens right at the beginning of the journey. It represents the hope and excitement in anticipation of new experiences.

*a. Honeymoon

b. Culture Shock

c. Adaptation

d. Re-entry

11. Of the several underlying factors to experiencing culture shock, one of the most important factors is?

a. Uncertainty

b. Power distance

c. Cultural distance

*d. Motivational orientation

12. How one travels into a new culture can significantly impact the degree of culture shock one experiences..

*a. True

b. False

13. Travelers are more interested in cultural exploitation rather than cultural exploration.

a. True

*b. False

14. According to your text, one of the best remedies for managing culture shock is?

a. Talk out loud

b. Start a blog

*c. Acknowledge it exists

d. Activity

15. Another model to help comprehend culture shock that is presented in a cyclical pattern is called the?

a. Ethnocentrism approach

b. Stress – adaptation – growth

c. Cultural highs and lows

d. Decontamination

16. “The ability of the traveler to fit in and interact with members of the host culture” influences the degree of culture shock and is referred to as:

a. Retreatism

*b. Sociocultural adjustment

c. Cultural distance

d. Revitalization

17. In Chengdu, there were certain locations called English corners, where people gathered to practice English. The American students who went to the English corners were surrounded by local Chinese people who invited them to their homes, took them out for meals, and showed them the hidden jewels of the city that they otherwise never would have encountered. This example illustrates what means of managing culture shock?

- a. Realize that culture shock exists
- b. Learn more about the host country
- *c. Develop friendships
- d. Learn to tolerate ambiguity

18. The best advice for managing culture shock is:

- a. Realize that culture shock exists
- b. Learn more about the host country
- c. Develop friendships
- *d. Suspend ethnocentric evaluations

19. When we travel to a new culture, the _____ between our home culture and host culture impacts our level of culture shock.

- *a. Cultural distance
- b. Sociocultural adjustment
- c. Resistance
- d. Level of ambiguity

Type: E

Short Answer

1. What is the benefit of a study abroad program in regards to culture shock?
2. What is the difference between a tourist and a traveler?
3. How do personality attributes contribute to our ability to cope with culture shock? How do you think you would cope given your personality? Use specific examples.
4. Compare and contrast travelers and tourists?

Essay

1. Compare and contrast the different models (The W-curve Model & Stress - Adaptation - Growth) that help explain culture shock.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

7: Barriers to Intercultural Communication

[7.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[7.2: Outline](#)

[7.4: Test Bank](#)

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7.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

Privilege

Whether they realize it or not, white people enjoy societal advantages in their daily lives, simply because they are white. These advantages are white privilege (section 7.1: White Privilege). Peggy McIntosh defines white privilege as an invisible knapsack of advantages that some people carry around. They are invisible because they are often not recognized, seen as normative (i.e., “that’s just the way things are”), seen as universal (i.e., “everyone has them”), or used unconsciously. In addition to the information on privilege in the text, here are some additional sources you can share with students:

- [White Privilege: Unpacking the Invisible Knapsack](#), Peggy McIntosh
- [How to recognize your white privilege - and use it to fight inequality](#), Peggy McIntosh, TED Talk.
- [How Privileged Are You?](#), BuzzFeed. Participants talk about their experience taking the privilege quiz and what it has taught them about themselves and their relationships with others.

Student Activity: Have students take the [privilege quiz](#).

Check off all the statements that apply to you.

- I am white.
- I have never been discriminated against because of my skin color.
- I have never been the only person of my race in a room.
- I have never been mocked for my accent.
- I have never been told I am attractive “for my race.”
- I have never been a victim of violence because of my race.
- I have never been called a racial slur.
- I have never been told I “sound white.”
- A stranger has never asked to touch my hair, or asked if it is real.
- I am heterosexual.
- I have never lied about my sexuality
- I never had to “come out.”
- I never doubted my parents’ acceptance of my sexuality.
- I have never been called “fag.”
- I have never been called “dyke.”
- I have never been called a “fairy,” or any other derogatory slur for homosexuals.
- I have never tried to hide my sexuality.
- I am always comfortable with P.D.A. with my partner in public.
- I have never pretended to be “just friends” with my significant other.
- I have never been ostracized by my religion for my sexual orientation.
- I have never been told I would “burn in hell” for my sexual orientation.
- I have never been told that my sexuality is “just a phase.”
- I have never been violently threatened because of my sexuality.
- I am a man.
- I feel comfortable in the gender I was born as.
- I still identify as the gender I was born in.
- I have never tried to change my gender.
- I have never been denied an opportunity because of my gender.
- I make more money than my professional counterparts of a different gender.
- I have never felt unsafe because of my gender.
- I have never been catcalled.
- I have never been sexually harassed or assaulted.
- I have never been raped.
- I work in a salaried job.

- My family and I have never lived below the poverty line.
- I don't have any student loans.
- I have never gone to bed hungry.
- I have never been homeless.
- My parents pay some of my bills.
- My parents pay all of my bills.
- I don't rely on public transportation.
- I buy new clothes at least once a month.
- I have never done my taxes myself.
- I have never felt poor.
- I have never had to worry about making rent.
- I have never worked as a waiter, barista, bartender, or salesperson.
- I have had an unpaid internship.
- I have had multiple unpaid internships.
- I went to summer camp.
- I went to private school.
- I graduated high school.
- I went to an elite college.
- I graduated college.
- My parents paid (at least some of) my tuition.
- I had a car in high school.
- I've never had a roommate.
- I've always had cable.
- I have traveled internationally.
- I travel internationally at least once a year.
- I studied abroad.
- I've never skipped a meal to save money.
- I have frequent flier miles.
- My parents are heterosexual.
- My parents are both alive.
- My parents are still married.
- I do not have any physical disabilities.
- I do not have any social disabilities.
- I do not have any learning disabilities.
- I have never had an eating disorder.
- I have never been depressed.
- I have never considered suicide.
- I have never attempted suicide.
- I have never taken medication for my mental health.
- I can afford medication if/when I need it.
- I have never been told I'm overweight or "too skinny."
- I have never felt overweight or underweight or "too skinny."
- I have never been shamed for my body type.
- I consider myself to be physically attractive.
- I can afford a therapist.
- I've used prescription drugs recreationally.
- I have never had an addiction.
- I have never been shamed for my religious beliefs.
- I have never been violently threatened for my religious beliefs.
- I have never been violently attacked for my religious beliefs.
- There is a place of worship for my religion in my town.
- I have never lied about my ethnicity as self-defense.

- I have never lied about my religion as self-defense.
- All my jobs have been accommodating of my religious practices.
- I am not nervous in airport security lines.
- I have never heard this statement: “You have been randomly selected for secondary passport control.”
- I have never been called a terrorist.
- Nobody has ever tried to “save” me for my religious beliefs.
- I have never been cyber-bullied for any of my identities.
- I was not bullied as a child for any of my identities.
- I have never tried to distance myself from any of my identities.
- I have never been self-conscious about any of my identities.
- I have never questioned any of my identities.
- I feel privileged because of the identities I was born with.

Investigation:

*The actual privilege test should remain anonymous, you should not collect them and you should not ask students to share specifics. If they volunteer to talk about specific questions that is great but they should not be forced or required to share this information with you or their classmates.

As you were completing the activity, reading and answering the questions, how did you feel?

1. Were there things on the list that you had never thought of as privilege?
2. Which of these privileges are based on race?
3. What other kinds of social privilege do these questions highlight?
4. What is the relationship between power and privilege? Which of these questions helps illustrate that relationship for you?
5. Why is it so difficult to talk about privilege?
6. How can you work to raise awareness about privilege and how it impacts yourself and others?

Stereotypes

“Stereotypes are oversimplified ideas about groups of people. Stereotypes can be based on race, ethnicity, age, gender, sexual orientation — almost any characteristic” (section 7.1: Stereotypes). Stereotypes are generalizations that don’t take individual differences into account. This activity will help students think about how stereotypes are perpetuated.

Before class, write the name of a group of people on several cards or small slips of paper. Here are some ideas for groups to include:

- Asian
- American Indian
- American
- Middle Eastern
- White
- Black
- African American
- Hispanic
- Jewish
- Catholic
- Baptist
- Rural
- Women
- Disabled
- Gay
- Lesbian
- Elderly

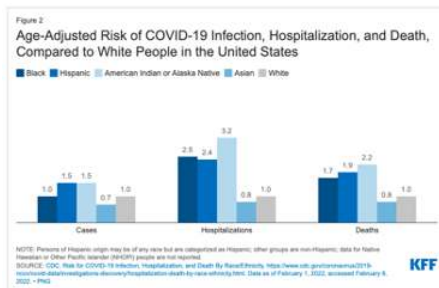
Student Activity: Give each person or group one card and instruct them to write down as many stereotypes (adjectives) to describe their particular group. After each person/group has written down their adjectives ask them to think about whether they function as stereotypes.

Investigation:

1. Where did these stereotypes start?
2. Why do people hold this stereotype?
3. Are there positive and negative stereotypes?
4. How do stereotypes affect people who identify with these groups?
5. Have any of you ever felt the effects of prejudice? How did it make you feel?
6. How can we work to combat these stereotypes?

Institutional Discrimination

Institutional discrimination is discrimination that pervades the practices of whole institutions, such as housing, medical care, law enforcement, employment, and education. This type of discrimination does not just affect a few isolated individuals, instead, it affects large numbers of individuals simply because of their race, gender, ability, or other group affiliation (section 7.2: Types of Discrimination). People of color have higher rates of disease and illness than whites, due in large part to institutional discrimination based on race and ethnicity. Most recently we have seen this in the disparity in COVID-19 hospitalizations and deaths.



Student Activity: Have students explore the ways in which race impacts healthcare and healthcare outcomes. Here are some additional examples you can use to guide this inquiry:

- [Devices Used In COVID-19 Treatment Can Give Errors For Patients With Dark Skin](#), Richard Harris, NPR, December 16, 2020.
- [Black Women Over Three Times More Likely to Die in Pregnancy, Postpartum Than White Women, New Research Finds](#). Population Reference Bureau, December 6, 2021.
- [City-Level Data Shows Stark Racial Disparities in Diabetes Deaths](#), Jessica Kent, March 29, 2021

Investigation:

1. What is the difference between individual and institutional discrimination?
2. How do we know that something has risen to the level of institutional discrimination?
3. Is institutional discrimination still dependent on individual actors?
4. How does the US's staunch individualism make it difficult to tackle institutional discrimination?
5. What can we do in the specific case of healthcare disparities to help increase access and better outcomes for people of color?

Discussion Questions

1. Have students read or listen to the following NPR story: [The Slants Frontman Fights Government To Register His Band's Name](#) NPR All Things Considered, May 8, 2015. What would you think of a band called "The Slants" or "The Chinks"? What if the members of the band are all Asian?

Update: [Why the Slants Took a Fight Over Their Band Name to the Supreme Court](#), Joe Coscarelli, The New York Times, June 19, 2017. The Supreme Court ruled that a law denying federal trademark protection to names that are deemed disparaging is unconstitutional. "It offends a bedrock First Amendment principle: Speech may not be banned on the ground that it expresses ideas that offend," Justice Samuel Alito wrote in the unanimous decision (though the justices were split on the exact reasoning).

2. People often form judgments and hold expectations about people based on their age. Ageism is widespread in U.S. culture (Nosek, 2005), and a common ageist attitude toward older adults is that they are incompetent, physically weak, and slow (Greenberg, Schimel, & Martens, 2002) and some people consider older adults less attractive (Section 7.2: Examples of Discrimination). Provide some examples of how we see this ageism in the US. Why do you think it is so prevalent in our

culture, especially in comparison to other cultures where the elderly are revered? Why do you think this particular kind of discrimination is dismissed more easily? How can we work to overcome these trends?

Supplemental Materials

[Tiger Mom: Some Cultural Groups Are Superior](#), Maureen Callahan, New York Post, January 14, 2014.

[Wilkerson: America Has A Caste System](#)

Author Isabel Wilkerson tells Amanpour about her new book "Caste: The Origins of Our Discontents" and why we need a new language to understand divisions in the United States. Source: CNN

[America's Caste System](#)

"Race" is often used as a fundamental way to understand American history. But what if "caste" is the more appropriate lens? In conversation with Pulitzer Prize winner Isabel Wilkerson, we examine the hidden system that has shaped our country.

[Author Isabel Wilkerson: Caste, not race, is the 'bones' of inequality in the US](#)

American writer Isabel Wilkerson began her latest book long before the police killing of George Floyd and long before many American conservatives took issue with the argument that systemic racism is at the heart of the problem of police brutality.

[The Power of Privilege](#), Jonathan Kalan, TED Talk

Journalist and entrepreneur Jonathan Kalan is acutely aware of the advantages his US passport, education and background have given him. He set out to travel to far reaches of the world to see it through others' eyes. In this talk, he argues for empathy and how the benefits of a global perspective can broaden one's sense of purpose and understanding.

[A 'Forgotten History' Of How The U.S. Government Segregated America](#), Terry Gross, NPR Fresh Air, May 3, 2017.

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7.2: Outline

7.1: Ethnocentrism and Stereotypes

A. Ethnocentrism is placing one's own culture and the corresponding beliefs, values, and behaviors in the center; in a position where it is seen as normal and right, and evaluating all other cultural systems against it.

B. Our cultural background influences every aspect of our lives from the food we consume to the classroom.

C. Cultural imperialism is the ethnocentric imposition of one's own cultural values on another culture.

D. To dismantle ethnocentrism, we must recognize that our views of the world, what we consider right and wrong, normal or weird, are largely influenced by our cultural standpoint and that our cultural standpoint is not everyone's cultural standpoint.

E. This ethnocentric bias has received some challenges recently in United States' schools as teachers make efforts to create a *multicultural classroom* by incorporating books, short stories, and traditions from non-dominant groups.

1. Stereotypes

A. Stereotypes are rigid categorizations of people based on their group affiliation. We stereotype people because it streamlines the perception process.

1. Perception is the process of selecting stimuli from our environment, categorizing those stimuli, and then interpreting them.

B. Stereotypes are oversimplified ideas about groups of people.

C. Stereotypes are overgeneralized and applied to all members of a group.

D. New stereotypes are rarely created; rather, they are recycled from subordinate groups that have assimilated into society and are reused to describe newly subordinate groups.

2. Confirmation Bias

A. We seek out information that supports our stereotypes and ignore information that is inconsistent with our stereotypes.

3. Stereotypes and Self-Fulfilling Prophecy

A. A self-fulfilling prophecy is an expectation held by a person that alters his or her behavior in a way that tends to make it true.

B. When we hold stereotypes about a person, we tend to treat the person according to our expectations.

4. The Stereotype Effect

A. Our stereotypes influence not only our judgments of others but also our beliefs about ourselves, and even our own performance on important tasks.

1. Stereotype lift occurs when these beliefs may be positive, and they have the effect of making us feel more confident and thus better able to perform tasks.

2. Stereotype threat occurs these beliefs are negative, and they create negative self-fulfilling prophecies such that we perform more poorly just because of our knowledge about the stereotypes.

a. Stereotype threat is created in situations that pose a significant threat to self-concern, such that our perceptions of ourselves as important, valuable, and capable individuals are threatened.

b. Manipulations that affirm positive characteristics about oneself or one's group are successful at reducing stereotype threat.

5. Treating individuals according to rigid stereotypic beliefs is detrimental to all aspects of the communication process and can lead to prejudice and discrimination.

7.2: Prejudice and Discrimination

1. Prejudice is a negative attitude and feeling toward an individual based solely on one's membership in a particular social group, such as gender, race, ethnicity, nationality, social class, religion, sexual orientation, profession, and many more.

2. Identifying Prejudice

- A. Implicit biases operate out of our awareness, and also because people are frequently unwilling to admit that they hold them, social psychologists have developed methods for assessing them indirectly.
- B. Other indirect measures of prejudice are also frequently used in intercultural communication research, for instance—assessing nonverbal behaviors such as speech errors or physical closeness.

3. Explaining Prejudice

A. We all belong to a gender, race, age, and socioeconomic group. These groups provide a powerful source of our identity and self-esteem

- 1. An ingroup is a group that we identify with or see ourselves as belonging to.
- 2. An outgroup is a group that we don't belong to or a group that we view as fundamentally different from us.
- 3. Ingroup favoritism is the tendency to respond more positively to people from our ingroups than we do to people from outgroups.
- B. People also make trait attributions in ways that benefit their ingroups, just as they make trait attributions that benefit themselves.
 - 1. Ultimate attribution error is the tendency for each of the competing groups to perceive the other group extremely and unrealistically negatively.
 - 2. When an ingroup member engages in positive behavior, we tend to see it as a stable internal characteristic of the group as a whole.
 - 3. Similarly, negative behaviors on the part of the outgroup are seen as caused by stable negative group characteristics.

C. Authoritarianism is a personality dimension that characterizes people who prefer things to be simple rather than complex and who tend to hold traditional and conventional values.

D. Scapegoating is the act of blaming a subordinate group when the dominant group experiences frustration or is blocked from obtaining a goal.

E. Social learning theory argues that people who are prejudiced are merely conforming to the culture in which they grow up, and prejudice is the result of socialization from parents, peers, the news media, Facebook, and other various aspects of their culture.

4. Discrimination refers to the arbitrary denial of rights, privileges, and opportunities to members of these groups.

A. Examples of Discrimination

- 1. When we meet strangers we automatically process three pieces of information about them: their race, gender, and age.

B. Racism

- 1. A type of prejudice that is used to justify the belief that one racial category is somehow superior or inferior to others.
- 2. Racial discrimination is discrimination against an individual based solely on one's membership in a specific racial group.

C. Sexism

- 1. Is prejudice and discrimination toward individuals based on their sex.
- 2. Common forms of sexism in modern society include gender role expectations, such as expecting women to be the caretakers of the household.
- 3. Sexism also includes people's expectations of how members of a gender group should behave.

D. Heterosexism

- 1. Homophobia is widespread prejudice in U.S. society that is tolerated by many people and often results in heterosexual discrimination, such as the exclusion of lesbian, gay, bisexual, and transgender (LGBTQ) people from social groups and the avoidance of LGBTQ neighbors and co-workers.

E. Agesism

- 1. People often form judgments and hold expectations about people based on their age.
- 2. Typically, ageism occurs against older adults, but ageism also can occur toward younger adults.

3. Ageism is widespread in U.S. culture and a common ageist attitude toward older adults is that they are incompetent, physically weak, and slow.

5. Types of Discrimination

A. Individual discrimination is discrimination that individuals practice in their daily lives, usually because they are prejudiced.

1. Much individual discrimination occurs in the workplace.

B. Institutional discrimination, or discrimination that pervades the practices of whole institutions, such as housing, medical care, law enforcement, employment, and education.

1. This type of discrimination does not just affect a few isolated individuals, instead, it affects large numbers of individuals simply because of their race, gender, ability, or other group affiliation.

2. Criminal Justice

a. The number of incarcerated individuals in the United States (2.3 million individuals reported as incarcerated in 2016) is higher than in any other high-income country.

b. Incarceration disproportionately impacts African American individuals with African American men six times more likely to be incarcerated than non-Hispanic White men and African American women twice as likely to be incarcerated as non-Hispanic white women.

3. Health Care

a. People of color have higher rates of disease and illness than whites, due in large part to institutional discrimination based on race and ethnicity.

b. These adverse health outcomes are compounded for people of color when considering the intersectionality between poor health care and incarceration.

4. Housing

a. African Americans and Latinx Americans are more likely than Whites to have their mortgage applications declined.

b. There is also evidence of banks rejecting mortgage applications for people who wish to live in certain urban, supposedly high-risk neighborhoods, and of insurance companies denying homeowner's insurance or else charging higher rates for homes in these same neighborhoods. Practices like these are called redlining.

c. Residential segregation is widespread because of mortgage rejections and other processes that make it very difficult for people of color to move out of segregated neighborhoods and into unsegregated areas.

5. Employment

a. African Americans, Latinx Americans, and Native Americans still have much lower earnings than Whites.

7.3: Racism and Privilege

A. Racism can be traced back to the 15th century when European imperialists set out to colonize the rest of the world.

1. Alongside these imperialist ventures, racialization also ensued, where colonized peoples were positioned as inferior.

2. This process was extended across the planet and became embedded in countries colonized by Europeans, resulting in a redistribution of world resources through the politicization of biological attributes.

B. The dynamic of racism, whereby individuals and groups of people are discriminated against and subjugated on the basis of perceived physical characteristics such as skin color, has been and continues to be a pervasive and destructive force in many human societies.

1. Racism

A. A set of economic, political, and ideological practices whereby a dominant group exercises control over subordinate groups.

B. A concept founded upon the scientifically false premises that there are physical and psychological inequalities between human races.

C. Institutional racism, refers to the way in which racial distinctions are used, whether intentional or not, to organize the policy and practice of state, judicial, economic, and educational institutions.

2. Privilege and Power

A. Power is the ability to influence others and control our lives.

1. The dominant group: white, male, Christian, middle-class, able-bodied, educated, and heterosexual have more power than others.
2. People whose cultural identities do not conform to this model are the nondominant groups and have less sociopolitical and economic power.

B. White Privilege

1. Skin color is one of the more disturbing, largely unexamined, and persistent social constructs that perpetuates discrimination and divides power.
2. Whether they realize them or not, White people enjoy societal advantages in their daily lives, simply because they are white.
3. Peggy McIntosh defines white privilege as an invisible knapsack of advantages that some people carry around.
 - a. They are invisible because they are often not recognized, seen as normative (i.e., “that’s just the way things are”), seen as universal (i.e., “everyone has them”), or used unconsciously.
 - b. *To be white in America is not to have to think about it.* Except for hard-core racial supremacists, the meaning of being white is having the choice of attending to or ignoring one’s own whiteness”
4. Effective change lies in making whiteness visible, by exploring it as a racial or cultural construct, and defining whiteness in a non-defensive and non-racist manner.

C. Antiracist

1. The active practice of identifying, challenging, and changing organizational structures, policies, practices, and attitudes that perpetuate systemic racism.
 - a. Notice differences in treatment
 - b. Talk about white privilege and other forms of social privilege.
 - c. Be willing to teach other people about privilege and power.

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7.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. The Mercator projection creates increasing distortions of size as you move away from the equator. As you get closer to the poles the distortion becomes severe. The use of these kinds of maps is an example of:

- *a. Ethnocentrism
- b. Egocentrism
- c. Stereotyping
- d. Cultural misunderstanding

2. People with the best intentions sometimes travel to a society to “help” its people, because they see them as uneducated or backward—essentially inferior. In reality, these travelers are guilty of:

- a. Linearity
- b. Stereotyping
- c. Cultural appropriation
- *d. Cultural imperialism

3. Perception is the process of selecting stimuli from our environment, categorizing that stimuli, and then interpreting it.

- *a. True
- b. False

4. When we _____, we replace human complexities of personality with broad assumptions about character and worth based on social group affiliation.

- a. Perception
- *b. Stereotype
- c. Gaslight
- d. Ethnocentrism

5. We seek out information that supports our stereotypes and ignore information that is inconsistent with our stereotypes in a process known as:

- a. Ethnocentrism
- b. Self-fulfilling prophecy
- *c. Confirmation bias
- d. Stereotype lift

6. Discrimination is a negative attitude and feeling toward an individual based solely on one’s membership in a particular social group, such as gender, race, ethnicity, nationality, social class, religion, sexual orientation, profession, and many more.

- a. True
- *b. False

7. An _____ is a group that we identify with or see ourselves as belonging to.

- a. Egogroup
- b. Outgroup
- c. Agroup
- *d. Ingroup

8. _____ is the act of blaming a subordinate group when the dominant group experiences frustration or is blocked from obtaining a goal.
- a. Authoritarianism
 - b. Social learning
 - *c. Scapegoating
 - d. Domination
9. The tendency for competing groups to perceive the other group extremely and unrealistically negatively is known as:
- a. Ingroup favoritism
 - *b. Ultimate attribution error
 - c. Authoritarianism
 - d. Prejudice
10. _____ is a type of prejudice that is used to justify the belief that one racial category is somehow superior or inferior to others.
- *a. Racism
 - b. Sexism
 - c. Heterosexism
 - d. Ageism
11. This kind of discrimination includes a common attitude toward older adults as incompetent, physically weak, and slow.
- a. Racism
 - b. Heterosexism
 - *c. Ageism
 - d. Sexism
12. This type of discrimination does not just affect a few isolated individuals, instead, it affects large numbers of individuals simply because of their race, gender, ability, or other group affiliation.
- a. Individual discrimination
 - *b. Institutional discrimination
 - c. Cultural discrimination
 - d. Multiple discrimination
13. Residential segregation includes mortgage rejections and redlining. These practices are examples of institutional discrimination in:
- a. Criminal justice
 - b. Health care
 - *c. Housing
 - d. Employment
14. People of color have higher rates of disease and illness than whites, due in large part to institutional discrimination based on race and ethnicity.
- *a. True
 - b. False
15. Skin color is one of the more disturbing, largely unexamined, and persistent social constructs that perpetuate discrimination and divide power.

*a. True

b. False

16. When we hold stereotypes about a person, we tend to treat the person according to our expectations. This treatment can influence the person to act according to our stereotypic expectations, thus confirming our stereotypic beliefs. This cycle is referred to as:

a. Ethnocentrism

*b. Self-fulfilling prophecy

c. Confirmation bias

d. Stereotype lift

17. Implicit association procedures such as the IAT show that participants who claim that they are not prejudiced do not hold cultural stereotypes about social groups.

a. True

*b. False

18. Because we often feel a strong sense of belonging and emotional connection to those who are like us we develop:

*a. Ingroup favoritism

b. Ultimate attribution error

c. Authoritarianism

d. Prejudice

19. _____ is a personality dimension that characterizes people who prefer things to be simple rather than complex and who tend to hold traditional and conventional values.

a. Ingroup favoritism

b. Ultimate attribution error

*c. Authoritarianism

d. Prejudice

20. The fatal shooting of Trayvon Martin in February 2012 was a deadly example of:

*a. Individual discrimination

b. Institutional discrimination

c. Cultural discrimination

d. Multiple discrimination

Type: E

Short Answer

1. What is stereotype threat? How does it help explain poor performance amongst groups targeted by negative stereotypes?

2. Stereotypes and prejudices often operate out of our awareness and people are frequently unwilling to admit that they hold them. Explain what methods social psychologists developed for assessing them indirectly.

3. What is white privilege? How does it manifest in the lives of “white” people? How does it affect people of color?

Essay

1. How are maps ethnocentric? Why did the Mercator projection persist for so long? Do you think it has been resolved? Why or why not? What can we do to rectify this misperception?

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

8: Intercultural Conflict

[8.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[8.2: Outline](#)

[8.4: Test Bank](#)

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8.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

Group Dynamics: Understanding Intercultural Incidents

Section 8.1(Conflict Defined) explains that “conflict is a part of all human relationships (Canary, 2003)...and is happening all around the world at the personal, societal, political, and international levels.” The purpose of this activity is to focus on understanding the differences that could lead to conflict during group work from an intercultural perspective. This involves (i) discussing a framework for understanding cultural variation and difference and (ii) analyzing the impact of cultural difference on interaction in the international classroom using the high–low context continuum.

First remind students of the high-low context framework for analyzing cultural differences (Hall & Reed Hall, 1989). Explain that this is one of the possible theoretical frameworks to understand and analyze communication incidents that may come up in intercultural groups (Section 4.3: Communication Styles). Then provide a discussion on the impact of the high–low context mode of communication on the interaction between students in a project group which may lead to misunderstandings, conflicts, and failed group projects. Ask participants to provide concrete examples when possible.

Student Activity: Have students get into groups of equal size. Introduce and distribute the case study to the participants. Ask the participants to first individually read the case and complete the individual worksheet. When everyone is done completing their own worksheet, ask students to discuss their findings with each other in their groups. After they are finished discussing, instruct students to create a shared framework on the group handout or a flip chart.

Case Study

It is nearing the end of the semester and you have been asked to help teach a section of the course and facilitate (tutor) some group projects as a class leader. There are 36 students in six groups. The student groups have been researching a topic and working on a final report. One of the groups is having a conflict and the instructor has asked you to help because you have a background in intercultural communication. This group includes Joanna (United Kingdom), Wong (Malaysia), Françoise (France), Mohamed (Oman), Renee (Netherlands), and John (Nigeria). The students from this group have studied the task and have worked together for one week. During your first tutoring session with them, you notice they have not progressed as far as you would have liked. Joanna, who volunteered to be the group coordinator, is clearly embarrassed and explains that not everyone was able to attend the preparation meeting that she had organized and/or provide the pre-work she had requested. She also felt that she had been undertaking most of the work along with Françoise. She was concerned about the overall grade they may be awarded. You decide to speak with all of the group members to see what is going on. Here is what you found out:

- Wong was not clear about what was expected of him.

- John claims he was representing the College in basketball but should be able to attend the next meeting.
- Renee felt left out of the group work because, due to the tight deadline, the decision was made to put in the work on a Sunday, which conflicted with her religious obligations (no work on Sunday).
- Mohamed felt his contributions were being disregarded.
- Some group members felt Joanna was only concerned with her grades and not listening to the other members of the group.

Worksheet Identifying and Analyzing Intercultural Misunderstandings: (1 for each participant to complete individually and 1 for the group to fill out together).

Student	What was the intention of the behavior?	What are the perceptions of the other students?	Which intercultural issues could be at play?
Joanna			
Francoise			
Wong			
Renee			
Mohammed			
John			

Investigation:

1. In terms of understanding and resolving differences, what would success look like for you as the tutor in this Case?
2. What was the impact of taking an intercultural perspective?
3. What factors were you not originally thinking about that were highlighted by the High–Low Context Continuum?
4. What was the impact of discussing this with someone else?
5. What else did you learn through this process?
6. What does it take to work effectively with this tool?
7. How can the tool be useful to you moving forward?

This activity was adapted from EQUiP (Educational Quality at Universities for inclusive international Programmes). Co-funded by the Erasmus+ Programme of the European Union, ([CC BY 2.0](https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/2.0/))

Cultural Miscommunication

Parties in conflict have perceptions about their own position and the position of others. Each party may also have a different perception of any given situation. We can anticipate having such differences due to

a number of factors that create perceptual filters or cultural frames that influence our responses to the situation. Such influences can be things like culture, race & ethnicity, gender & sexuality, knowledge, impressions of the messenger, and previous experience. These factors and more conspire to form the perceptual filters through which we experience conflict (Section 8.1: Conflict Defined). This activity has us think about how these perceptive filters influence our understanding of cultural miscommunication using the D.I.E. (Description, Interpretation, Evaluation) Model.

Student Activity: Have students think about a cultural misunderstanding from their own lives and complete this chart (you can provide a worksheet version or have them write their own):

Describe – Interpret – Evaluate

Description: What I see (only observed facts)

Interpretation: What I think about what I see

Evaluation: How I feel about what I see (positive or negative)

Description	Interpretation	Evaluation
What I see	What I think	What I feel

Investigation:

1. Our perceptions of ourselves and the world around us have developed throughout our lives, they are a reflection of our lived experiences. How did this exercise help you think specifically about your perceptions?
2. How can we work to be more understanding of others' perceptions and recognize that they may not be the same as ours?
3. What is the relationship between how we describe an event and how we interpret it?
4. What influence do our emotions play on our interpretation of this experience?
5. How can this practice/model help us engage in more productive evaluations of potential points of conflict?
6. Do you think having the parties involved in a conflict complete this model could improve their conflict management? How/why?

Additional Resource: Dally, J. (2013, September 28). [Bennett's Developmental Model of Intercultural Sensitivity \(DMIS\)](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8133333333) [Video]. YouTube.

Adapted from Improving Intercultural Competence in Canadian Settlement In Action: History and Future (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0).

Face

Section 8.2: Face explains that the concept of face is defined as a person's self-image or the amount of respect or accommodation a person expects to receive during interactions with others, which plays a crucial role in navigating intercultural conflict. Conflict Face-Negotiation Theory (Ting-Toomey, 2004) examines the extent to which face is negotiated within a culture and what existing value patterns shape culture members' preferences for the process of negotiating face in conflict situations. According to the theory, there are three different concepts of face:

- Self-face: The concern for one's image, the extent to which we feel valued and respected.
- Other-face: Our concern for the other's self-image, the extent to which we are concerned with the other's feelings.
- Mutual-face: Concern for both parties' face and for a positive relationship developing out of the interaction.

This activity explores how an intercultural conflict might be managed with a focus on self-face, other-face, and mutual-face.

Student Activity: Begin by having students brainstorm potential intercultural conflicts. Have students be specific, in identifying the parties involved, the setting (relational, workplace, school, etc.), and the nature of the conflict. Instead of having students brainstorm, you could provide a case study.

Case Studies:

Ariel, a sophomore, and Tara, a senior, are roommates. Most of the time the two women get along very well and conflict is limited. Recently though, Ariel has been leaving dirty dishes and personal belongings in the shared living space. This has started to annoy Tara, as she is becoming overwhelmed with the messy room, increased class assignments, and the stress of her upcoming graduation. Tara feels Ariel is taking advantage of her and being disrespectful. This morning, after stepping on one of Ariel's wire clothing hangers and lacerating her foot, Tara has had enough and goes to confront Ariel.

Michael and Kristen are volunteers on a student committee responsible for planning monthly Late Night Dances on campus. Kristen is in charge of the committee and Michael is the person she has put in charge of security at the dances. At the dance in March (two weeks ago) there was a problem involving an intoxicated student who gained entrance to the dance and caused a fight. Kristen sent Michael an email indicating that he was relieved of his security responsibilities as a result of the fight. When Michael saw Kristen on campus two days later he angrily confronted her and accused her of prejudice in the decision to fire him.

The case studies were adapted from Introduction to Public Communication (CC BY-SA 4.0).

Now that there is a specific conflict to examine, have students explore various ways to manage this conflict that reflect the different face strategies. What would a self-face strategy look like compared to a

mutual-face, etc.? Students could do this individually, in pairs, or in groups.

Investigation:

1. What is my cultural and personal assessment of the problem?
2. Why did I form this assessment and what is the source of this assessment?
3. What are the underlying assumptions or values that drive my assessment?
4. How do I know they are relative or valid in this conflict context?
5. What reasons might I have for maintaining or changing my underlying conflict premise?
6. How should I change my cultural or personal premises in the direction that promotes deeper intercultural understanding?
7. How should I adapt on both verbal and nonverbal conflict style levels in order to display facework sensitive behaviors and to facilitate a productive common-interest outcome?

Discussion Questions

1. Section 8.1 (Conflict Styles) reminds us that conflict is an inevitable part of life. Nonetheless, conflict can make us profoundly uncomfortable. Why is some conflict productive while another conflict is destructive? Some competitive and some cooperative? What distinguishes these kinds of conflicts? Are we prone to one or the other? How can we move from destructive to productive? Is this always possible or something we should strive for? Does some conflict need to be competitive?
2. In section 8.2 (Managing Conflict Across Cultures) we learn more about the variables that impact how we choose to manage conflict. In some cases, we choose to walk about and avoid conflict, other times we stand up and fight. While we don't always know consciously why we chose one or the other in the moment it is helpful to reflect and understand why we choose one style or another. Does your relationship with the other person influence your choice? How does the focus of the conflict influence the decision? What cultural norms impact our choices? What about our individual personalities?

Supplemental Materials

Working with Cross-Cultural Couples: Unexplored Issues in Therapy

In the United States, 1 in 6 new marriages is interethnic or interracial. Today's therapists need to be equipped to help cross-cultural couples not only navigate the usual intimacy and communication concerns but also address issues of identity, privilege, and cultural differences, which are often ignored in traditional couples therapy. To do this well, and enhance our therapeutic effectiveness, we must examine our own blind spots and biases around race and culture. This movie is available at Films on Demand.

Cross Cultural Communication, Pellegrino Riccardi, TED Talk

This talk was given at a local TEDx event, produced independently of the TED Conferences. Pellegrino, being a cross cultural expert, he is sharing with us his personal and professional experience about how very different cultures can successfully coexist next to each other.

Stella Ting-Toomey on Face-Negotiation Theory

Interview conducted by Em Griffin, author of A First Look at Communication Theory.

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8.2: Outline

8.1: Characteristics of Intercultural Conflict

1. Conflict Defined: “conflict is an expressed struggle between at least two interdependent parties who perceive incompatible goals, scarce resources, and interference from others in achieving their goals.”

A. Expressed Struggle

1. Conflict is a communication process expressed verbally and nonverbally.
2. Often, conflict is easily identified because one party openly and verbally disagrees with the other, but intrapersonal, or internal conflict, may exist for some time before being expressed.

B. Interdependent

1. Parties engaged in expressed struggle do so because they are interdependent.
2. Each party’s choices affect the other because conflict is a mutual activity.

C. Perception

1. Parties in conflict have perceptions about their own position and the position of others.
2. We can anticipate having such differences due to a number of factors that create perceptual filters or cultural frames, including culture, race & ethnicity, gender & sexuality, knowledge, impressions of the messenger, and previous experience.

D. Clashes in Goals, Resources, and Behaviors

1. Conflicts arise from differences and can occur whenever parties disagree over their values, motivations, ideas, or desires.
2. When conflict triggers strong feelings, a deep need is typically at the core of the problem.
2. Characteristics of Intercultural Conflict: Intercultural conflicts are often characterized by more ambiguity, language issues, and the clash of conflict styles than some cultural conflicts.

A. Conflict and Communication

1. Conflict can arise over differences of opinion regarding substantive issues or may derive from misunderstandings based on verbal or nonverbal communication tied to cultural norms and values.
2. Conflict is less likely to come from language mechanics and more likely from mistakes in language pragmatics, most frequently in the area of speech acts, i.e. using language to perform certain actions or to have them performed by others.

B. Conflict and Ethnocentrism

1. In our everyday lives, we don’t have to think about how to navigate through our own culture.
2. When communicating across cultures, this error in thinking can lead us to create expectations for behavior that fail to factor in the cultural context.
3. This ethnocentric thinking can easily lead to misunderstanding and conflict.

3. Conflict Styles

A. Conflict Style Inventories

1. Direct Approaches are favored by cultures that think conflict is a good thing, and that conflict should be approached directly, because working through conflict results in more solid and stronger relationships.
2. Indirect Approaches are favored by cultures that view conflict as destructive to relationships and prefer to deal with conflict indirectly.
3. Emotionally Expressive people or cultures are those who value intense displays of emotion during a disagreement.
4. Emotionally Restrained people or cultures are those who think that disagreements are best discussed in an emotionally calm manner. A sensitivity to hurting feelings or protecting the face or honor of the other is paramount.

B. Intercultural Conflict Style Inventory: disagreements leading to the conflict have two dimensions, an affective (emotional) and a cognitive (intellectual or analytical) side.

1. Discussion style: combines *direct* and *emotionally restrained* dimensions.
2. Engagement style: emphasizes a verbally *direct* and *emotionally expressive* approach to dealing with conflict.
3. Accommodating style: combines the *indirect* and *emotionally restrained* approaches.
4. Dynamic style: uses indirect communication along with more emotional expressiveness.

C. Seven-step conflict resolution model

1. State the Problem. Ask each of the conflicting parties to state their view of the problem as simply and clearly as possible.
2. Restate the Problem. Ask each party to restate the problem as they understand the other party to view it.
3. Understand the Problem. Each party must agree that the other side understands both ways of looking at the problem.
4. Pinpoint the Issue. Zero in on the objective facts.
5. Ask for Suggestions. Ask how the problem should be solved.
6. Make a Plan.
7. Follow up.

8.2: Intercultural Conflict Management

1. Managing Conflict Across Cultures

A. Types of conflict rarely stand alone.

B. Most often, several types of conflict are found intertwined within each other and within the context itself.

C. How people choose to manage conflict depends on the type of conflict, the contexts that they occur within, and the relationships with the other person or people.

D. Considering all the variations in how people choose to deal with conflict, it's important to distinguish between productive and destructive conflict as well as cooperative and competitive conflict.

1. Destructive conflict leads people to make sweeping generalizations about the problem by escalating issues with negative attitudes.

2. Productive conflict features skills that make it possible to manage conflict situations effectively and appropriately.

3. Competitive conflict promotes escalation. Coercion, deception, suspicion, rigidity, and poor communication are all hallmarks of a competitive atmosphere.

4. Cooperative conflict promotes perceived similarity, trust, flexibility, and open communication.

2. Conflict resolution styles represent processes and outcomes based on the interests of the parties involved.

A. If I am intent on reaching my own goals in an encounter, I use what's called a dominating or controlling style.

B. On the other hand, if I am content to allow others to get their way, I use an obliging or yielding style.

C. Flexibility and openness might lead to the adoption of an integrating or collaborating approach, seeking to find a solution that satisfies both parties.

D. A compromising approach provides a negotiated outcome that necessitates each party to give up something in order to reach a solution that provides partial gains on each side.

E. Avoidance or withdrawal may be appropriate if no resolution is likely, or there is not enough time or information to resolve the conflict.

3. Individualism and Collectivism

A. The strongest cultural factor that influences your conflict approach is whether you belong to an individualistic or collectivistic culture.

1. People raised in collectivistic cultures often view direct communication regarding conflict as personal attacks and consequently are more likely to manage conflict through avoidance or accommodation

2. People from individualistic cultures feel comfortable agreeing to disagree and don't particularly see clashes as personal affronts.

B. Perspectives

1. If you are an individualist in a dispute with a collectivist, you should consider the following:

a. Recognize that collectivists may prefer to have a third party mediate the conflict so that those in conflict can manage their disagreement without direct confrontation to preserve relational harmony.

b. Use more indirect verbal messages.

c. Let go of the situation if the other person does not recognize the conflict exists or does not want to deal with it.

2. If you are a collectivist and are conflicting with someone from an individualistic culture, the following guidelines may help:

a. Recognize that individualists often separate conflicts from people. It's not personal.

b. Use an assertive style, filled with "I" messages, and be direct by candidly stating your opinions and feelings.

c. Manage conflicts even if you'd rather avoid them.

4. Face: a person's self-image of the amount of respect or accommodating a person expects to receive during interactions with others.

A. Conflict Face-Negotiation Theory examines the extent to which face is negotiated within a culture and what existing value patterns shape culture members' preferences for the process of negotiating face in conflict situations.

1. Three concepts of face:

a. Self-face: The concern for one's image, the extent to which we feel valued and respected.

b. Other-face: Our concern for the other's self-image, the extent to which we are concerned with the other's feelings.

c. Mutual-face: Concern for both parties' face and for a positive relationship developing out of the interaction.

2. According to face negotiation theory, people in all cultures share the need to maintain and negotiate face.

a. Some cultures and individuals tend to be more concerned with self-face, often associated with individualism.

b. Collectivists, cultures, or individuals, tend to be more concerned with other-face and may prefer an indirect approach.

B. Facework: refers to the communication strategies that people use to establish, sustain, or restore a preferred social identity during an interaction with others.

1. Conflict Face-Negotiation Theory recommends a four-skills approach to managing conflict across cultures.

a. Mindful Listening: pay special attention to the cultural and personal assumptions being expressed in the conflict interaction.

b. Mindful Reframing: another face-honoring skill requiring the creation of alternative contexts to shade our understanding of conflict behavior.

c. Collaborative Dialog: an exchange of dialog that is oriented fully in the present moment and builds on Mindful Listening and Mindful Reframing to practice communicating with different linguistic of

contextual resources.

d. Culture-based Conflict Resolution Steps is a seven-step conflict resolution model that guides conflicting groups to identify the background of a problem, analyze the cultural assumptions and underlying values of a person in a conflict situation, and promote ways to achieve harmony and share a common goal.

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8.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. Conflict is inevitable.

*a. True

b. False

2. Conflict involves all of the following except:

a. An expressed struggle

*b. Independence

c. Perception

d. Clashes in resources

3. A direct approach conflict style is favored by cultures who view conflict as a good thing.

*a. True

b. False

4. In a/an _____ conflict style, sensitivity to hurting feelings or protecting the face or honor of the other is paramount.

a. Direct approach

b. Indirect approach

c. Emotionally expressive

*d. Emotionally restrained

5. The Intercultural Conflict Style Inventory posits that disagreements leading to conflict have two dimensions:

a. Affective and communicative

*b. Affective and cognitive

c. Afflicted and cognitive

d. Afflicted and communicative

6. This conflict style emphasizes a verbally direct and emotionally expressive approach to dealing with conflict.

a. Discussion style

*b. Engagement style

c. Accommodating style

d. Dynamic style

7. This conflict style uses indirect communication along with more emotional expressiveness.

a. Discussion style

b. Engagement style

c. Accommodating style

*d. Dynamic style

8. The seven-step conflict resolution model advocates for which conflict style?

*a. Discussion style

b. Engagement style

c. Accommodating style

- d. Dynamic style
9. It is very difficult to turn a competitive conflict relationship into a cooperative conflict relationship.
- *a. True
- b. False
10. Which conflict resolution style is more associated with a culture labeled as individualistic?
- *a. Dominating
- b. Obliging
- c. Integrating
- d. Compromising
11. Seeking to find a solution that satisfies both parties is more associated with a/an
- a. Dominating style
- b. Avoidance style
- *c. Integrating style
- d. Compromising style
12. The strongest cultural factor that influences your conflict approach is whether you belong to an individualistic or collectivistic culture
- *a. True
- b. False
13. Which of the following is not one of the concepts of face from Conflict Face-Negotiation Theory?
- a. Self-face
- b. Other-face
- c. Mutual-face
- *d. Multiple-face
14. Conflict Face-Negotiation Theory recommends a four-skills approach to managing conflict across cultures. One of these is the Culture-based Conflict Resolution Steps. How many steps does this model include?
- a. Five
- b. Six
- *c. Seven
- d. Eight
15. Which of the following is NOT included in the four-skills approach in Conflict Negotiation Theory?
- a. Mindful Listening
- b. Mindful Reframing
- *c. Communicative Agreement
- d. Culture-based Conflict Resolution Steps
16. Which of the following statements would you expect to see from native English speakers who will typically qualify requests.
- a. Bring me another cup of tea
- b. Pass the ketchup
- c. Turn the music down
- *d. Could I have the salt

17. Conflict is less likely to come from language mechanics and more likely from mistakes in language pragmatics.

*a. True

b. False

18. This face-honoring skill requires the creation of alternative contexts to shape our understanding of the conflict behavior.

a. Mindful Listening

*b. Mindful Reframing

c. Collaborative Dialog

d. Culture-based Conflict Resolution Steps

19. Which of the following is not a positive function of conflict?

a. It prevents stagnation

b. It stimulates interest and curiosity

*c. It allows for the airing of grievances

d. It is the root of personal and social change

20. Knowing the general norms of a group predicts the behavior of a specific member of a group.

a. True

*b. False

Type: E

Short Answer

1. What does the term interdependent mean? Include an example as it relates to conflict.

2. How could ethnocentrism lead to misunderstanding in conflict?

3. Explain the concept of facework.

4. If you are an individualist in dispute with a collectivist, what should you consider? Also, if you are a collectivist in conflict with an individualist, what should you keep in mind?

Essay

1. Recall the conflict resolution styles of dominating, obliging, integrating, compromising, and avoidance. Provide an example of a situation when it would be appropriate to use each style.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

9: Intercultural Relationships

[9.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[9.2: Outline](#)

[9.4: Test Bank](#)

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9.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

Interracial Dating

Section 9.2: Interracial Relationships argues that “while interracial relationships have occurred throughout history, there have been more historical taboos in the United States regarding relationships between African Americans and white people than other racial groups.” On its face, it would seem that technology would increase the ability for intercultural relationships by allowing people who might not otherwise interact to find each other. But recent data suggests that online dating apps may actually be facilitating the opposite. “Research shows racial inequities in online dating are widespread. For example, black men and women are 10 times more likely to message whites than white people are to message black people. Letting users search, sort, and filter potential partners by race not only allows people to easily act on discriminatory preferences, it stops them from connecting with partners they may not have realized they’d like.” (Lefkowitz, 2018).

Here are a few articles about this phenomenon that you can have students explore:

Dating is hard enough without the added element of racial discrimination can be disheartening and hurtful. Dating sites have shown that there are racial biases. The messages and comments made by users claim to be dating preferences but why does it feel racist? Dating preferences are based on familiarity and reflect IRL, in real life. A preference could be based on where one grew up, such as a mostly white neighborhood/city, and the familiarity can lead to a preference for a white person because that is what they are familiar with. Dating sites are encouraging users to focus less on a person’s demographics and more on psychographics.

[‘Least Desirable’? How Racial Discrimination Plays Out In Online Dating](#), Ashley Brown, NPR Morning Edition, January 9, 2018.

In public outcry against systemic racism, many dating apps removed the “ethnicity filter” from their sites. Some argue that removing the ethnicity filter will not address the discrimination on the app. On the other hand, removing the filter does promote the idea that race should not be a factor in partner selection. What some view as a preference is seen as outright racist with profile statements like “whites only.” As more people were called out for their racism, these types of posts decreased. Users can push dating apps to be more inclusive and more socially conscious. Dismantling racism begins with everyone and not trusting institutions to do the right thing.

[Why Dating Apps Are Racist AF — With or Without Ethnicity Filters](#), Lester Fabian Brathwaite, Rolling Stone, August 21, 2020.

Cornell researchers found that dating apps that allow race filters reinforce racial division. As more relationships start online, dating apps should discourage discrimination by removing race/ethnicity filters. Dating apps should promote inclusion, allowing filters to remove anyone different from you is at

odds with inclusivity. The study also found that dating apps may also create bias. People are more likely to engage in interracial exchanges if they get messages from people of other races. Apps without race filters make it easier to have interracial exchanges and reducing bias. It is becoming more evident that dating apps have an impact on racial discrimination and should take a justice-oriented approach to designing their platform.

[Redesign dating apps to lessen racial bias, study recommends](#), Melanie Lefkowitz, Cornell Chronicle, September 27, 2018.

Investigation:

1. Should apps allow users to identify their race and ethnicity in their profiles?
2. Should it be a way that you can filter who you see on the app?
3. If we remove these categories what other information should we allow?
4. How might that decrease racial bias?
5. Is this bias something that we should be concerned with?
6. What about the potential impact it has on individual users?

Self-Disclosure

Self-disclosure is the purposeful disclosure of personal information to another person. Self-disclosure is fundamental to relationship building because it builds trust and provides depth to the connection between two people. “There are many decisions that go into the process of self-disclosure. We have many types of information we can disclose, but we have to determine whether or not we will proceed with disclosure by considering the situation and the potential risks. Then we must decide when, where, and how to disclose” (Communication in the Real World). Research has shown that individuals from different countries in intercultural friendships differ in terms of the topics and depth of self-disclosure, but that as the friendship progresses, self-disclosure increases in depth and breadth (section 9.1: Friendship and Cultural Complexity). This activity explores how culture influences what topics we are willing to disclose, to whom, how, etc.

Student Activity: Have students rank on a scale of 1-5 how willing they are to share the following information:

1. My attitudes toward other religions, nationalities, and races
2. My financial status: how much money I earn, how much I owe, how much I have saved
3. My feelings about my parents
4. My sexual fantasies
5. My physical and mental health
6. My ideal romantic partner

7. My drinking and/or drug behavior
8. My most embarrassing moment
9. My unfulfilled desires
10. My self-concept

You can add several variations to the questions for comparison including specific people, length of the relationship, how the information is shared (social media), etc.

Investigation:

1. What kinds of topics would you be comfortable sharing early in a relationship?
2. What kinds of topics would you wait until the relationship has been more firmly established? How would you know you had reached that point?
3. Are there topics on the list that you would have no problem disclosing?
4. Would that change if it was a public disclosure (i.e. on a social media platform)

Romantic Relationships

Have you ever wondered what draws you to people, why do some make a lasting impression and others don't? What makes us interested in pursuing a relationship with one person but not another? "It is not a mystery. The factors include physical attractiveness, similarity, complementarity, proximity, reciprocal liking, and resources (section 9.2: Facilitating Factors). This activity will help explore some of these factors and how we present ourselves to others.

Student Activity: Have students (individually or in groups) write a dating profile.

Investigation:

1. What kind of photo would you include?
2. What makes an "attractive" photo?
3. Should you be explicit about what you want in a partner? Would you share this information if you were first interacting with someone face-to-face?
4. How do you share who you are in a way that others might find you to be similar or complementary? Does this change from one channel to another?
5. What does proximity mean? How does that work when it comes to online profiles?
6. How do you display your personality? Is this easier to do in-person or online when you have time to craft a specific message?

Discussion Questions

1. All relationships take work, but navigating intercultural relationships requires even more work because we have to navigate the relational differences as well. As Chapter 9.1 points out, "while

intercultural relationships can enrich our lives and provide life-changing benefits, they can also present several challenges” (Challenges in Intercultural Relationships). It is important that we spend some time thinking about how to navigate our modern world of dating (and friendships) now that we are more diverse and interconnected than ever before. With that in mind, think about how much of what you bring to your relationships is a reflection of your cultural upbringing. How open are you to diverse and new experiences? What is friendship? What expectations do you have of the people you identify as friends? Why would you want to be friends? How do you define a romantic relationship? What is the difference between being friends and being romantic? These are just some of the questions about relationships that are culturally influenced and may vary in intercultural relationships. How can you navigate disparities in these responses as you build and maintain relationships?

2. “Although homosexuality has existed throughout human history, cultures can have vast differences in how they support, accept, and categorize attraction and sexual relations between persons of the same gender” (section 9.2: Gay & Lesbian Relationships). The United States, as a whole, is becoming more accepting of gay and lesbian relationships. For example, in June 2015 the U.S. Supreme Court decision in *Obergefell v. Hodges* held in a 5-4 decision that the Fourteenth Amendment requires all states to grant same-sex marriages and recognize same-sex marriages granted in other states. Despite these legal victories individuals in same-gender romantic relationships still face prejudice and discrimination. What is your perception of the dominant US culture's view of same-gender relationships? How does a culture's view on accepted relationships change? How do individuals help shift perception?

Supplemental Materials

Global Relationships: Intercultural Couples Talk about Dating

We asked intercultural couples about the challenges and rewards of dating someone from a different ethnicity, here is what they had to say.

[4 tips for talking about race with your partner if you're in an interracial relationship](#). Canela Lopez, Insider, July 16, 2020.

Since the death of George Floyd during an arrest, there has been a near-global conversation about race, racism, and anti-Blackness — and conversations about how to have those conversations with your friends, family, and colleagues.

Creative Differences: The Benefits Of Reaching Out To People Unlike Ourselves

Hidden Brain, NPR Podcast

There is great comfort in the familiar. It's one reason humans often flock to people who share the same interests, laugh at the same jokes, and hold the same political views. But familiar ground may not be the best place to cultivate creativity.

[How Going Out Can Spur Outside-the-Box Thinking](#), Tom Relihan, MIT Management Sloan School, Sep 18, 2018.

This article argues that going outside of your cultural comfort zone in friendships and dating can spur creativity, innovation, and entrepreneurship.

[The Pairing Game: A Classroom Demonstration of the Matching Phenomenon](#). (March 1999). Bruce Ellis and Harold Kelley. *Teaching of Psychology*, 26(2):118-121.

This article describes 2 versions of an in-class simulation that allows students to directly experience the matching phenomenon and explore issues concerning mate selection, social exchange, and related Psychological concepts. Students are randomly assigned a value (either a numerical value or a list of adjectives), which they place on their forehead so others can see it but the student cannot. The goal is to pair off with another student with as high a value as possible. The simulation, called the Pairing Game, illustrates how matching on similarity can occur, even in the absence of knowledge of one's own value and merely by seeking the highest value possible in a partner. Students in Development Psychology courses responded favorably to the simulation on an anonymous survey.

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9.2: Outline

9.1: Intercultural Communication and Relationship

A. Establishing relationships with people different from us can be challenging and rewarding. Building relationships across cultures is influenced by our society and identity.

B. Relationships are hard work that require constant upkeep and maintenance through communication. What is said and done becomes part of the relationship. Inaccurate interpretations of messages can lead to misunderstandings and conflict, but the potential reward of new cultural knowledge.

C. There are benefits and challenges to intercultural relationships, different types of intercultural relationships, and strategies for building solid intercultural relationships.

1. Benefits of Intercultural Relationships

A. Increasing Cultural Knowledge

1. Intercultural relationships can open us to learn more about the world. One can experience new food, music, games, sport, or dialect.

2. The new “history” you learn can ground the stories you hear from friends or family rather than through school or television.

B. Learning New Skills

1. New skills are required to adjust to difficulties in intercultural relationships.

2. Newfound understanding of one culture will make it more likely make it easier for you to relate to people from other cultures.

C. Challenging Previously Held Stereotypes

1. Intercultural relationships can help us rethink stereotypes. Differences can be challenging, but when the relationship is focused on the similarities, the relationship can be strengthened and preconceived stereotypes can be broken down.

2. Challenges in Intercultural Relationships

A. Perceived Differences

1. Perceived differences within intercultural relationships can create anxiety and uncertainty, and it takes effort to find similarities.

2. Anxiety levels can be higher if people have previous negative experiences. Once similarities are uncovered, the tension can begin to balance out and anxiety lessen.

B. Motivation

1. Intercultural relationships take more work to nurture and maintain, therefore motivation is essential. All differences and similarities must be explored and explained. This requires time, effort, and patience.

C. Negative Stereotypes

1. Negative stereotypes are powerful, take a conscious effort to detect, and can hinder progress towards relational development.

2. There are ways to reduce stereotyping discrimination within relationships.

a. Know the facts

b. Be aware of your attitudes and behavior

c. Choose your words carefully

d. Educate others

e. Focus on the positive

f. Support people

g. Include people

3. Intercultural relationships are not impossible. It is critical to affirm the other person’s cultural identity and recognize that the other person has different values. Beliefs, values, and behaviors that form their individual and cultural identities.

D. Common Types of Intercultural Relationships

1. Intercultural relationships between people with different cultural identities include romantic partners, friends, family, and coworkers.

2. Friendships and romantic relationships are the two most common types of intercultural relationships.

a. Intercultural Friendships: Friendship is a unique and important type of interpersonal relationship that constitutes a significant portion of a person's social life from early childhood all the way through late adulthood. It is different from other relationships because it is voluntary and a person can begin or end a relationship when desired.

i. Every culture has a different idea of what constitutes a friend that is rooted in the values of individualism and collectivism. Individualistic viewpoints see friendship as a voluntary decision that is more spontaneous and focused on individual goals. Americans that follow individualistic tendencies, form relationships quickly and can be informal, forward, intrusive, and superficial.

ii. Collectivists view friendship as a long-term obligation that involves mutual gain. Collectivistic Asian cultures emphasize indirect communication patterns and more stress on maintaining soul relationships, sincerity, and spirituality.

b. Friendship and Cultural Complexity: Intercultural friendships can be hard to start, develop, and maintain, however, different cultures can have similar views on friendship.

i. Previous intercultural experience increases the likelihood of intercultural friendship. More time is needed for friendships that cross nationalities for common understanding due to language barriers.

ii. Communication exchanges through self-disclosure and increase as friendship progresses.

iii. Cultural differences can enhance friendship development. Broadening one's perspective and learning about other cultures is not balanced. Intercultural friendships highlight the complexity of culture and the importance of being mindful of your communication and the context that it occurs in.

9.2: Intercultural Romantic Relationships

A. Similar to intercultural friendships, each culture has a different viewpoint of romantic relationships. Romantic relationships are "voluntary" and most cultures stress the importance of openness, mutual involvement, shared nonverbal meanings, and relationship assessment.

1. Facilitating Factors

A. Different factors draw you to a person such as physical attractiveness. The idea of attractiveness is different for each person.

B. Similarity is more than physical attractiveness and means sharing personalities, values, and preferences. Research has shown that we are attracted to those we perceive as similar to ourselves.

C. Complementarity is the idea that we are attracted to people that are different from us. There are conflicting studies that show the desire to find someone different that can complete us and the opposite, most people are not interested in dealing with people that are not like us

D. Proximity refers to how often people are around each other and has more impact on relationships.

E. Reciprocal liking is the idea that we tend to be attracted to people who are attracted to us.

F. Resources are the final attraction foundation. It refers to qualities such as a sense of humor, intelligence, kindness, and supportiveness.

2. Individualism and Collectivism in Romantic Relationships

A. Individualistic cultures view togetherness as important as long as it doesn't interfere with one's autonomy.

B. Collectivistic cultures often prioritize the value of "togetherness" for romantic partners. Family approval can make or break a relationship. Individual happiness is important but only can be fully realized within the family system

3. Conflict in Intercultural Relationships

A. Intercultural marriages and couples are increasing. Negotiating through the differences can be challenging. There are four distinct conflict styles that intercultural couples use to negotiate through differences.

1. Submission style is the most common and involves one partner abdicating power to the other's culture or cultural preferences. Although the most popular, it rarely works because submission involves denying one's own culture.
2. Compromise style means that both people sacrifice some aspect of their life. Each person gives up some culturally bound habit or value.
3. Obliteration style is when both partners try to erase the other's original culture and create a new culture.
4. Consensus style is the ideal and is based on negotiation and mutual agreement and neither has to abandon their own culture.

4. Gay & Lesbian Relationships

A. There has been more research done on heterosexual or cisgender intercultural friendships and romantic relationships than gay or same-sex intercultural relationships. The four areas that differ between the relationships are:

1. Importance of close relationships
2. Conflict management
3. Intimacy
4. The role of sexuality

B. Every culture can have a vast difference in how they support, accept, and categorize attraction and sexual relations between persons of the same gender.

C. Although the acceptance of gay and lesbian relationships is becoming more common, there is still prejudice and discrimination that same-gender relationships face.

D. One of the challenges for LGBTQ individuals is the fear of disclosing their sexuality because of the potential discrimination. If people are not comfortable disclosing their sexuality, then they are less likely to meet others that are the same as them. Another challenge is the lack of legal support and resources for gay and lesbian couples.

E. Despite the challenges, gay and lesbian relationships are similar to heterosexual relationships. People seek similar qualities in potential mates and experience similar degrees of relational satisfaction.

5. Interracial Relationships

6. Interracial relationships have existed throughout history, there have been more taboos in the United States between African Americans and white people than any other group.

A. Antimiscegenation laws were common and made it illegal for people of different racial/ethnic groups to marry. In 1967, the Supreme Court ruled that these laws are unconstitutional.

B. Relational satisfaction is not different for interracial partners, although the challenges they face can be stressors that are not as strong for intercultural partners.

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9.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. Which of the following is not a benefit of intercultural relationships?
 - a. Learning new skills
 - b. Increasing cultural knowledge
 - c. Challenging previously held stereotypes
 - *d. Confirming biases
2. Motivation is required to build a relationship across cultural boundaries
 - *a. True
 - b. False
3. Which of the following is not a suggestion to reduce stereotyping and discrimination within relationships?
 - a. Choose your words wisely
 - *b. Bring up past negative experiences
 - c. Be aware of your attitudes and behavior
 - d. Include everyone
4. Which of the following is an example of an intercultural relationship?
 - a. Romantic partners
 - b. Friends
 - c. Coworkers
 - *d. All of the above
5. Friendship is distinguished from other types of relationships by its “voluntary” nature.
 - *a. True
 - b. False
6. Which of the following is not an example of motivation for someone to pursue intercultural relationships?
 - a. Studying abroad in college
 - b. Studying a new language that is not their own
 - *d. Owning a car that is a foreign brand
7. Which of the following factors, that draw people to each other, refers to sharing personalities, values, and preferences?
 - a. Complementarity
 - *b. Similarity
 - c. Proximity
 - d. Reciprocal Liking
8. The attraction foundation called resources include qualities like sense of humor, intelligence, kindness, and supportiveness.
 - *a. True
 - b. False
9. Individualism and collectivism do not play a role in romantic relationships.
 - a. True

*b. False

10. Which of the following is not one of the four distinct conflict styles within intercultural relationships?

*a. Permission

b. Submission

c. Compromise

d. Obliteration

11. The consensus style is based on negotiation and mutual agreement, neither person has to assume that they must abandon their own culture.

*a. True

b. False

12. Which of the following is a difference between gay and cisgender relationships?

*a. Role of sexuality

b. Communication

c. Upbringing

d. Cultural identity

13. Gay and lesbian partners do not have a set preferences in terms of gender roles.

*a. True

b. False

14. Which of the following refer to laws making it illegal for people of different racial/ethnic groups to marry?

a. Illegal

*b. Antimiscegenation

c. Antisemitic

d. Unconstitutional

15. Proximity has no impact on relationships.

a. True

*b. False

16. Research has shown that individuals from different countries in intercultural friendships differ in terms of the topics and depth of this kind of communication exchange?

*a. Self-disclosure

b. Humor

c. Deception

d. Listening

17. Which of the following are not friendship variables that impact intercultural friendship formation?

a. Personality traits

b. Network patterns

c. Intergroup attitudes

*d. All of the above are variables that impact intercultural friendship formation

18. This factor, the simple fact of often being around each other exerts far more impact on relationships than generally acknowledged.

- a. Complementarity
- b. Similarity
- *c. Proximity
- d. Reciprocal Liking

19. Studies examining stories about “falling in love” have found that _____ is the most commonly mentioned factor leading to love

- a. Complementarity
- b. Similarity
- c. Proximity
- *d. Reciprocal Liking

20. In individualistic cultures such as the United States, togetherness is important as long as it doesn’t interfere too much with one’s _____.

- a. Family approval
- *b. Individual autonomy
- c. Passions
- d. Individual resources

Type: E

Short Answer

1. There are many benefits to interracial relationships. Identify a couple of the benefits and explain how they can impact society.
2. The four distinct conflict styles reflect how intercultural couples negotiate their way through differences. Do you agree that the compromise style is the most desirable? Why or why not.
3. Identify two ways in which romantic relationships have been influenced by society and culture.

Essay

1. How has your cultural upbringing influenced the way you communicate with friends or romantic partners with different cultural backgrounds? In which ways do you focus on the similarities and differences between the cultures?

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

10: Intercultural Communication Competence

[10.1: Chapter Resources](#)

[10.2: Outline](#)

[10.4: Test Bank](#)

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10.1: Chapter Resources

Activities

Test Your Competence

“Intercultural communication competence is the ability to communicate effectively and appropriately in various cultural contexts” (section 10.1). We hope that after a semester of studying intercultural communication students feel more competent and equipped for intercultural communication encounters. This activity is one way to measure students' competence levels.

Student Activity: Have students complete this [Test your Intercultural Competence Quiz](#) from the London School International Communication.

Investigation:

1. What were your perceptions of the quiz? How did you do?
2. This quiz focuses on specific cultural practices, do you think it is important to just know these things, why or why not?
3. If you were planning to travel to a specific country would you make sure you knew this information?
4. How would you go about finding the answers to this specific knowledge?
5. How does your willingness to learn and knowledge of how to find out demonstrate your competence?

Concept Map

Improving our intercultural competence requires knowledge. “Knowledge includes self- and other-awareness, mindfulness, and cognitive flexibility. Building knowledge of our own cultures, identities, and communication patterns takes more than passive experience” (section 10.1:Cultivating Intercultural Communication Competence). Over the course of this semester, students have built a great deal of knowledge.

One way to help them retain this information is by having them construct concept maps focusing on the full range of the course material. In order to do so, students will have to make choices about what is important enough to include and think about how to organize the material to make meaningful connections between topics.

Student Activity: Ask students to make concept maps for the knowledge and skills developed in the course. This activity is best done by having them work in small groups so they can recall as much information as possible and talk through the connections. Students can draw the maps by hand or use any number of online concept map construction tools.

[Concept Maps](#) The Learning Center, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill.

“Reflective practices can also help us process through rewards and challenges associated with developing intercultural communication competence” (section 10.1: Cultivating Intercultural Communication Competence). Now that students have reached the end of the course, it is a great opportunity for them to reflect on their experiences and what they have learned. Here are several questions you could consider asking:

- What was the most significant idea you learned in this class, or what was the most significant moment of your learning? Why?
- What was your biggest accomplishment in the course? What course elements helped you reach it?
- What risks did you take in this course?
- How has your perspective or understanding of intercultural communication changed, challenged, reinforced, or deepened after this course?
- What is one way you intend to use or apply your learning in your future endeavors?
- Did you have any “Aha” moments during the semester? Why do these events and “Aha” moments stand out?
- What challenges did you encounter during the course? Were you able to overcome them? Why or why not?
- What did your instructor do to support your academic journey through intercultural communication? What would have liked them to do differently?

Discussion Questions

1. Identify an intercultural encounter in which you did not communicate as competently as you would have liked. What concept(s) from the chapter (section 10.1: Cultivating Intercultural Communication Competence) would have helped you in this situation and how? Which of the following components of ICC—motivation, mindfulness, cognitive flexibility, and tolerance for uncertainty—do you think you are most competent at, and which one needs the most work? Identify how you became so competent at the first one and some ways that you can improve the second one. Choose one of the three ways discussed to cultivate ICC and make a list of five steps you can take to enhance this part of your competence.
2. Section 10.1: Intercultural Communication Competence lays out The National Communication Association’s guidelines for what it means to be a competent communicator (1999). They include:
 - State ideas clearly.
 - Communicate ethically.
 - Recognize when it is appropriate to communicate.
 - Identify their communication goals.

- Select the most appropriate and effective medium for communicating.
- Demonstrate credibility.
- Identify and manage misunderstandings.
- Manage conflict.
- Be open-minded about another's point of view.
- Listen attentively.

These guidelines were meant to be applied in a variety of communication situations, not specifically for intercultural communication. Now that you have a better sense of what it takes to be an effective intercultural communicator you should be able to apply them to intercultural encounters. Choose three of the guidelines above and explain what they would look like coming from someone who is an effective intercultural communicator.

[Supplemental Materials](#)

[Bridging Cultural Differences](#) - Ted Talk Playlist

It's all about understanding. These talks explore perspective -- looking past the stereotype and learning who people are, what they do and why they do it to build new cultural understandings.

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10.2: Outline

10.1: Intercultural Communication Competence

1. People who have developed good communication skills are described as having communication competence.
2. To have communication competence means that “we have knowledge of effective and appropriate communication patterns and the ability to use and adapt that knowledge in various contexts”
3. The National Communication Association (NCA) has developed guidelines for what it means to be a competent communicator (1999). They include:
 - A. State ideas clearly.
 - B. Communicate ethically.
 - C. Recognize when it is appropriate to communicate.
 - D. Identify their communication goals.
 - E. Select the most appropriate and effective medium for communicating.
 - F. Demonstrate credibility.
 - G. Identify and manage misunderstandings.
 - H. Manage conflict.
 - I. Be open-minded about another’s point of view.
 - J. Listen attentively.
4. Intercultural communication competence is the ability to communicate effectively and appropriately in various cultural contexts.
 - A. Unconscious incompetence is the “be yourself” approach. This person may not have a strong knowledge of cultural differences and does not see any need to accommodate differences in communication styles or culture.
 - B. Once people learn more about culture and communication, they may become conscious incompetent. This is where they have the vocabulary to identify the concepts, and know what they should be doing, but realize they are not communicating as well as they could.
 - C. As communication skills increase, and the focus is on cultural concepts and communication styles, you become a conscious competent communicator.
 - D. Unconscious competence means that you can communicate successfully without straining to be competent.
5. Cultivating Intercultural Communication Competence
 - A. Building intercultural communication competence often requires us to take more risks. Some of these risks require us to leave our comfort zones and adapt to new and uncertain situations.
 - B. Motivation refers to the root of a person’s desire to foster intercultural relationships.
 1. Intrinsic motivation occurs when a person has a healthy curiosity that drives him or her toward intercultural encounters in order to learn more about self and others, then there is a foundation from which to build additional competence-relevant attitudes and skills.
 2. Extrinsic motivation is driven by the desire for an outside reward like money, power, or recognition.
 3. Tolerance for uncertainty refers to an individual’s attitude about and level of comfort in uncertain situations.
 5. C. Members of dominant groups are often less motivated, intrinsically and extrinsically, toward intercultural communication than members of nondominant groups, because they don’t see the incentives for doing so.
 - D. Knowledge includes self- and other-awareness, mindfulness, and cognitive flexibility.
1. Building knowledge of our own cultures, identities, and communication patterns takes more than passive experience. Developing cultural self-awareness often requires us to get out of our comfort zones.
2. The most effective way to develop other-awareness is by direct and thoughtful encounters with other cultures.
3. Developing knowledge through self- and other-awareness is an ongoing process that will continue to adapt and grow as we encounter new experiences.
4. Mindfulness is a state of self- and other-monitoring that informs later reflection on communication interactions.
 - a) One tool to increase mindfulness involves learning more about our cognitive style, or how we learn. Our cognitive style consists of our preferred patterns for “gathering information, constructing meaning, and organizing and applying knowledge.”

b) This awareness can lead to cognitive flexibility, which refers to the ability to continually supplement and revise existing knowledge to create new categories rather than forcing new knowledge into old categories.

5. E. Skills

1. Contact with culturally different others alone does not increase intercultural skills; there must be more deliberate measures taken to fully capitalize on those encounters.

2. Research shows that intercultural contact does decrease prejudices, it is not enough to become interculturally competent.

3. The ability to empathize and manage anxiety enhances prejudice reduction, and these two skills have been shown to enhance the overall impact of intercultural contact even more than acquiring cultural knowledge.

4. Reflective practices can also help us process through rewards and challenges associated with developing intercultural communication competence.

5. F. Intercultural learning is a lifelong process.

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10.4: Test Bank

Multiple-Choice

1. People who have developed good communication skills are often described as having communication competence.
*True
False
2. Which of the following is not one of the guidelines developed by NCA for what it means to be a competent communicator?
 - a. State ideas clearly
 - b. Recognize when it is appropriate to communicate
 - *c. Avoid conflict
 - d. Listen attentively
3. Competence enables us to:
 - a. Better cope with the unexpected
 - b. Adapt to the nonroutine
 - c. Connect to uncommon frameworks
 - *d. All of the answers enable competence
4. In this level of intercultural communication competence, the person may not have a strong knowledge of cultural differences and does not see any need to accommodate differences in communication styles or culture.
 - a. Conscious incompetent
 - b. Unconscious competent
 - c. Conscious competent
 - *d. Unconscious incompetent
5. As communication skills increase and the focus is on cultural concepts and communication styles, you become a(n) _____ communicator. You know that you are communicating well in the moment, and you can add this memory to your growing bank of successful intercultural interactions.
 - a. Conscious incompetent
 - b. Unconscious competent
 - *c. Conscious competent
 - d. Unconscious incompetent
6. This motivation makes intercultural communication a voluntary, rewarding, and lifelong learning process.
 - *a. Intrinsic
 - b. Extrinsic
 - c. Antittrinsic
 - d. All of the other answers are correct
7. Individuals who are intrinsically motivated toward intercultural communication may have a higher tolerance for uncertainty.
 - *a. True
 - b. False
8. Seeking out intercultural training demonstrates what aspect of building intercultural communication competence?
 - a. Motivation

b. Awareness

*c. Skills

d. Mindfulness

9. The most effective way to develop _____ is by direct and thoughtful encounters with other cultures.

a. Self-awareness

*b. Other-awareness

c. Mindfulness

d. Cognitive flexibility

10. The overall diversity of the United States means most people regularly interact with people who are very different from themselves.

a. True

*b. False

11. The ability to continually supplement and revise existing knowledge to create new categories rather than forcing new knowledge into old categories is referred to as:

a. Self-awareness

b. Other-awareness

c. Mindfulness

*d. Cognitive flexibility

12. Taking note of negative or defensive reactions you have to intercultural encounters demonstrates:

a. Self-awareness

*b. Reflective practices

c. Tolerance for uncertainty

d. Motivation

13. Members of _____ groups are often less motivated, intrinsically and extrinsically, toward intercultural communication, because they don't see the incentives for doing so.

a. Dominant

*b. Nondominant

c. Majority

d. Minority

14. An individual's attitude about and level of comfort in new and different situations is referred to as:

a. Self-awareness

b. Reflective practices

*c. Tolerance for uncertainty

d. Motivation

15. Our preferred patterns for "gathering information, constructing meaning, and organizing and applying knowledge" make up our:

a. Tolerance of uncertainty

b. Cognitive flexibility

c. Reflective practices

*d. Cognitive style

16. Uncritically accepting the dominant belief systems, relying on stereotypes, or prejudging someone based on their identities are all indications that we are:

a. Thinking without purpose

*b. Thinking under the influence

c. Acting before thinking things through

d. Judgemental thinking

17. _____ is a practice by which we acknowledge intersecting identities, both privileged and disadvantaged, and implicate ourselves in social hierarchies and inequalities.

a. Reflexology

b. Getting competent

c. Cognitive flexibility

d. Intersectional reflexivity

18. Knowledge of another language does not automatically equate to intercultural communication competence.

*a. True

b. False

19. This means of cultivating intercultural communication competence requires that we develop a sense of wonder about culture.

*a. Fostering attitudes that motivate us

b. Discovering knowledge that informs us

c. Developing skills that enable us

d. Acting in ways that meet our needs

20. Women in corporate environments may adopt masculine communication patterns, people who are gay or lesbian may self-censor and avoid discussing their same-gender partners with coworkers, and people with nonvisible disabilities may not disclose them in order to avoid judgment. These are all examples of:

a. Uncertainty avoidance

*b. Code-switching

c. Extrinsic motivation

d. Power encounters

Type: E

Short Answer

1. Explain how “thinking under the influence” (TUI) can help us hone our intercultural communication competence.

2. Describe an intercultural encounter that you had. How did this encounter help you develop other-awareness? If it did not, explain.

3. How has this course helped you build your intercultural communication competence? What will you do moving forward to continue this growth?

Essay

1. With a better understanding of intercultural communicator competence and the National Communication Association’s guidelines for what it means to be a competent communicator (1999). What are the main challenges to obtaining communicator competence? Given the challenges, what are ways to enhance communicator competence?

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Index

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 - 1: What is Intercultural Communication? - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [1.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [1.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [1.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 2: Cultural Essentials and the Roots of Culture - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [2.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [2.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [2.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 3: Identity and Intercultural Communication - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [3.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [3.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [3.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 4: Verbal Processes in Intercultural Communication - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [4.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [4.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [4.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 5: Nonverbal Processes in Intercultural Communication - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [5.1: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [5.3: Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [5.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 6: Culture Shock - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [6.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [6.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [6.3: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 7: Barriers to Intercultural Communication - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [7.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [7.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [7.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 8: Intercultural Conflict - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [8.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [8.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [8.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 9: Intercultural Relationships - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [9.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [9.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [9.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - 10: Intercultural Communication Competence - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [10.1: Chapter Resources](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [10.2: Outline](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - [10.4: Test Bank](#) - [CC BY 4.0](#)
 - Back Matter - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Index](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)